

INDIAN POLITY

Simplified — High-Retention Revision Guide

Allahabad High Court RO/ARO Exam & UP State-Level Competitive Examinations

Features:

Simple Language • Mnemonics & Memory Tricks • Article & Amendment Shortcuts
Comparison Tables • Frequently Confused Topics • Expected MCQs
Quick-Revision Boxes • Last-Minute Revision Sheet

*Compiled from Constitution of India, NCERT Polity, M. Laxmikanth — Indian Polity,
Constitutional Amendments, PRS Legislative Research, PIB / Current Affairs (up to June 2026)*

How To Use This Guide

This guide rewrites the entire Polity syllabus in simple, exam-focused English specifically for the Allahabad High Court RO/ARO Exam and similar UP state-level competitive exams.

- ★ EXAM FOCUS boxes (blue) highlight points frequently asked or specifically appearing in Allahabad HC RO/ARO papers.
- 🧠 MEMORY TRICK boxes (yellow) give mnemonics, acronyms, and shortcut tricks for hard-to-remember numbers.
- ⚠️ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED boxes (red/pink) flag commonly mixed-up pairs that examiners love to test.
- 📖 QUICK REVISION boxes (green) give a rapid-fire recap of each Unit for last-minute reading.
- 📅 PREVIOUS YEAR FOCUS boxes (purple) flag facts that have a track record of appearing in past papers.
- Tables are used wherever comparison helps memory (e.g., Money Bill vs Ordinary Bill, President vs Governor).
- Article numbers, Schedules, Parts and Amendments are bolded/tabled throughout — these are the single most-tested elements in RO/ARO Polity.
- Dedicated sections at the end cover: Master Quick-Reference Tables, Writs, the Seventh Schedule, Frequently Confused Topics, High Court RO-Focused Comparison Tables, Most Important Articles/Amendments, Expected MCQs, One-Liner Facts, FAQs, and a Last-Minute Revision Sheet.

Note on currency of facts: Office-holder names (President, Vice-President, CJI, CEC, etc.) are updated to June 2026. Always verify the latest incumbents close to your exam date, as these change.

UNIT 1: UNION EXECUTIVE

The President is the nominal (constitutional) Head of State. Real power lies with the Council of Ministers headed by the PM. Think of the President as the 'Chairman' of a company and the PM as the 'CEO' who actually runs daily operations.

1.1 President of India — Key Articles (52–78)

Article	Provision
52	There shall be a President of India
53	Executive power of Union vested in President
54	Election of President (Electoral College)
55	Manner of election
56	Term of office — 5 years
57	Eligible for re-election (any number of times)
58	Qualifications for election
60	Oath/affirmation by President
61	Procedure for impeachment
72	Pardoning power
74	Council of Ministers to aid & advise President
75	Appointment of PM & other Ministers



MEMORY TRICK

"52 → 78 = President's Palace": Article 52 (President exists) to Article 78 (duties of PM towards President) covers the whole office.

Order trick — "E-E-E-M-T-R-Q-O-I": Exists(52) → Executive power(53) → Election(54) → Manner(55) → Term(56) → Re-election(57) → Qualification(58) → Oath(60) → Impeachment(61). Read them in order — they literally follow the life-cycle of a President: born → works → elected → sworn-in → removed.

Qualification (Art. 58) trick — "C-35-Q-O" (say it like 'see-thirty-five-cue-oh'): Citizen of India, 35 years, Qualified for Lok Sabha, no Office of profit.

Election of the President (Article 54)

- Elected indirectly by an Electoral College: elected MPs (LS+RS) + elected MLAs of States, NCT Delhi & Puducherry.
- Nominated MPs/MLAs do NOT vote in Presidential election.
- System used: Proportional Representation by Single Transferable Vote (STV); secret ballot.
- Value of vote of MP/MLA calculated by a special formula to balance Centre and States.

MEMORY TRICK

"No NOMINATION, No VOTE" — in Presidential election, nominated members are silent spectators. Remember: President's election = only ELECTED people decide (mirrors democracy at its purest).

Term, Oath & Vacancy

- Term: 5 years from date of entering office (Art. 56); unlimited re-election (Art. 57).
- Oath administered by Chief Justice of India (or senior-most SC judge in CJI's absence).
- Resigns by writing to the Vice-President.
- Vacancy: VP acts as President; if VP unavailable, CJI discharges functions.
- Fresh election must happen within 6 months of vacancy.

Impeachment (Article 61)

- Only ground: 'Violation of the Constitution'.
- Can start in EITHER House; charge signed by 1/4th members; 14 days' notice to President.
- Passed by Special Majority (2/3rd of total membership) in that House.
- Other House investigates; the President can appear/be represented.
- If the 2nd House also passes by special majority → President removed from that date.

No Indian President has ever faced impeachment proceedings to date.

MEMORY TRICK

"VIP-14" — Violation is the only ground, Impeachment can start in either house, Process is quasi-judicial, 14 days' notice required.

Nominated members CAN vote in impeachment (unlike Presidential election) — remember: 'Impeachment is Parliament's job — everyone in Parliament votes'.

President's Veto Power (Bills other than Money Bills)

Veto Type	Meaning
Absolute Veto	Withholds assent; bill ends completely
Suspensive Veto	Returns bill for reconsideration; must assent if re-passed
Pocket Veto	Neither signs nor rejects nor returns — keeps pending indefinitely, no time limit
No Veto (Const. Amendment Bills)	Must give assent — since 24th Amendment, 1971

MEMORY TRICK

"A-S-P" — Absolute, Suspensive, Pocket — remember as 'A Sleepy President' has 3 veto moods.

Pocket Veto story: imagine the President puts the bill in his POCKET and forgets about it forever — no deadline, no answer.

Powers of the President — "EeLFJEM" Memory Code

Use the acronym E-L-F-J-E-M to recall the 6 power categories:

- E — Executive: appoints PM, Ministers, Governors, CJI, judges, CAG, AG, ECs, UPSC, Finance Commission, Ambassadors.
- L — Legislative: summons/prorogues Parliament, dissolves LS, nominates 12 RS members, assents to bills.
- F — Financial: Money Bills need prior Presidential recommendation; controls Contingency Fund (Art. 267).
- J — Judicial: pardoning power (Art. 72) — including death sentence & Court Martial.
- E — Emergency: National Emergency (352), President's Rule (356), Financial Emergency (360).
- M — Military/Diplomatic: Supreme Commander of Defence Forces; treaties concluded in his name.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Tenth Schedule (Anti-Defection) added by 52nd Amendment, 1985 — often confused with other Schedules.

Impeachment needs special majority in BOTH Houses but does NOT need Presidential assent (he is the accused).

Nominated members CAN vote in impeachment (unlike Presidential election) — a commonly tested distinction.

Pardoning power: President (Art. 72) > Governor (Art. 161) — only President can pardon death sentence & Court Martial.

List of Presidents of India — Quick Facts

President	Term	Notable Fact
Dr. Rajendra Prasad	1950–1962	First President; only President with two full terms (12 yrs)
Dr. S. Radhakrishnan	1962–1967	'Philosopher President'; birthday = Teachers' Day (5 Sept)
Dr. Zakir Husain	1967–1969	First Muslim President; first to die in office
V. V. Giri	1969 (acting), 1969–1974	Only person Acting + elected President; ex-trade unionist
Mohammad Hidayatullah	1969 (acting)	Only CJI to later officiate as President
Fakhruddin Ali Ahmed	1974–1977	Died in office; 1975 Emergency proclaimed in his term
B. D. Jatti	1977 (acting)	Acting President after Ahmed's death

President	Term	Notable Fact
Neelam Sanjiva Reddy	1977–1982	Only unopposed President; ex-LS Speaker (twice)
Giani Zail Singh	1982–1987	First Sikh President
R. Venkataraman	1987–1992	—
Dr. Shankar Dayal Sharma	1992–1997	—
K. R. Narayanan	1997–2002	First Dalit President
Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	2002–2007	'Missile Man'; 'People's President'
Smt. Pratibha Patil	2007–2012	First woman President
Pranab Mukherjee	2012–2017	—
Ram Nath Kovind	2017–2022	Second Dalit President
Droupadi Murmu	2022–present	First ST President; 2nd woman; youngest President

PREVIOUS YEAR FOCUS

Neelam Sanjiva Reddy was Speaker of Lok Sabha TWICE (1967 & 1977) before becoming President in 1977 — very frequently asked.

1.2 Vice-President of India (Articles 63–67)

Article	Provision
63	The Vice-President of India
64	VP is ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha
65	VP acts as President in certain contingencies
66	Election of Vice-President
67	Term of office of VP

- Electoral College = BOTH Houses of Parliament only (no MLAs unlike President).
- Both elected AND nominated MPs vote.
- Term: 5 years; min. age 35; must be qualified for Rajya Sabha membership.
- Oath administered by the President.
- Removed by: RS resolution (effective majority) + LS agreement (simple majority) — NOT impeachment.

As of June 2026, the Vice-President of India is Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan (15th VP), ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha.

MEMORY TRICK

"VP votes only with MPs" — the single biggest VP vs President difference: VP election has NO STATE involvement at all.

Removal of VP starts ONLY in Rajya Sabha (his own house) — 'You get removed from the house you preside over'.

Comparison: President vs Vice-President

Aspect	President	Vice-President
Election	Indirect — MPs + MLAs	Indirect — only MPs (elected+nominated)
Minimum Age	35 years	35 years
Eligibility	Qualified for Lok Sabha	Qualified for Rajya Sabha
Oath by	Chief Justice of India	President of India
Removal	Impeachment (Art. 61)	RS resolution + LS agreement
Dispute Resolution	Supreme Court	Supreme Court

1.3 Prime Minister & Council of Ministers

- Art. 74: CoM headed by PM aids & advises President — advice is BINDING (42nd & 44th Amendments).
- **Art. 75(1)**: PM appointed by President; other Ministers on PM's advice.
- **Art. 75(3)**: CoM collectively responsible to Lok Sabha only.
- **Art. 75(1A) [91st Amdt., 2003]**: CoM strength (incl. PM) $\leq$ 15% of total LS membership.
- Non-MP/MLA Ministers must get elected within 6 months.

Three Categories of Ministers — "C-S-D" Trick

- C — Cabinet Ministers: head key ministries, top decision-makers.
- S — (Ministers of) State: independent charge or assist Cabinet Ministers.
- D — Deputy Ministers: assist; no independent charge.

Council of Ministers = ALL 3 categories. Cabinet = only Cabinet Ministers (smaller, real power centre). This distinction is a favourite MCQ trap.

Responsibility — Collective vs Individual

- Collective (Art. 75(3)): If No-Confidence Motion passes, ENTIRE CoM resigns. Lord Morley: ministers 'swim or sink together'.
- Individual (Art. 75(2)): Ministers hold office 'during the pleasure of the President'; PM can ask a minister to quit.
- No-Confidence Motion: moved ONLY in Lok Sabha; needs min. 50 members' support to be admitted; not named in the Constitution itself.

★ EXAM FOCUS

91st Amendment (2003): CoM capped at 15% of House strength; also tightened anti-defection (only whole-party mergers recognised).
 Non-MP/MLA can become Minister but must get elected within 6 months — e.g. H.D. Deve Gowda became PM (1996) without being an MP/MLA at appointment.
 No-Confidence Motion: Lok Sabha ONLY; minimum 50 members for admission.

Prime Minister — Key Facts Table

Fact	Detail
First woman PM	Indira Gandhi
First non-Congress PM	Morarji Desai (1977)
PM who never sat in Lok Sabha	Chaudhary Charan Singh
Shortest-tenure PM	Atal Bihari Vajpayee (13 days, 1996)
PM who introduced LPG reforms (1991)	P. V. Narasimha Rao (with FM Manmohan Singh)
PM who became PM while still an MLA	H. D. Deve Gowda (1996)
Longest-serving PM	Jawaharlal Nehru (1947–1964)
Current PM (June 2026)	Narendra Modi

1.4 Attorney General of India (Article 76)

- Highest law officer of the country; appointed by President; qualified to be a SC judge.
- Holds office 'during the pleasure of the President' — no fixed tenure.
- Can speak in both Houses + any Joint Sitting + any Parliamentary Committee, but CANNOT VOTE.
- Has all privileges of an MP but is NOT an MP or part of the CoM.

As of June 2026, the Attorney General of India is Shri R. Venkataramani.

MEMORY TRICK

"AG can SPEAK but can't VOTE" — like a guest lecturer in Parliament: full access to speak, zero voting rights.

Solicitor General & Additional Solicitors General assist the AG but are NOT constitutional posts — only statutory/government-created.

QUICK REVISION

President: Art. 52–78 (Part V). Election: indirect, STV, secret ballot. Term: 5 yrs, unlimited re-election. Min age: 35.

Oath by CJI. Removal only by impeachment (Art. 61) — 'violation of Constitution'.

Money Bill needs PRIOR Presidential recommendation (Art. 110/117).

Constitutional Amendment Bills: President has NO veto (24th Amdt., 1971).

Pardoning power: Art. 72 (President, incl. death sentence) wider than Art. 161 (Governor).

VP: Art. 63–71; ex-officio RS Chairman (Art. 64); only MPs vote.

CoM headed by PM — Art. 74 & 75; responsible to Lok Sabha only.

91st Amdt (2003): CoM $\leq$ 15% of House strength.

Attorney General — Art. 76; highest law officer; speaks but can't vote in Parliament.

UNIT 2: PARLIAMENT

Parliament = President + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha (Article 79). Visualise it as a 3-legged stool — remove any leg and it's incomplete.

2.1 Lok Sabha (House of the People)

- Article 81: Composition. Max strength: 552 (530 States + 20 UTs). Current: 545.
- 2 Anglo-Indian nominated seats abolished by 104th Amendment, 2019.
- Directly elected by universal adult franchise (Art. 326) from territorial constituencies.
- Normal term: 5 years; extendable by 1 year at a time during National Emergency (not beyond 6 months post-emergency).
- Minimum age to contest: 25 years (Art. 84). Quorum: 1/10th of total membership.

Speaker & Deputy Speaker

- Elected by LS from amongst its own members (Art. 93).
- Decides if a bill is a Money Bill — FINAL & binding (Art. 110(3)).
- Resigns by writing to Deputy Speaker (vice-versa).
- Removed by effective-majority resolution; 14 days' notice required.
- Continues in office even after LS dissolution, till new House meets.
- Presides over Joint Sitzings (Art. 118) — NOT the RS Chairman.

First Speaker of Independent India's Lok Sabha: G. V. Mavalankar.



MEMORY TRICK

"104 → Anglo gone" — 104th Amendment, 2019 = Anglo-Indian seats abolished. Peg: 1-0-4 looks like 'IO4' — 'I owe for(4) Anglo-Indians' — (their seats are gone).

2.2 Rajya Sabha (Council of States)

- Article 80: Composition. Max: 250 (238 elected + 12 nominated). Current: 245 (233+12).
- PERMANENT body — never dissolved; 1/3rd retire every 2 years.
- Member's term: 6 years. Elected by State MLAs via proportional representation/STV.
- Min. age: 30 years (Art. 84).
- VP = ex-officio Chairman (Art. 64); House also elects a Deputy Chairman.
- Constituted 3 April 1952; first sitting 13 May 1952.

Special Powers of Rajya Sabha — "SAS" Trick

Remember 'SAS' — State subject & All-india Services — these are powers the Lok Sabha does NOT have:

- **Article 249:** RS, by 2/3rd majority, can let Parliament legislate on a State List subject 'in national interest' (renewable, max 1 yr at a time).
- **Article 312:** RS, by 2/3rd majority resolution, can authorise Parliament to create new All India Services (e.g. IAS, IPS, IFoS).

Trick: 2-4-9 → '2 for 49 States' (State List power); 3-1-2 → sounds like 'service number' (All India Services).

★ EXAM FOCUS

Articles 249 & 312 give RS special powers LS does NOT have — classic question.
Rajya Sabha CANNOT be dissolved — a continuing chamber.
Money Bill can be held by RS for max. 14 days only.
Ordinary bill can be held/rejected by RS up to 6 months before Joint Sitting can be called.

Lok Sabha vs Rajya Sabha — Quick Comparison

Aspect	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Nature	Lower House; directly elected	Upper House; permanent body
Max. Strength	552	250
Current Strength	545	245
Term	5 years (can dissolve)	Permanent; member's term 6 yrs
Min. Age (Member)	25 years	30 years
Presiding Officer	Speaker (elected)	Chairman (VP, ex-officio)
Money Bill	Originates ONLY here	Can only recommend, max 14 days
Dissolution	Yes	Never

2.3 Sessions of Parliament (Article 85)

Point	Detail
Summons/Prorogues	President (on CoM advice)
Max gap between sessions	6 months
Conventional pattern	Budget (Feb–May), Monsoon (Jul–Sep), Winter (Nov–Dec)
LS on dissolution	Ceases to exist; pending bills (except joint-sitting bills) lapse
RS on prorogation	Continues; never dissolves

- Zero Hour: Indian innovation (NOT in Rules of Procedure); starts right after Question Hour (~12 noon); raises urgent matters without notice; began in 1960s.
- Question Hour: first hour of sitting; governed by Rules of Procedure (unlike Zero Hour).

MEMORY TRICK

"Zero Hour has ZERO rules" — easy way to recall it's NOT mentioned in the Rules of Procedure, unlike Question Hour which IS.

2.4 Bills & Legislative Procedure

Types of Bills

- Ordinary Bill — either House, Minister or private member.
- Money Bill (Art. 110) — only taxation/borrowing/Consolidated Fund matters.
- Financial Bill Type I (Art. 117(1)) — Money Bill matters + other provisions; LS only; needs prior Presidential recommendation.
- Financial Bill Type II (Art. 117(3)) — expenditure from Consolidated Fund but not a Money Bill; either House; Presidential nod needed before CONSIDERATION, not introduction.
- Constitution Amendment Bill (Art. 368) — either House; special majority.

Comparative Table: Bills

Aspect	Ordinary	Money Bill	Fin. Bill-I	Fin. Bill-II	Const. Amdt
Prior Pres. recomm.?	No	Yes	Yes	No	No
House of introduction	Either	LS only	LS only	Either	Either
Majority	Simple	Simple	Simple	Simple	Special
Joint Sitting?	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No
Article	—	110	117(1)	117(3)	368

Money Bill — Full Detail (Article 110)

Aspect	Detail
Introduced in	Only Lok Sabha
Who introduces	Only a Minister
Prior Recommendation	Required before introduction
Role of Rajya Sabha	Can only recommend; cannot amend/reject
Time limit for RS	14 days
If RS doesn't act	Deemed passed after 14 days
Joint Sitting	Not allowed
Speaker's role	Decides Money Bill status — FINAL (Art. 110(3))
President's Assent	Cannot return for reconsideration; only assent

Bills Requiring PRIOR Presidential Recommendation — "M-3-117-304-274" Trick

- Money Bill (Art. 110)
- New State formation / boundary alteration (Art. 3)
- Expenditure from Consolidated Fund, even if not Money Bill (Art. 117)
- State bill restricting trade/commerce freedom (Art. 304)
- State bill on taxation affecting States' financial interests (Art. 274)

Mnemonic: "My Money, New States, Big Funds, Trade Restricted, Tax Talks" — each phrase pegs to a bill type needing Presidential nod.

President's Options on an Ordinary Bill

Option	Details
1. Give assent	Bill becomes an Act
2. Withhold assent	Absolute veto; bill ends
3. Return for reconsideration	Suspensive veto; must assent if re-passed
4. Pocket veto	No action; no time limit prescribed

Joint Sitting of Parliament (Article 108)

- Called by President for deadlock on ordinary bill/Financial Bill (NOT Money Bills or Constitutional Amendment Bills).
- Presided over by Speaker of LS (or Deputy Speaker; or RS Deputy Chairman if both absent).
- Decided by simple majority of both Houses present & voting.
- Held only 3 times: Dowry Prohibition Bill (1961), Banking Service Commission (Repeal) Bill (1978), POTA Bill (2002).

MEMORY TRICK

"DBP" = Dowry (1961), Banking (1978), POTA (2002) — the only 3 Joint Sitzings ever, in chronological order.

Joint Sitting: SUMMONED by President (Art. 108) but PRESIDED by Speaker (Art. 118) — 'President calls the meeting, Speaker runs it'.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Joint Sitting summoned under Art. 108, presided under Art. 118 — a commonly confused pair.

No Joint Sitting for Money Bills or Constitutional Amendment Bills — only ordinary & Financial Bills.

Only 3 Joint Sitzings in history (1961, 1978, 2002).

2.5 Parliamentary Committees

Committee	Key Facts
Public Accounts Committee (PAC)	Est. 1921 (GoI Act 1919); examines CAG audit reports; 22 members (15 LS+7 RS); Chairman from Opposition (convention since 1967)
Estimates Committee	LARGEST committee; 30 members, LS only; examines budget estimates, suggests economy
Committee on Public Undertakings	22 members (15 LS+7 RS); examines PSU reports/accounts

Committee	Key Facts
Departmentally Related Standing Committees (DRSCs)	24 committees; scrutinise bills/budgets/policies of ministries

All LS committees function under the Speaker, who appoints chairpersons of all Parliamentary Committees.

QUICK REVISION

Parliament = President + LS + RS (Art. 79).

LS: max. 552, current 545; term 5 yrs; min. age 25.

RS: max. 250, current 245; permanent; min. age 30; 1/3rd retire every 2 yrs.

Art. 85: max. 6-month gap between sessions.

Art. 108: Joint Sitting summoned by President. Art. 110: Money Bill. Art. 117: Financial Bills.

Speaker decides Money Bill status — final (Art. 110(3)).

104th Amdt (2019): abolished Anglo-Indian seats. 91st Amdt (2003): CoM $\leq$ 15%.

PAC — 1921; Estimates Committee — largest (30, LS only).

UNIT 3: STATE EXECUTIVE

3.1 Governor

- Constitutional head of a State; first citizen; appointed by President (Art. 155) as Union's representative.
- Article 153: A Governor for each State (one person CAN govern 2+ States — 7th Amendment, 1956).
- Article 154: Executive power of State vested in Governor.
- Article 157: Must be Indian citizen, 35+ years.
- Article 156: Holds office 'during pleasure of President'; normal term 5 years.
- Oath by Chief Justice of the State High Court (or senior-most judge).
- Unlike President, Governor is NOT elected — appointed/nominated, an agent of the Union.

Article	Provision
153	Governor of States
154	Executive power of State
155	Appointment of Governor
156	Term of office
157	Qualifications
158	Conditions of office
159	Oath/affirmation
160	Discharge of functions in contingencies
161	Pardoning power of Governor

MEMORY TRICK

"153 → 161 = Governor's Address" — just like Pin codes follow each other: 153 (exists) to 161 (pardon) covers the whole office in sequence.

Governor's pardon (161) is 'Junior' to President's pardon (72) — 'J' for Junior = no death sentence, no Court Martial power.

★ EXAM FOCUS

First woman Governor (Independent India): Sarojini Naidu, United Provinces (now UP), 1947–49 — the 'Nightingale of India'.

Governor CANNOT pardon a death sentence or touch Court Martial sentences (only President can).

One person can be Governor of 2+ States simultaneously (7th Amendment, 1956).

Governor vs President — Quick Comparison

Aspect	President	Governor
Mode of Selection	Indirectly elected	Appointed by President
Pardoning power	Art. 72 — incl. death sentence & Court Martial	Art. 161 — NO power over either
Tenure	Fixed 5 yrs; removable only by impeachment	'During pleasure of President'
Discretion	Very limited	Has discretionary powers (e.g. reserving bills, recommending Pres. Rule)

3.2 Chief Minister & State Council of Ministers

- Article 163: CoM headed by CM aids/advises Governor (except matters needing Governor's discretion).
- Article 164: CM appointed by Governor; other Ministers on CM's advice.
- **Article 164(1A) [91st Amdt., 2003]:** State CoM size $\leq$ 15% of State Assembly strength (minimum 12 ministers incl. CM).
- CoM collectively responsible to the State Legislative Assembly.

QUICK REVISION

Governor — Art. 153–162 (Part VI); appointed by President for 5 yrs 'during pleasure'.
Pardoning: President (72) > Governor (161) — Governor cannot touch death sentences.
7th Amdt (1956): one Governor for 2+ States.
CM & State CoM — Art. 163 & 164; responsible to State Assembly.
91st Amdt also capped State CoM at 15% (min. 12 ministers).

UNIT 4: JUDICIARY

4.1 Supreme Court of India

Part V, Articles 124–147. SC = guardian of the Constitution & final court of appeal.

Article	Provision
124	Establishment of SC; appointment of CJI & judges
126	Appointment of acting Chief Justice
127	Appointment of ad-hoc judges
131	Original jurisdiction (Centre-State / inter-State disputes)
137	Power to review its own judgments
141	Law declared by SC binding on all courts in India
143	Advisory jurisdiction (President may refer questions)
32	Right to Constitutional Remedies (also a Fundamental Right)

MEMORY TRICK

"1-3-1 = Original", "1-4-1 = Law is Law (binding)", "1-4-3 = Advice" — spot the pattern: 131→143 are all SC's special powers, increasing by digit groups.

Article 32 is itself a Fundamental Right (Dr. Ambedkar: 'heart and soul' of the Constitution) — NOT just a remedy clause.

- Jurisdiction: Original (Art. 131), Writ (Art. 32), Appellate (civil/criminal/constitutional), Advisory (Art. 143).
- SC judges: appointed by President; retire at 65.
- Removal of SC/HC judges: only by Parliament, address + special majority of each House, on 'proved misbehaviour or incapacity' (Art. 124(4)).

★ EXAM FOCUS

Article 141: SC's law binding on ALL courts — ultimate interpreter of law.

Article 32 (FR, SC writ) vs Article 226 (constitutional right, HC writ) — frequently tested distinction.

Article 131 = SC's ORIGINAL jurisdiction (Centre vs State / State vs State).

4.2 High Courts

Articles 214–231 (Part VI).

- Article 214: A High Court for each State (one HC can cover 2+ States/UTs).
- Article 217: HC judges appointed by President.
- **Article 226:** HC can issue writs for FR enforcement AND 'any other purpose' — WIDER than SC's Art. 32 (FR only).
- HC judges retire at 62.

High Courts With Jurisdiction Over More Than One State/UT

High Court	Coverage	Seat / Bench
Bombay HC	Maharashtra, Goa, Dadra & Nagar Haveli, Daman & Diu	Mumbai (Nagpur, Aurangabad, Panaji)
Calcutta HC	West Bengal, A&N Islands	Kolkata (Port Blair)
Guwahati HC	Assam, Nagaland, Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh	Guwahati (Kohima, Aizawl, Itanagar)
Punjab & Haryana HC	Punjab, Haryana, Chandigarh	Chandigarh
Madras HC	Tamil Nadu, Puducherry	Chennai (Madurai)
Kerala HC	Kerala, Lakshadweep	Ernakulam

Single-State HCs (no sharing): Allahabad, Delhi, Karnataka, Rajasthan, Gujarat, Patna, etc.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Article 226 gives HCs **BROADER** writ jurisdiction than SC (Art. 32) — FR enforcement + 'any other purpose'.

Allahabad High Court is the **LARGEST** High Court in India by sanctioned judge strength; main seat Prayagraj, Bench at Lucknow.

J&K and Ladakh share a common High Court (Srinagar/Jammu, rotation) after the J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019.

📌 QUICK REVISION

SC: Art. 124–147 (Part V); HC: Art. 214–231 (Part VI).

Art. 32 (SC writ, FR only) vs Art. 226 (HC writ, FR + any other purpose) — HC wider in scope.

Art. 131: SC original jurisdiction. Art. 141: SC law binding on all courts. Art. 143: SC advisory.

SC judges retire at 65; HC judges retire at 62.

Judge removal: special majority address in Parliament, 'proved misbehaviour or incapacity' (Art. 124(4)).

UNIT 5: FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS

Part III, Articles 12–35 — called the 'Magna Carta' of India. Justiciable (enforceable in court). Inspired by the Bill of Rights of the USA.

Key Facts

- Originally 7 Fundamental Rights; now 6 — Right to Property removed by 44th Amendment, 1978 → now Art. 300-A (legal right, Part XII).

The Six Fundamental Rights — "E-F-E-R-C-C" Acronym

Memorise the order using: Equality → Freedom → Exploitation → Religion → Cultural → Constitutional Remedies. Trick phrase: "Every Free Election Requires Clean Conduct."

Right	Articles
Right to Equality	14 to 18
Right to Freedom	19 to 22
Right against Exploitation	23 to 24
Right to Freedom of Religion	25 to 28
Cultural & Educational Rights	29 to 30
Right to Constitutional Remedies	32

MEMORY TRICK

"14-18 Equal, 19-22 Free, 23-24 No Exploit, 25-28 Religion, 29-30 Culture, 32 Remedy" — read it like a countdown ladder; each block is bigger except the last (Art. 32 stands alone as the FR enforcer).

Story trick: A STUDENT (Art. 29-30, Cultural/Educational) practises RELIGION (25-28) FREELY (19-22) without EXPLOITATION (23-24) because all are EQUAL (14-18), and if anything goes wrong, the COURT (32) fixes it.

★ **EXAM FOCUS**

44th Amendment, 1978 removed Right to Property from Part III → now only a legal right under Art. 300-A.

Article 21 (Life & Personal Liberty) judicially expanded hugely — includes Right to Privacy (K.S. Puttaswamy, 2017), Right to Education (later Art. 21A), clean environment, etc.

Article 21A (Right to Education, age 6–14) inserted by 86th Amendment, 2002.

Article 32 is itself a Fundamental Right (Dr. Ambedkar: 'heart and soul' of the Constitution).

Articles 20 & 21 CANNOT be suspended even during National Emergency (post-44th Amendment) — very high-value fact.

Suspension of Fundamental Rights During Emergency

- Article 358: During National Emergency (war/external aggression), Article 19 freedoms AUTOMATICALLY suspended; restored automatically when emergency ends.
- Article 359: President can suspend the right to move courts for FR enforcement (except Art. 20 & 21) via separate order during emergency.
- This Art. 20 & 21 safeguard added by the 44th Amendment, 1978 (post-Emergency reform).

MEMORY TRICK

"358 = teen-Nine auto-gone" — Article 358 suspends Article 19 AUTOMATICALLY (numbers 3-5-8 vs 1-9, just remember 358 → 19).

"359 = court closed, except 20-21" — Article 359 closes the COURT DOOR for FR enforcement, but 20 & 21 always keep a door open.

FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Article 358 (automatic suspension of Art. 19 only, ONLY during war/external aggression) vs Article 359 (President's separate order suspends right to enforce FRs except Art. 20 & 21, during ANY National Emergency).

Article 32 (Fundamental Right — SC writ) vs Article 226 (Constitutional, not fundamental, right — HC writ).

QUICK REVISION

Part III, Art. 12–35 — Fundamental Rights.

6 FRs today (originally 7; Property removed by 44th Amdt., 1978 → Art. 300-A).

Equality (14–18), Freedom (19–22), Against Exploitation (23–24), Religion (25–28), Cultural/Educational (29–30), Constitutional Remedies (32).

Art. 21A (Right to Education) added by 86th Amdt., 2002.

Art. 20 & 21 cannot be suspended even during National Emergency.

Borrowed from: Bill of Rights, USA Constitution.

UNIT 6: DIRECTIVE PRINCIPLES OF STATE POLICY (DPSP)

Part IV, Articles 36–51. Non-justiciable but 'fundamental in governance' (Art. 37). Borrowed from the Irish Constitution (which borrowed the idea from Spain).

Important DPSP Articles

Article	Provision
38	State to secure social/economic/political justice
39	Equal pay, distribution of resources for common good
39A	Equal justice & free legal aid (42nd Amdt., 1976)
40	Organisation of Village Panchayats
41	Right to work, education, public assistance
43	Living wage for workers
43A	Workers' participation in management (42nd Amdt., 1976)
43B	Promotion of co-operative societies (97th Amdt., 2011)
44	Uniform Civil Code
45	Early childhood care/education below 6 yrs (amended 86th Amdt., 2002)
46	Promotion of SC/ST/weaker sections' interests
47	Raise nutrition & public health standards
48	Organisation of agriculture & animal husbandry
48A	Protection of environment, forests, wildlife (42nd Amdt., 1976)
49	Protection of monuments & places of national importance
50	Separation of Judiciary from Executive
51	Promotion of international peace & security



MEMORY TRICK

"39A-43A-48A = the 'A-Team' of 1976" — all three 'A' Articles (39A legal aid, 43A workers' participation, 48A environment) were added in ONE STROKE by the 42nd Amendment, 1976.

"44 = Uniform, 40 = Union of villages" — Article 44 (Uniform Civil Code) and Article 40 (Village Panchayats) are both 'Gandhian' DPSPs; both numbers are reverses of each other (44/40) to help you pair them mentally.

Article 50 = 'Fifty-Fifty separation' — separates Judiciary (50%) from Executive (50%) in spirit — easy peg for 'Separation of Judiciary from Executive'.

Key Amendments to DPSP

Amendment	Year	Effect
42nd Amdt.	1976	Added Articles 39A, 43A, 48A
44th Amdt.	1978	Amended Art. 38 language — minimise income inequality
86th Amdt.	2002	Amended Art. 45 — early childhood care below 6 yrs
97th Amdt.	2011	Added Art. 43B — co-operative societies

★ EXAM FOCUS

42nd Amendment (1976) is THE most important DPSP-related amendment — added 39A, 43A, 48A; ALSO added the original 10 Fundamental Duties (Art. 51A) in the same amendment.

Article 44 (UCC) and Article 40 (Village Panchayats) are 'Gandhian principles' within DPSP — categories tested: Gandhian, Liberal-Intellectual, Socialistic.

M.C. Mehta vs Union of India: SC directed environmental education for at least 1 hour/week — links Art. 48A with judicial activism.

DPSPs are non-justiciable, but courts use them with FRs for harmonious interpretation (Minerva Mills case, 1980).

📌 QUICK REVISION

Part IV, Art. 36–51 — DPSP; borrowed from Irish Constitution.

Non-justiciable (Art. 37) but fundamental in governance.

42nd Amdt. (1976): biggest DPSP amendment — added 39A, 43A, 48A.

97th Amdt. (2011): added Art. 43B (co-operatives).

Art. 44: UCC (still not uniformly implemented as of 2026, except Uttarakhand's state-level UCC, 2024).

Art. 50: separation of judiciary from executive.

UNIT 7: FUNDAMENTAL DUTIES

Part IVA, Article 51A. NOT part of the original Constitution — added later, inspired by the erstwhile USSR Constitution.

Key Facts

Fact	Detail
Added by	42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976
Recommending body	Swaran Singh Committee (1976)
Originally recommended	8 duties
Actually added (1976)	10 Fundamental Duties (Art. 51A, clauses a–j)
11th Duty added by	86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002
Total today	11
Borrowed from	USSR (Soviet Union) Constitution
Applicability	Only on citizens (not foreigners)
Enforceability	Non-justiciable
Propagation Committee	Justice J. S. Verma Committee, 1999

MEMORY TRICK

"8 Suggested, 10 Added, 11 Today" — the numeric trap: Swaran Singh suggested 8, government added 10 (1976), 86th Amdt. made it 11 (2002).

"Same Amendment, Double Gift": the 86th Amendment, 2002 gave BOTH Article 21A (a Fundamental Right) AND the 11th Fundamental Duty (parents' duty to educate children 6–14) — a 2-for-1 exam favourite.

The 11 Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — Quick Reference

- (a) Abide by the Constitution; respect Flag & National Anthem.
- (b) Cherish ideals of the freedom struggle.
- (c) Uphold sovereignty, unity, integrity of India.
- (d) Defend the country; render national service when called.
- (e) Promote harmony; renounce practices derogatory to women's dignity.
- (f) Preserve India's composite cultural heritage.
- (g) Protect environment, forests, wildlife; compassion for living creatures.
- (h) Develop scientific temper, humanism, spirit of inquiry.
- (i) Safeguard public property; abjure violence.

- (j) Strive for excellence in all spheres.
- (k) [86th Amdt., 2002] Parents/guardians must educate children aged 6–14.



MEMORY TRICK

"A-CUD HePIS-E" first-letter mnemonic (loose): Abide, Cherish, Uphold, Defend, Harmony, Preserve, Protect-environment, Inquiry/scientific temper, Safeguard-property, Excellence, +(k) educate — group them as 'duties to Nation (a-d), to Society (e-f), to Environment/Science (g-h), to Property/Excellence (i-j), to Children (k)'.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Swaran Singh Committee (1976) recommended 8 Fundamental Duties; government added 10 — frequently tested numeric trap.

11th Duty (educate children 6–14) added by 86th Amendment, 2002 — SAME amendment that added Art. 21A.

Verma Committee (1999): on operationalisation of Fundamental Duties.

Fundamental Duties apply ONLY to citizens, unlike some FRs (e.g. Art. 14, 21) that apply to all persons including foreigners.



QUICK REVISION

Part IVA, Art. 51A — Fundamental Duties; added by 42nd Amdt., 1976.

Inspired by USSR Constitution.

Swaran Singh Committee recommended 8; government added 10 originally.

11th duty (education for children 6–14) added by 86th Amdt., 2002.

Apply only to citizens; non-justiciable.

Verma Committee, 1999: propagation/operationalisation of Fundamental Duties.

UNIT 8: EMERGENCY PROVISIONS

Part XVIII, Articles 352–360 — borrowed largely from the Weimar Constitution of Germany. Converts the federal structure into a unitary one during a crisis.

Three Types of Emergency — "N-P-F" Trick

National → **President's Rule** → **Financial** — remember the order N-P-F = 'Now Parliament Faces it'.

Type	Article	Proclaimed By	Parliamentary Approval
National Emergency	352	President (Cabinet's written recommendation)	Within 1 month, special majority, both Houses
President's Rule	356	President (Governor's report or otherwise)	Within 2 months, simple majority, both Houses
Financial Emergency	360	President	Within 2 months, simple majority, both Houses
Type	When Invoked	Max. Duration	
National Emergency	War, External Aggression, Armed Rebellion (was 'internal disturbance' till 44th Amdt., 1978)	6 months at a time; indefinite with repeated approval	
President's Rule	Failure of constitutional machinery in a State	6 months at a time; max 3 years (with conditions, post-44th Amdt.)	
Financial Emergency	Threat to financial stability/credit of India	No maximum limit prescribed	

Effects

- National Emergency: Centre becomes all-powerful; Art. 19 automatically suspended; Centre-State relations turn unitary.
- President's Rule: State government dismissed/suspended; Governor administers for President; Assembly may dissolve or stay suspended.

- Financial Emergency: Centre can direct States on finances; salaries of govt employees/judges can be reduced.



MEMORY TRICK

"6-6-No Limit" — National Emergency: 6 months/time, President's Rule: 6 months/time (max 3 yrs), Financial Emergency: NO limit at all.

"1 month vs 2 months" — National Emergency needs FASTEST approval (1 month, special majority — most serious); the other two get 2 months, simple majority.

National Emergency — History

Proclaimed 3 times — trick: "6-2, 7-1, 7-5" (1962, 1971, 1975):

- 1962 — Sino-Indian War (external aggression).
- 1971 — Indo-Pak War (external aggression); 2nd proclamation.
- 1975 — 'internal disturbance' (the controversial Emergency, PM Indira Gandhi, 1975–77); 3rd proclamation.
- 44th Amendment, 1978 replaced 'internal disturbance' with 'armed rebellion' to prevent misuse.

Effect of National Emergency on Fundamental Rights

- Article 358: Automatically suspends Art. 19 freedoms when emergency is on war/external aggression grounds (NOT armed rebellion, post-44th Amdt.); restored automatically.
- Article 359: President can suspend right to move courts for FR enforcement (except Art. 20 & 21) via separate order, in ANY National Emergency.
- Articles 20 & 21 can NEVER be suspended — safeguard added by 44th Amendment, 1978.

★ EXAM FOCUS

44th Amendment, 1978 changed 'internal disturbance' to 'armed rebellion' under Art. 352 — frequently asked.

Articles 20 & 21 cannot be suspended during ANY emergency.

President's Rule (Art. 356) restricted by SC in S.R. Bommai vs Union of India (1994) — made subject to judicial review.

Financial Emergency (Art. 360) NEVER proclaimed in India to date (as of June 2026).

National Emergency proclaimed 3 times: 1962, 1971, 1975.



FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Article 358 (Art. 19 suspended AUTOMATICALLY, only for war/external aggression) vs Article 359 (right to move courts suspended by SEPARATE PRESIDENTIAL ORDER, except Art. 20/21, applies to ANY National Emergency).

National Emergency (Art. 352, Centre-State turn unitary) vs President's Rule (Art. 356, only a particular State affected) vs Financial Emergency (Art. 360, never used).



QUICK REVISION

Part XVIII, Art. 352–360 — Emergency Provisions; borrowed from Weimar Constitution (Germany).
 National Emergency (352): war/external aggression/armed rebellion; proclaimed 3 times (1962, 1971, 1975).
 President's Rule (356): failure of State machinery; judicial review post Bommai (1994).
 Financial Emergency (360): never proclaimed so far.
 44th Amdt. (1978): 'internal disturbance' → 'armed rebellion'; protected Art. 20 & 21 from suspension.

UNIT 9: CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENT PROCESS & KEY AMENDMENTS

9.1 Amendment Procedure (Article 368, Part XX)

- Bill can be introduced in EITHER House (not by a State Legislature).
- Introduced by a Minister OR private member — NO prior Presidential recommendation needed.
- Must pass EACH House separately by Special Majority: majority of total membership AND 2/3rd of members present & voting.
- NO Joint Sitting provision for disagreement on a Constitutional Amendment Bill.
- Some amendments (federal structure: President's election, Centre-State relations, legislative powers distribution, States' representation, Art. 368 itself) ALSO need ratification by $\geq 1/2$ of State Legislatures (simple majority).
- After passage, President MUST give assent — mandatory since 24th Amendment, 1971.

Three Categories of Amendment — "S-Sp-SpR" Trick

Category	Majority Required
By simple majority (NOT under Art. 368)	Ordinary legislation — new States (Art. 4), Legislative Councils
By special majority (Art. 368)	Most parts — e.g. Fundamental Rights, DPSP
Special majority + ratification by 1/2 States	Federal provisions — President's election, legislative power distribution, States' representation, Art. 368 itself, 7th Schedule



MEMORY TRICK

"Simple-Special-Special+States" — think of it as 3 levels of difficulty: Easy (simple majority), Medium (special majority), Hard (special majority + half the States must agree).
 Article 368 is a 'synthesis of rigidity and flexibility' — unlike rigid USA or flexible UK Constitution, India takes the middle path.

★ EXAM FOCUS

President has ZERO discretion on a Constitutional Amendment Bill — must assent (settled by 24th Amdt., 1971, after the Golaknath case controversy).

Basic Structure Doctrine: Kesavananda Bharati vs State of Kerala (1973) — Parliament can amend ANY part under Art. 368 but cannot alter the 'basic structure' (supremacy of Constitution, federalism, secularism, judicial review, separation of powers).

9.2 Landmark Constitutional Amendments — Master Table

Amdt.	Year	Key Provision
1st	1951	Added Ninth Schedule; restrictions on free speech (Art. 19)
7th	1956	States reorganised on linguistic basis; 1 Governor for 2+ States
24th	1971	Parliament can amend any part incl. FRs; Presidential assent to amendment bills made mandatory
25th	1971	Curtailed Right to Property; added Art. 31C
26th	1971	Abolished Privy Purses of former princely rulers
39th	1975	PM/Speaker election disputes placed beyond judicial review (partly struck down later)
42nd	1976	'Mini-Constitution' — added Socialist/Secular/Integrity to Preamble; Fundamental Duties; DPSP additions; curtailed judicial review
44th	1978	Reversed 42nd Amdt. excesses; removed Right to Property (→ Art. 300-A); 'internal disturbance' → 'armed rebellion'; protected Art. 20 & 21
52nd	1985	Anti-Defection Law — Tenth Schedule
61st	1989	Voting age 21 → 18 (Art. 326)
73rd	1992	Constitutional status to Panchayati Raj; Part IX + Eleventh Schedule
74th	1992	Constitutional status to Urban Local Bodies; Part IXA + Twelfth Schedule
86th	2002	Added Art. 21A (Right to Education); 11th Fundamental Duty; amended Art. 45
91st	2003	CoM capped at 15% of House strength; tightened anti-defection
97th	2011	Added Art. 43B (co-operatives); Part IXB
101st	2016	Introduced GST
103rd	2019	10% EWS reservation in education & public employment
104th	2019	Extended SC/ST reservation by 10 yrs; abolished Anglo-Indian seats



MEMORY TRICK

"24-25-26 = Triple Punch of 1971" — three back-to-back amendments in 1971: 24th (Parliament's amending power affirmed), 25th (Property curtailed), 26th (Privy Purses abolished).

"42 the Maker, 44 the Undoer" — 42nd Amendment (1976) added many Emergency-era changes; 44th Amendment (1978) reversed most of them post-Emergency. Pair these two numbers together always.

"73-74 Twins" — 73rd = rural (Panchayats), 74th = urban (Municipalities); both passed together in 1992, both add a new Part + a new Schedule.

"91 stops the Defectors, 52 starts the Punishment" — 52nd Amdt (1985) created Anti-Defection Law; 91st Amdt (2003) tightened it further (only whole-party mergers recognised).

Eighth Schedule — Languages (Frequently Tested With Amendments)

Amendment	Year	Languages Added	Running Total
Original Constitution	1950	—	14
21st Amendment	1967	Sindhi	15
71st Amendment	1992	Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali	18
92nd Amendment	2003	Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali	22

MEMORY TRICK

"14 → 15 → 18 → 22" — sequence trick: 21st Amdt adds 1 (Sindhi) → 71st adds 3 (KMN: Konkani-Manipuri-Nepali) → 92nd adds 4 (BDMS: Bodo-Dogri-Maithili-Santhali). Notice: 1, then 3, then 4 — an increasing pattern!

Trick to remember which Amendment did what: '21 is one (Sindhi=1), 71 is three (KMN=3), 92 is BDMS (4, biggest batch)'.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Eighth Schedule sequence: 21st Amdt (Sindhi, 1967) → 71st Amdt (Konkani, Manipuri, Nepali, 1992) → 92nd Amdt (Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, Santhali, 2003). Total now 22 languages. 42nd Amendment (1976) called the 'Mini-Constitution' — single most important amendment for RO/ARO.

73rd & 74th Amendments (1992) in force from 24 April 1993 and 1 June 1993 respectively.

QUICK REVISION

Art. 368 (Part XX): Amendment procedure; either House; special majority (some need State ratification).

President has NO veto on amendment bills (mandatory since 24th Amdt., 1971).

Basic Structure Doctrine: Kesavananda Bharati case, 1973.

42nd Amdt., 1976: 'Mini-Constitution'. 44th Amdt., 1978: undid Emergency excesses.

52nd Amdt., 1985: Anti-Defection (10th Schedule). 61st Amdt., 1989: voting age 21→18.

73rd & 74th Amdts., 1992: Panchayats & Municipalities given constitutional status.
86th Amdt., 2002: Art. 21A + 11th Fundamental Duty. 101st Amdt., 2016: GST.
103rd Amdt., 2019: 10% EWS. 104th Amdt., 2019: Anglo-Indian seats abolished.
8th Schedule: 14 → 15 (1967, Sindhi) → 18 (1992) → 22 (2003) languages.

UNIT 10: CONSTITUTIONAL & OTHER IMPORTANT BODIES

10.1 Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG)

- Articles 148–151. Known as 'Guardian of the Public Purse'.
- Appointed by President; holds office for 6 years OR till 65 years, whichever is earlier.
- Removed like an SC judge (proved misbehaviour/incapacity, special majority address).
- Submits audit reports to President → placed before Parliament → examined by PAC.

First CAG of independent India: V. Narahari Rao. Dr. Ambedkar called CAG the most important officer under the Constitution.



MEMORY TRICK

"CAG = 6/65, just like ECI & UPSC (Centre)" — most central watchdog bodies share the 6 years OR 65 years rule — group them together to remember faster.

10.2 Attorney General vs Advocate General

Aspect	Attorney General (Centre)	Advocate General (State)
Article	76	165
Appointed by	President	Governor
Qualification	Same as SC judge	Same as HC judge
Tenure	Pleasure of President	Pleasure of Governor
Role	Chief law officer, Union	Chief law officer, State
Legislature rights	Speaks in Parliament, no vote	Speaks in State Legislature, no vote

10.3 Election Commission of India (ECI)

- Articles 324–329 (Part XV). Established 25 January 1950 — celebrated as National Voters' Day.
- Originally single-member; multi-member (1 CEC + 2 ECs) since 16 October 1989.
- Appointment by President; under the CEC Act, 2023, on recommendation of a Selection Committee: PM + a Union Cabinet Minister + Leader of Opposition in LS.
- Tenure: 6 years or 65 years, whichever earlier.
- CEC removed like an SC judge; other ECs removed only on CEC's recommendation.
- Voting age reduced 21→18 by 61st Amendment, 1989.

As of June 2026, the Chief Election Commissioner of India is Shri Gyanesh Kumar.



MEMORY TRICK

"1950 born, 1989 grown" — ECI born as single-member body in 1950; 'grew up' into a 3-member body only in 1989.

"61 = 18" peg — 61st Amendment, 1989 = voting age 18. (6+1=7... ignore math, just remember '61st sounds like '61-teen', i.e., voting age becomes a teen number, 18').

★ EXAM FOCUS

ECI established 25 January 1950 (also National Voters' Day since 2011).

ECI became 3-member only from 16 October 1989.

CEC Appointment Act, 2023 changed selection committee composition (PM + Union Minister + LoP in LS), replacing the system where CJI was part of the panel.

61st Amendment (1989): voting age 21→18 — don't confuse with 42nd or 44th Amendment.

10.4 UPSC & State PSCs

- Articles 315–323 (Part XIV). UPSC Chairman/Members appointed by President; State PSC by Governor.
- UPSC conducts All India Services + Central Civil Services exams; advises on recruitment/promotion/discipline.
- Tenure: UPSC — 6 yrs or 65 yrs; State PSC — 6 yrs or 62 yrs, whichever earlier.
- Removal: by President, on misbehaviour, after SC inquiry under Article 317.

10.5 Finance Commission

- Article 280: quasi-judicial body, constituted by President every 5 years (or earlier).
- Recommends distribution of tax proceeds between Centre & States, and grants-in-aid principles.
- 1st Finance Commission: 1951, chaired by K. C. Neogy.

16th Finance Commission (2026–31) chaired by Dr. Arvind Panagariya — important current-affairs fact for 2026 exams.

10.6 NITI Aayog vs Planning Commission

Aspect	Planning Commission	NITI Aayog
Established	15 March 1950	1 January 2015
Nature	Non-constitutional, non-statutory	Non-constitutional, non-statutory
Chairperson	Prime Minister	Prime Minister
Role	Centralised 5-Year Plans; allocated funds	Think tank; policy advisory; NO fund allocation power
Key documents	Five-Year Plans	3-yr Action Agenda, 7-yr Strategy, 15-yr Vision

- National Development Council (NDC): est. 6 Aug 1952; non-constitutional, non-statutory, PM-chaired; used to approve Five-Year Plans.

MEMORY TRICK

"Plans vs Think Tank" — Planning Commission MADE plans and gave MONEY; NITI Aayog only THINKS and ADVISES — no money power at all.

Both bodies are 'extra-constitutional' — neither is mentioned in the Constitution nor created by a Parliament Act; both came from a Cabinet resolution.

10.7 Lokpal and Lokayukta

- 'Lokpal' first mentioned in Parliament in 1963 by MP Laxmi Mall Singhvi.
- First Lokpal Bill introduced in 1968; lapsed multiple times over decades.
- Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013: provides Lokpal (Centre) + Lokayukta (each State).
- Lokpal is a STATUTORY body, NOT constitutional — created by an Act of Parliament.
- Composition: Chairperson + max. 8 members (judicial + non-judicial).

★ EXAM FOCUS

Lokpal/Lokayukta is STATUTORY, not constitutional — commonly confused with CAG/UPSC/ECI which ARE constitutional.

16th Finance Commission (Arvind Panagariya) covers 2026–31 — important current affairs.
Planning Commission (1950) replaced by NITI Aayog (2015) — both extra-constitutional/non-statutory.

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Constitutional Body (created BY the Constitution, e.g. ECI, UPSC, CAG, Finance Commission) vs Statutory Body (created by an ACT of Parliament, e.g. Lokpal, NHRC, CIC) vs Non-Constitutional/Non-Statutory Body (created by Cabinet resolution/executive order, e.g. NITI Aayog, NDC, erstwhile Planning Commission).

📝 QUICK REVISION

CAG: Art. 148–151; 6 yrs/65 yrs; removed like an SC judge; first CAG — V. Narahari Rao. Attorney General (Art. 76, Centre) vs Advocate General (Art. 165, State).

ECI: Art. 324–329; est. 25 Jan 1950; multi-member since 1989; CEC Act 2023 changed selection panel.

61st Amdt. (1989): voting age 21→18. UPSC/SPSC: Art. 315–323 (Part XIV).

Finance Commission: Art. 280; every 5 yrs; 1st FC — 1951, K.C. Neogy; 16th FC (2026–31) — Panagariya.

Planning Commission (1950) replaced by NITI Aayog (2015) — both non-constitutional.

Lokpal & Lokayuktas Act, 2013 — statutory body.

UNIT 11: LOCAL SELF-GOVERNMENT (PANCHAYATI RAJ & MUNICIPALITIES)

11.1 Historical Background

- Lord Ripon (1882) — 'Father of Local Self-Government in India'.
- GoI Act, 1935: made local self-government a purely State (Provincial) subject.
- Community Development Programme launched 2 October 1952.
- Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957) — architect of modern Panchayati Raj; recommended 3-tier system: Gram Panchayat → Panchayat Samiti → Zila Parishad.
- Panchayati Raj first inaugurated 2 October 1959 at Bagdari, Nagaur, Rajasthan, by PM Nehru — Rajasthan = first State to implement it.

Panchayati Raj Committees — Quick Reference

Committee	Year	Key Recommendation
Balwant Rai Mehta	1957	3-tier system: Gram Panchayat, Panchayat Samiti, Zila Parishad
Ashok Mehta	1977–78	2-tier: Zila Parishad + Mandal Panchayat; district as basic unit
G.V.K. Rao	1985	Revived PRIs as the 'core' of development administration
L.M. Singhvi	1986	First recommended CONSTITUTIONAL status for PRIs; importance of Gram Sabha
P.K. Thungon	1988	Regular elections; State Finance Commission for Panchayats
C.H. Hanumantha Rao	1983	District planning bodies; rural development administration



MEMORY TRICK

"BAG-LPH" order trick — Balwant Rai Mehta (1957) → Ashok Mehta (1977-78) → G.V.K. Rao (1985) → L.M. Singhvi (1986) → P.K. Thungon (1988) — chronological order of Panchayati Raj committees.

"Singhvi Suggested, 73rd Sealed it" — L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986) FIRST suggested constitutional status for Panchayats; it was finally SEALED/implemented by the 73rd Amendment in 1992 (a 6-year gap).

11.2 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 (Panchayati Raj)

- Added Part IX (Art. 243 to 243-O) + Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects).
- In force from 24 April 1993 — National Panchayati Raj Day.
- Uniform 3-tier structure: Gram Panchayat → Intermediate/Block → Zila Parishad (States <20 lakh population may skip intermediate level).

- Gram Sabha: body of all registered voters in a Panchayat area — made a constitutional entity for the first time.
- Reservation: SC/ST proportional; $\geq 1/3$ rd seats for women at all 3 levels.
- Tenure: 5 years; fresh elections within 6 months if dissolved early.
- State Election Commission (Art. 243K) conducts Panchayat/Municipal elections — separate from ECI (Art. 324).
- State Finance Commission: constituted every 5 years by Governor.
- PESA Act, 1996: extends Part IX to Scheduled Areas (tribal); based on Bhuria Committee; covers 10 States (AP, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, HP, Jharkhand, MP, Maharashtra, Odisha, Rajasthan, Telangana).

11.3 74th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 (Municipalities)

- Added Part IXA (Art. 243P to 243ZG) + Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects).
- In force from 1 June 1993.
- 3 types of Urban Local Bodies: Nagar Panchayat (transitional) → Municipal Council (smaller urban) → Municipal Corporation (larger urban).
- Same reservation, tenure, State Election Commission, State Finance Commission provisions as 73rd Amendment.



MEMORY TRICK

"9 for Rural, 9A for Urban" — Part IX = Panchayats (rural), Part IXA = Municipalities (urban); 11th Schedule = 29 subjects (Panchayats), 12th Schedule = 18 subjects (Municipalities). Trick: 'Eleven for Earth (village), Twelve for Town'.

"24 April Rural, 1 June Urban" — 73rd Amendment force date (24 April 1993) vs 74th Amendment force date (1 June 1993).

★ EXAM FOCUS

73rd Amendment: Part IX (Art. 243–243O) + 11th Schedule (29 subjects); in force 24 April 1993.

Minimum $1/3$ rd reservation for women in Panchayats at all 3 tiers (some States raised it to 50%).

PESA Act, 1996 covers 10 States; based on Bhuria Committee recommendations.

State Election Commission (Art. 243K) — distinct from Election Commission of India (Art. 324).

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

State Election Commission (Art. 243K/243ZA — conducts Panchayat/Municipal elections) vs Election Commission of India (Art. 324 — conducts Parliament/Assembly/President/VP elections).

Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (3-tier system) vs Ashok Mehta Committee (2-tier system) — frequently swapped in MCQs.



QUICK REVISION

Lord Ripon (1882): pioneer of local self-government.

Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957): 3-tier Panchayati Raj; first implemented in Nagaur, Rajasthan (2 Oct 1959).

Ashok Mehta Committee (1977–78): 2-tier; district as basic unit.

L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986): first proposed constitutional status — implemented via 73rd Amdt.

73rd Amdt. (1992): Part IX, Art. 243–243O, 11th Schedule (29 subjects); force 24 April 1993.

74th Amdt. (1992): Part IXA, Art. 243P–243ZG, 12th Schedule (18 subjects); force 1 June 1993.

Both: min. 1/3rd women's reservation; 5-yr tenure; State Election Commission & State Finance Commission.

PESA Act, 1996: extends PRI to Scheduled Areas; Bhuria Committee; covers 10 States.

UNIT 12: NATURE OF THE CONSTITUTION & FEDERALISM

12.1 Rigid vs Flexible Constitution

- Indian Constitution = 'synthesis of rigidity and flexibility' — Art. 368 itself permits 3 different amendment procedures.
- USA Constitution = rigid; UK Constitution = flexible; India = middle path.

12.2 Sharing/Distribution of Power — Concepts

Concept	Meaning
Separation of Powers	Power shared among Legislature, Executive, Judiciary
Federalism	Power shared among Centre & States
Pluralism	Power shared among social groups (linguistic, religious, ethnic)
Coalition Government	Power shared among 2+ political parties governing together



MEMORY TRICK

"F-S-P-C" — Federalism (levels of govt), Separation (organs of govt), Pluralism (social groups), Coalition (parties) — four different ways power can be SHARED; don't mix them up.

12.3 Dyarchy / Dyarchy (Historical Background)

- Dyarchy ('Dwishasan'): authority divided between two sets of rulers — one responsible to legislature, one not.
- Introduced by GoI Act, 1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms).
- Reserved subjects: administered by Governor's executive council, NOT responsible to legislature.
- Transferred subjects: administered by ministers responsible to elected legislature.
- Lionel Curtis: architect/originator of the idea of dyarchy.
- Abolished by GoI Act, 1935, replaced by provincial autonomy.

MEMORY TRICK

"1919 Divides, 1935 Decides" — Gol Act 1919 DIVIDED power (Dyarchy: Reserved vs Transferred); Gol Act 1935 DECIDED to end it (Provincial Autonomy).

"R for Restricted, T for Trusted" — Reserved subjects = Restricted to Governor (no legislature control); Transferred subjects = Trusted to elected ministers.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Gol Act, 1919 introduced Dyarchy; Gol Act, 1935 abolished it + introduced provincial autonomy + an All-India Federation (never came into force).

Gol Act, 1935 is the single most important pre-independence Act — direct structural template for India's Constitution (~75% provisions borrowed/adapted, per Dr. Ambedkar).

12.4 J&K Integration with India

- Instrument of Accession signed 26 October 1947 by Maharaja Hari Singh.
- Article 370 abrogated; reorganised into 2 UTs — J&K (with legislature) and Ladakh (without legislature) — via J&K Reorganisation Act, 2019, effective 31 October 2019.

12.5 Integration of Other Territories

- Goa, Daman & Diu: liberated via 'Operation Vijay' (1961); Goa became a full State in 1987; Daman & Diu later merged with Dadra & Nagar Haveli (2020).
- Puducherry: French colony merged 1954; became UT via 14th Amendment, 1962.
- Sikkim: became 22nd State via 36th Amendment, 1975 (after referendum).

MEMORY TRICK

"V for Vijay, V for Victory" — Operation Vijay (1961) freed Goa from Portuguese rule.

"14 for French, 36 for Sikkim" — 14th Amendment (1962) made Puducherry a UT; 36th Amendment (1975) made Sikkim the 22nd State.

QUICK REVISION

Indian Constitution: synthesis of rigid & flexible amendment procedures (Art. 368).

Dyarchy: introduced by Gol Act, 1919; abolished by Gol Act, 1935.

Gol Act, 1935: structural source of India's Constitution.

J&K: Instrument of Accession — 26 Oct 1947; Art. 370 abrogated, 2 UTs — 31 Oct 2019.

Goa: Operation Vijay (1961); State in 1987. Puducherry: UT via 14th Amdt., 1962.

Sikkim: 22nd State via 36th Amdt., 1975.

UNIT 13: NATIONAL SYMBOLS

National Symbol	Detail
National Flag	Tiranga; adopted by Constituent Assembly on 22 July 1947
National Emblem	Lion Capital of Ashoka, Sarnath; adopted 26 January 1950
National Anthem	'Jana Gana Mana' (Tagore); first sung 27 Dec 1911; adopted 24 Jan 1950
National Song	'Vande Mataram' (Bankim Chandra Chatterjee); first sung publicly 1896; equal status, adopted 24 Jan 1950
National Script	Devanagari
National Language	Hindi (Devanagari script) — Article 343
National Motto	'Satyameva Jayate' — from the Mundaka Upanishad
National Calendar	Saka Calendar/Era
National Animal	Royal Bengal Tiger
National Aquatic Animal	Ganges River Dolphin
National Bird	Indian Peacock
National Tree	Banyan Tree
National Fruit	Mango
National Flower	Lotus
National Game	NONE officially notified (Hockey is only a popular convention)
National Currency Symbol	₹ (adopted 2010)

National Flag — Detail

- Adopted 22 July 1947. 3 stripes: Saffron (courage), White (truth/peace), Green (prosperity/fertility).
- Navy-blue Ashoka Chakra (24 spokes) in white centre stripe — wheel of law/dharma.
- Flag Code of India came into effect 26 January 2002.

National Anthem — Detail

- Written in Bengali by Tagore; full version 5 stanzas, only first stanza adopted as Anthem.
- First published Jan 1912 in Tatvabodhini Patrika as 'Bharoto Bhagyo Bidhata'.
- First publicly sung 27 Dec 1911 at Calcutta session of INC.
- Formally adopted by Constituent Assembly 24 January 1950.
- Standard playing time: ~52 seconds (full); short version (first & last lines) ~20 seconds.

MEMORY TRICK

"22-24-26" date trick — Flag: 22 July 1947. Anthem & Song: 24 January 1950. Emblem: 26 January 1950. Notice the pattern of increasing even numbers (22→24→26)!

"Same Day, Equal Status" — National Anthem AND National Song were BOTH adopted on 24 January 1950, with equal status — a frequent trap question.

Upanishad peg: 'Satyameva Jayate' → Mundaka Upanishad — remember 'Mundaka = Mouth that speaks Truth'.

★ **EXAM FOCUS**

National Anthem & National Song BOTH adopted 24 January 1950 — equal status.

'Satyameva Jayate' is from the Mundaka Upanishad — frequently tested source-text question.

National Flag adopted 22 July 1947 (BEFORE independence) — distinct from Anthem/Emblem (24/26 Jan 1950).

There is officially NO notified National Game — a classic 'trick' MCQ; many wrongly assume Hockey.

QUICK REVISION

Flag: 22 July 1947; Saffron-White-Green + Ashoka Chakra (24 spokes).

National Anthem & Song: both adopted 24 January 1950, equal status.

National Emblem: 26 January 1950; from Ashoka's Lion Capital, Sarnath.

Motto 'Satyameva Jayate': from the Mundaka Upanishad.

National Script: Devanagari; National Language: Hindi (Art. 343).

No official National Game (Hockey is only a popular/conventional choice).

UNIT 14: POLITICAL PARTIES & MISCELLANEOUS FACTS

14.1 Major National Political Parties — Year of Formation

Party	Year	Founder(s)
Indian National Congress (INC)	1885	Allan Octavian Hume
Communist Party of India (CPI)	1925	M.N. Roy and others
Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJP's predecessor)	1951	Syama Prasad Mookerjee
Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)	1980	Atal Bihari Vajpayee, L.K. Advani, others
Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)	1984	Kanshi Ram
Nationalist Congress Party (NCP)	1999	Sharad Pawar, P.A. Sangma, Tariq Anwar

Note: always verify each party's founding year independently — coaching materials sometimes print errors in match-the-following questions.



MEMORY TRICK

"85-25-51-80-84-99" — chronological peg for INC(1885), CPI(1925), Jana Sangh(1951), BJP(1980), BSP(1984), NCP(1999). Read the last 2 digits as a rising staircase: 85, 25(wraps as 1925), 51, 80, 84, 99.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Political parties registered/recognised by ECI under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968 — NOT directly under the Constitution.

'Political Party' is not separately defined in the original Constitution; recognition flows from the Representation of the People Act, 1951 & ECI orders.

Anti-Defection Law (10th Schedule, 52nd Amdt., 1985) governs MP/MLA disqualification for defection.

14.2 Important Acts & Legal Provisions

- Citizenship Act, 1955: enacted under Article 11 (Parliament's power to regulate citizenship); Articles 5–11 (Part II) deal with citizenship in the Constitution.
- Sedition (Section 124A IPC, now under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023): 'bringing/attempting to bring hatred or contempt towards the Government'; punishable up to life imprisonment, or up to 3 yrs + fine.
- Right to vote/be elected: held by SC to be a Constitutional/Statutory right (Art. 326 + RP Act), NOT a pure Fundamental Right.

14.3 Other Frequently Asked Miscellaneous Facts

- Citizenship: Parliament's power under Article 11; Citizenship Act passed in 1955.
- Contingency Fund of India: Article 267; at President's disposal; for unforeseen expenditure pending Parliamentary authorisation.

- All India Services: created under Article 312, via RS resolution (2/3rd majority) — IAS, IPS, IFoS.
- Separation of Judiciary from Executive: DPSP under Article 50.
- Article 244: administration of Scheduled Areas/Tribes. Fifth Schedule = general Scheduled Areas/Tribes administration. Sixth Schedule = special tribal-area governance (Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram) via Autonomous District Councils.

MEMORY TRICK

"267 = Contingency, easy to remember as '2-6-7 → too-sick-seven' i.e. for emergencies/unforeseen expenses."

"5th = General, 6th = Special (AMTM States)" — peg AMTM = Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram for the Sixth Schedule.

★ **EXAM FOCUS**

Fifth Schedule (general Scheduled Areas/Tribes) vs Sixth Schedule (special tribal governance in AMTM states via Autonomous District Councils) — frequently confused pair. Article 267 = Contingency Fund of India, at President's disposal — recurring 1-mark question.

Article 312 lets Rajya Sabha (special resolution) authorise new All India Services — a power Lok Sabha does NOT have.

QUICK REVISION

INC — 1885 (Hume); CPI — 1925; Jana Sangh — 1951; BJP — 1980; BSP — 1984 (Kanshi Ram); NCP — 1999.

Citizenship Act — 1955, under Article 11.

Sedition: Section 124A IPC (now BNS, 2023).

Contingency Fund of India — Article 267, at President's disposal.

All India Services created via Article 312 (Rajya Sabha's special power).

5th Schedule: general Scheduled Areas/Tribes; 6th Schedule: Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram tribal areas.

UNIT 15: MASTER QUICK-REFERENCE TABLES

15.1 Constitutional Posts & Their Governing Articles

Post / Authority	Article
President of India	52
Vice-President of India	63
Prime Minister	75
Council of Ministers (Union)	75
Attorney General of India	76
State Governor	153

Post / Authority	Article
Chief Minister & State CoM	163–164
Advocate General of a State	165
CJI & Supreme Court Judges	124
High Court Judges	217
CAG	148
CEC & Election Commissioners	324
Finance Commission	280
UPSC Chairman & Members	316

15.2 Resignation Chart — 'Who Resigns To Whom'

Post	Resigns To
President	Vice-President
Vice-President	President
Prime Minister	President
Minister (individual)	President (through PM)
Lok Sabha Speaker	Deputy Speaker
Lok Sabha Deputy Speaker	Speaker
Member of Lok Sabha	Speaker
Member of Rajya Sabha	Chairman (Vice-President)
State Governor	President
Chief Minister	Governor
State Minister	Governor (through CM)
State Assembly Speaker	Deputy Speaker
State Assembly Deputy Speaker	Speaker
MLA	Speaker
MLC	Chairman of Legislative Council



MEMORY TRICK

Spot the SYMMETRY: President ↔ Vice-President (resign to EACH OTHER); Speaker ↔ Deputy Speaker (resign to EACH OTHER) — at BOTH Union and State levels. Once you see the pattern, you never forget it.

15.3 Minimum Age Requirements — Master Table

Post	Minimum Age
President	35 years
Vice-President	35 years
Governor	35 years
Lok Sabha Member (MP)	25 years
Rajya Sabha Member (MP)	30 years
Legislative Assembly Member (MLA)	25 years
Legislative Council Member (MLC)	30 years
Panchayat / Municipality Member	21 years
Voter (Right to Vote)	18 years



MEMORY TRICK

"35-35-35 (Top 3); 25-30 (Houses); 21 (local); 18 (voter)" — Top constitutional posts (President/VP/Governor) all need 35. Lower House (LS/Assembly) needs 25, Upper House (RS/Council) needs 30. Easy rule: Upper House age = Lower House age + 5.

15.4 Important Schedules of the Constitution

Schedule	Subject
First	Names of States & UTs, territorial extent
Second	Salaries/allowances of President, Governors, Speaker, Judges, CAG, etc.
Third	Forms of Oaths and Affirmations
Fourth	Allocation of RS seats to States/UTs
Fifth	Administration of Scheduled Areas & Scheduled Tribes
Sixth	Administration of Tribal Areas in Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram
Seventh	Union, State, Concurrent Lists (distribution of powers)
Eighth	Official/recognised languages (currently 22)
Ninth	Acts protected from judicial review (1st Amdt., 1951)
Tenth	Anti-Defection Law (52nd Amdt., 1985)
Eleventh	29 subjects for Panchayats (73rd Amdt., 1992)
Twelfth	18 subjects for Municipalities (74th Amdt., 1992)

MEMORY TRICK

"Original 8, then 9-10-11-12 added later" — Constitution originally had 8 Schedules; 9th (1951, judicial-review shield), 10th (1985, anti-defection), 11th & 12th (1992, local bodies) came via amendments — in that exact chronological order.

"TEN = Ten-dency to defect" — Tenth Schedule = Anti-Defection Law (NOT Scheduled Areas, which is the Fifth Schedule) — a very common RO/ARO trap.

PREVIOUS YEAR FOCUS

I.R. Coelho case (2007): laws placed in the Ninth Schedule AFTER 24 April 1973 (Kesavananda Bharati judgment date) are subject to judicial review if they violate the basic structure.

15.5 Important Parts of the Constitution

Part	Subject
Part I	The Union and its Territory (Art. 1–4)
Part II	Citizenship (Art. 5–11)
Part III	Fundamental Rights (Art. 12–35)
Part IV	Directive Principles of State Policy (Art. 36–51)
Part IVA	Fundamental Duties (Art. 51A)
Part V	The Union (Art. 52–151) — Executive, Parliament, Judiciary, CAG
Part VI	The States (Art. 152–237) — Executive, Legislature, High Courts
Part IX	The Panchayats (Art. 243–243O)
Part IXA	The Municipalities (Art. 243P–243ZG)
Part XIV	Services Under the Union & States (Art. 308–323)
Part XV	Elections (Art. 324–329)
Part XVIII	Emergency Provisions (Art. 352–360)
Part XX	Amendment of the Constitution (Art. 368)

15.6 Articles — The Most-Tested Numbers (Quick Peg List)

Article	One-line Peg
Art. 1	India = 'Bharat', a Union of States
Art. 14	Equality before law (Right to Equality starts here)

Article	One-line Peg
Art. 19	Six Freedoms (speech, assembly, association, movement, residence, profession)
Art. 21	Right to Life & Personal Liberty (most-expanded Article)
Art. 21A	Right to Education (6–14 yrs)
Art. 32	Right to Constitutional Remedies (FR; SC writ)
Art. 44	Uniform Civil Code (DPSP)
Art. 51A	Fundamental Duties
Art. 72	President's pardoning power
Art. 76	Attorney General
Art. 110	Money Bill
Art. 123	President's Ordinance-making power
Art. 124	Supreme Court — establishment
Art. 143	SC's advisory jurisdiction
Art. 161	Governor's pardoning power
Art. 164	CM & State CoM
Art. 226	High Court writ jurisdiction
Art. 280	Finance Commission
Art. 312	All India Services
Art. 324	Election Commission
Art. 352	National Emergency
Art. 356	President's Rule
Art. 360	Financial Emergency
Art. 368	Amendment procedure

UNIT 16: WRITS UNDER THE CONSTITUTION

Writs are court orders that protect citizens' rights. Issued by SC (Art. 32) and HC (Art. 226).
Memorise using 'HCQMP' = Habeas Corpus, Certiorari, Quo-Warranto, Mandamus, Prohibition.

Writ	Meaning / Use	Memory Peg
Habeas Corpus	'You may have the body' — produce a detained person before court to check legality of detention	HABEAS = 'have his body' brought to court
Mandamus	'We command' — directs a public official/body to perform a duty it is failing to perform	MAN-damus = a MAN(date) to act
Prohibition	Issued by a higher court to a lower court/tribunal to STOP exceeding its jurisdiction	PRO-hibition = PROhibits further action
Certiorari	'To be certified' — higher court quashes an order of a lower court/tribunal already passed (corrects an error)	CERTAIN-orari = make CERTAIN the order was correct, else quash it
Quo-Warranto	'By what authority' — questions the legality of a person's claim to a public office	QUO = 'who are YOU to hold this post?'

MEMORY TRICK

"H-M-P-C-Q" story: A person is illegally detained — file HABEAS CORPUS. An officer won't do his duty — file MANDAMUS. A tribunal is overstepping — file PROHIBITION (stop it before) or CERTIORARI (cancel it after). Someone is sitting on a public post illegally — file QUO-WARRANTO.

★ EXAM FOCUS

Habeas Corpus can be filed by ANYONE on behalf of the detained person (not just the detainee) — frequently tested.

Quo-Warranto applies ONLY to public offices created by statute/Constitution — NOT to private/ministerial posts.

Prohibition is preventive (before order is passed); Certiorari is curative (after order is passed) — the key distinguishing feature.

UNIT 17: SEVENTH SCHEDULE — UNION, STATE & CONCURRENT LISTS

Article 246 read with the Seventh Schedule divides legislative subjects between Centre and States.

List	Subjects (approx.)	Who Legislates	Examples
Union List	~100 (originally 97)	Only Parliament	Defence, Foreign Affairs, Railways, Currency, Banking, Atomic Energy
State List	~61 (originally 66)	Only State Legislature (normally)	Police, Public Order, Agriculture, Local Government, Public Health
Concurrent List	~52 (originally 47)	Both Parliament & State Legislature	Education, Forests, Criminal Law, Marriage & Divorce, Electricity

- In case of conflict on a Concurrent List subject, the UNION LAW PREVAILS (Art. 254), unless the State law was reserved for Presidential assent and received it.
- Residuary powers (subjects not in any list) belong to PARLIAMENT (Art. 248) — a unitary/centralising feature.
- 42nd Amendment (1976) transferred 5 subjects from State List to Concurrent List, incl. Education and Forests.

MEMORY TRICK

"Union = Country-wide, State = Local, Concurrent = Common" — simplest 3-word peg for the 3 Lists.

"Residue goes to the Centre" — just like leftover cake goes to whoever's hosting (the Centre), residuary power rests with Parliament (Art. 248).

★ EXAM FOCUS

Concurrent List conflict — Union law prevails (Art. 254), unless State law got Presidential assent after being reserved.

Residuary powers with Parliament (Art. 248) — unlike the USA, where residuary powers rest with the States.

42nd Amendment shifted Education & Forests from State to Concurrent List — frequently asked.

DEDICATED SECTION: FREQUENTLY CONFUSED TOPICS

This section collects ALL the commonly confused pairs/groups from across the syllabus in one place for rapid last-week revision.

Confused Articles

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Article 32 (Fundamental Right; SC writ; FR enforcement ONLY) vs Article 226 (Constitutional right, not fundamental; HC writ; FR + 'any other purpose' — wider scope).

Article 358 (automatic suspension of Art. 19 ONLY, war/external aggression grounds) vs Article 359 (President's separate order suspends right to move courts for FR enforcement except Art. 20/21, applies to ANY National Emergency).

Article 108 (Joint Sitting SUMMONED by President) vs Article 118 (Joint Sitting PRESIDED by Speaker).

Article 110 (Money Bill definition) vs Article 117 (Financial Bills, Types I & II).

Article 249 (RS power over State List subject, national interest) vs Article 312 (RS power to create new All India Services).

Article 72 (President's pardoning power — incl. death sentence, Court Martial) vs Article 161 (Governor's pardoning power — NO death sentence/Court Martial power).

Article 124(4) (removal of SC/HC judges) vs Article 61 (impeachment of President) — BOTH need special majority but are different processes for different posts.

Confused Schedules

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Fifth Schedule (general administration of Scheduled Areas/Tribes, most States) vs Sixth Schedule (special arrangements via Autonomous District Councils, ONLY Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram).

Tenth Schedule (Anti-Defection Law) — NOT to be confused with Fifth Schedule (Scheduled Areas) — a very common trap.

Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects, Panchayats/RURAL) vs Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects, Municipalities/URBAN).

Confused Bodies

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Constitutional Body (created by the Constitution itself — ECI, UPSC, CAG, Finance Commission) vs Statutory Body (created by an Act of Parliament — Lokpal, NHRC, CIC, NCSC) vs Extra-Constitutional/Non-Statutory Body (created by Cabinet resolution — NITI Aayog, NDC, erstwhile Planning Commission).

Attorney General (Art. 76, Centre's law officer) vs Solicitor General (NOT a constitutional post; statutory, assists AG) vs Advocate General (Art. 165, State's law officer).

Election Commission of India (Art. 324 — Parliament/Assembly/President/VP elections) vs State Election Commission (Art. 243K/243ZA — Panchayat/Municipality elections).

Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (3-tier PRI system, 1957) vs Ashok Mehta Committee (2-tier system, 1977–78) — commonly swapped.

Confused Amendments

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

42nd Amendment (1976 — 'Mini-Constitution', ADDED many provisions, curtailed rights) vs 44th Amendment (1978 — REVERSED most 42nd Amdt. excesses).

73rd Amendment (1992 — Panchayats/RURAL, Part IX, 11th Schedule) vs 74th Amendment (1992 — Municipalities/URBAN, Part IXA, 12th Schedule).

52nd Amendment (1985 — CREATED Anti-Defection Law) vs 91st Amendment (2003 — TIGHTENED Anti-Defection Law + capped CoM at 15%).

61st Amendment (1989 — voting age 21→18) — commonly confused with 44th or 42nd Amendment in MCQs.

24th Amendment (1971 — affirmed Parliament's amending power, made Presidential assent mandatory) vs 25th Amendment (1971 — curtailed Right to Property, added Art. 31C) vs 26th Amendment (1971 — abolished Privy Purses).

Confused Conventions/Concepts

⚠ FREQUENTLY CONFUSED

Ordinance (Art. 123, President; Art. 213, Governor — promulgated when legislature is NOT in session, force of law, temporary) vs Act (passed by the legislature through the full law-making process, permanent until repealed).

Money Bill (Art. 110 — ONLY taxation/Consolidated Fund matters, LS only, no RS amendment power) vs Finance Bill (Art. 117 — MAY contain other provisions besides Money Bill matters; Type-I needs Presidential nod like a Money Bill, Type-II does not).

Basic Structure Doctrine (Kesavananda Bharati, 1973 — limits on Parliament's amending power) vs Doctrine of Severability/Pith & Substance (different judicial doctrines used in Centre-State legislative disputes).

DEDICATED SECTION: HIGH COURT RO-FOCUSED COMPARISON TABLES

1. Fundamental Rights vs Directive Principles of State Policy

Aspect	Fundamental Rights	DPSP
Part & Articles	Part III, Art. 12–35	Part IV, Art. 36–51
Nature	Justiciable (enforceable in court)	Non-justiciable (not enforceable)
Purpose	Negative — restrain the State	Positive — direct the State towards welfare
Origin	Bill of Rights, USA Constitution	Constitution of Ireland (from Spain)
Example	Right to Equality (Art. 14)	Uniform Civil Code (Art. 44)

2. Fundamental Rights vs Fundamental Duties

Aspect	Fundamental Rights	Fundamental Duties
Part & Article	Part III, Art. 12–35	Part IVA, Art. 51A
Origin in Constitution	Part of original Constitution (1950)	Added later, 42nd Amdt., 1976
Applicability	Citizens & (for some) foreigners	Only citizens
Enforceability	Justiciable	Non-justiciable
Inspired by	USA Constitution	USSR Constitution
Number	6	11

3. Constitutional Body vs Statutory Body

Aspect	Constitutional Body	Statutory Body
Created by	The Constitution itself	An Act of Parliament/State Legislature
Can be abolished by	Only a Constitutional Amendment	A simple repeal Act
Examples	ECI, UPSC, CAG, Finance Commission	Lokpal, NHRC, CIC, NCSC

4. Lok Sabha vs Rajya Sabha

Aspect	Lok Sabha	Rajya Sabha
Nature	Directly elected, Lower House	Indirectly elected, Upper/permanent House
Max./Current Strength	552 / 545	250 / 245
Term	5 years (can dissolve)	Permanent; 6-yr member term
Money Bill	Originates here only	Only 14-day recommend power

5. Supreme Court vs High Court

Aspect	Supreme Court	High Court
Articles	124–147 (Part V)	214–231 (Part VI)
Writ Article	32 (FR enforcement only)	226 (FR + 'any other purpose' — wider)
Retirement Age	65 years	62 years
Original Jurisdiction	Art. 131 (Centre-State/inter-State)	Limited (varies by State)

6. Writs Comparison (Summary)

Writ	Used Against	Purpose
Habeas Corpus	Detaining authority/person	Produce detained person; test legality of detention
Mandamus	Public official/body	Command performance of a public duty
Prohibition	Lower court/tribunal	Stop exceeding jurisdiction (preventive)
Certiorari	Lower court/tribunal	Quash a wrongly-passed order (curative)
Quo-Warranto	Person holding public office	Question legal right to hold that office

7. Money Bill vs Finance Bill

Aspect	Money Bill (Art. 110)	Finance Bill (Art. 117)
Scope	ONLY matters in Art. 110(1) — taxation, Consolidated Fund, borrowing	Money Bill matters PLUS other provisions (Type-I); or just Consolidated Fund expenditure (Type-II)
House	Lok Sabha only	Type-I: LS only; Type-II: either House
Presidential recommendation	Mandatory before introduction	Type-I: mandatory; Type-II: only before consideration

Aspect	Money Bill (Art. 110)	Finance Bill (Art. 117)
RS Power	Can only recommend, max 14 days	Type-I same as Money Bill; Type-II treated as ordinary bill

8. Ordinance vs Act

Aspect	Ordinance	Act
Issued by	President (Art. 123) / Governor (Art. 213)	Passed by Parliament/State Legislature
When	Legislature NOT in session	Through full legislative process
Duration	Max. 6 weeks after legislature reassembles (unless approved/withdrawn earlier)	Permanent, until repealed
Force of law	Same as an Act, but temporary	Permanent

9. Constitutional Amendment Procedures (3 Types)

Type	Majority Needed	Example Subject
Simple majority (not under Art. 368)	Ordinary legislative majority	New States, Legislative Councils
Special majority (Art. 368)	Total membership majority + 2/3rd present & voting, each House	Fundamental Rights, DPSP
Special majority + State ratification	As above + ½ of State Legislatures (simple majority)	President's election, Centre-State relations, Art. 368 itself

10. Union List vs State List vs Concurrent List

Aspect	Union List	State List	Concurrent List
Who legislates	Only Parliament	Only State Legislature	Both
Approx. subjects	~100	~61	~52
Conflict rule	N/A	N/A	Union law prevails (Art. 254)
Example	Defence, Railways	Police, Agriculture	Education, Forests

11. Article 32 vs Article 226

Aspect	Article 32	Article 226
Court	Supreme Court	High Court
Nature of right	Itself a Fundamental Right	A Constitutional (not fundamental) right
Scope	Only for FR enforcement	FR enforcement + 'any other purpose' (wider)
Suspension	Can be suspended (except for Art. 20/21) during Emergency (Art. 359)	Not directly covered by Art. 359 suspension mechanism

12. President vs Governor (Recap)

Aspect	President	Governor
Selection	Indirectly elected	Appointed by President
Pardoning Power	Art. 72 — incl. death sentence, Court Martial	Art. 161 — NO such power
Tenure	Fixed 5 yrs; impeachment only	'Pleasure of President'

MOST IMPORTANT ARTICLES — EXAM-RANKED LIST

These Articles have appeared most frequently in Allahabad HC RO/ARO and similar one-day exams. Revise this list LAST, right before the exam.

Article	Subject	Why It's Important
Art. 14–18	Right to Equality	Base of Fundamental Rights; equality before law
Art. 19	Six Freedoms	Most-tested FR; basis of many SC judgments
Art. 20 & 21	Protection in offences; Life & Liberty	Cannot be suspended even in Emergency
Art. 21A	Right to Education	Added by 86th Amdt., links with 11th Duty
Art. 32	Constitutional Remedies	FR itself; 'heart and soul'
Art. 61	Impeachment of President	Only removal mechanism for President
Art. 72 / 161	Pardoning powers	President vs Governor comparison favourite
Art. 74 / 75	PM & Council of Ministers	Core of Union Executive
Art. 76	Attorney General	Highest law officer
Art. 80 / 81	RS / LS composition	Numbers-based MCQs
Art. 108 / 118	Joint Sitting	Summoned vs Presided distinction
Art. 110 / 117	Money Bill / Financial Bill	Procedure-heavy, frequently asked
Art. 123 / 213	Ordinance power	President vs Governor
Art. 124 / 217	SC / HC judges	Appointment & removal process
Art. 131 / 141 / 143	SC's jurisdiction types	Original / binding / advisory
Art. 153–161	Governor's office	State Executive core
Art. 226	HC writ jurisdiction	Wider than Art. 32
Art. 249 / 312	RS's special powers	LS does NOT have these
Art. 280	Finance Commission	Centre-State fiscal relations
Art. 324–329	Election Commission	Conducts all major elections
Art. 352 / 356 / 360	Three Emergencies	Most consequential provisions
Art. 368	Amendment procedure	How the Constitution changes

MOST IMPORTANT AMENDMENTS — EXAM-RANKED LIST

Rank	Amendment	Reason It's High-Value
1	42nd (1976)	'Mini-Constitution'; Fundamental Duties; DPSP additions; Preamble change
2	44th (1978)	Reversed Emergency excesses; protected Art. 20/21; Right to Property → 300-A
3	73rd & 74th (1992)	Constitutional status to Panchayats & Municipalities
4	24th (1971)	Made Presidential assent to amendment bills mandatory
5	86th (2002)	Art. 21A + 11th Fundamental Duty (combo question)
6	52nd (1985)	Anti-Defection Law (10th Schedule)
7	61st (1989)	Voting age 21 → 18
8	91st (2003)	CoM ≤ 15%; tightened anti-defection
9	101st (2016)	GST introduction
10	104th (2019)	Abolished Anglo-Indian nominated seats

EXPECTED MCQs (PRACTICE SET)

Try to answer before checking — covers the highest-yield topics for Allahabad HC RO/ARO.

Q1. The President of India is elected by an Electoral College consisting of:

(a) All MPs and MLAs (b) Elected MPs and elected MLAs only (c) Elected MPs only (d) Nominated MPs only

Ans: (b) — nominated members do NOT vote in Presidential election.

Q2. Which Article deals with the impeachment of the President?

(a) Art. 56 (b) Art. 60 (c) Art. 61 (d) Art. 72

Ans: (c) Article 61.

Q3. The Vice-President of India is elected by:

(a) Both Houses of Parliament only (b) Parliament + State Assemblies (c) Lok Sabha only (d) Electoral College of States

Ans: (a) — only MPs (elected + nominated) vote; no MLAs.

Q4. A Money Bill can be introduced only in:

(a) Rajya Sabha (b) Either House (c) Lok Sabha (d) Joint Sitting

Ans: (c) Lok Sabha, and only with prior Presidential recommendation.

Q5. The maximum period for which Rajya Sabha can hold a Money Bill is:

(a) 6 months (b) 30 days (c) 14 days (d) No limit

Ans: (c) 14 days.

Q6. Which Schedule deals with the Anti-Defection Law?

(a) Fifth (b) Ninth (c) Tenth (d) Eleventh

Ans: (c) Tenth Schedule, added by 52nd Amendment, 1985.

Q7. Articles that CANNOT be suspended even during a National Emergency are:

(a) 19 & 21 (b) 20 & 21 (c) 21 & 22 (d) 14 & 19

Ans: (b) Articles 20 and 21.

Q8. The Basic Structure Doctrine was propounded in which case?

(a) Golaknath (b) Minerva Mills (c) Kesavananda Bharati (d) S.R. Bommai

Ans: (c) Kesavananda Bharati vs State of Kerala, 1973.

Q9. Which writ is issued to question the legality of a person's claim to a public office?

(a) Mandamus (b) Certiorari (c) Quo-Warranto (d) Prohibition

Ans: (c) Quo-Warranto.

Q10. The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992 added which Schedule?

(a) Tenth (b) Eleventh (c) Twelfth (d) Ninth

Ans: (b) Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects for Panchayats).

Q11. Who administers the oath of office to the President of India?

- (a) Speaker of Lok Sabha (b) Vice-President (c) Chief Justice of India (d) Prime Minister

Ans: (c) Chief Justice of India (or senior-most SC judge in CJI's absence).

Q12. The 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976 is known as the:

- (a) Mini-Constitution (b) Golden Amendment (c) People's Amendment (d) Grand Amendment

Ans: (a) Mini-Constitution.

Q13. Which Article empowers the Rajya Sabha to authorise creation of new All India Services?

- (a) Art. 249 (b) Art. 280 (c) Art. 312 (d) Art. 324

Ans: (c) Article 312.

Q14. The High Court's writ jurisdiction (Art. 226) is wider than the Supreme Court's (Art. 32) because:

- (a) HC can issue writs to foreign nationals (b) HC writs cover FR enforcement AND any other purpose (c) HC has no restrictions at all (d) SC cannot issue writs

Ans: (b).

Q15. The first Lokpal Bill was introduced in Parliament in:

- (a) 1963 (b) 1968 (c) 1971 (d) 1985

Ans: (b) 1968 (though the term 'Lokpal' was first mentioned in Parliament in 1963).

Q16. Voting age in India was reduced from 21 to 18 years by which amendment?

- (a) 42nd (b) 44th (c) 52nd (d) 61st

Ans: (d) 61st Constitutional Amendment Act, 1989.

Q17. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution currently contains how many languages?

- (a) 14 (b) 18 (c) 22 (d) 25

Ans: (c) 22 languages.

Q18. Which Committee first recommended constitutional status for Panchayati Raj Institutions?

- (a) Balwant Rai Mehta (b) Ashok Mehta (c) L.M. Singhvi (d) G.V.K. Rao

Ans: (c) L.M. Singhvi Committee, 1986 (implemented via 73rd Amendment, 1992).

Q19. National Emergency has been proclaimed in India how many times so far?

- (a) Once (b) Twice (c) Thrice (d) Four times

Ans: (c) Three times — 1962, 1971, 1975.

Q20. Which of the following is a STATUTORY (not constitutional) body?

- (a) Election Commission of India (b) Union Public Service Commission (c) Lokpal (d) Finance Commission

Ans: (c) Lokpal — created by the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013.

Q21. Which Article deals with the Right to Constitutional Remedies?

(a) Art. 19 (b) Art. 21 (c) Art. 32 (d) Art. 226

Ans: (c) Article 32.

Q22. The Governor of a State cannot pardon:

(a) Any sentence (b) A death sentence (c) A fine (d) Imprisonment up to 2 years

Ans: (b) A death sentence — only the President can, under Art. 72.

Q23. The number of Fundamental Duties at present is:

(a) 8 (b) 10 (c) 11 (d) 12

Ans: (c) 11 — originally 10 (42nd Amdt.), 11th added by 86th Amendment, 2002.

Q24. Joint Sitting of Parliament is presided over by:

(a) President (b) Vice-President (c) Speaker of Lok Sabha (d) Chairman of Rajya Sabha

Ans: (c) Speaker of Lok Sabha (Art. 118).

Q25. The Right to Property was removed from Fundamental Rights by which amendment?

(a) 24th (b) 25th (c) 42nd (d) 44th

Ans: (d) 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978 — now Art. 300-A.

MOST IMPORTANT ONE-LINER FACTS

Rapid-fire list for the final days before your exam. Read this section multiple times.

Constitution — General

- Constitution adopted 26 November 1949; came into force 26 January 1950.
- Dr. B.R. Ambedkar — 'Father of the Indian Constitution'; chaired the Drafting Committee.
- Dr. Rajendra Prasad — President of the Constituent Assembly.
- Constituent Assembly constituted under the Cabinet Mission Plan, 1946.
- Original: 22 Parts, 8 Schedules, 395 Articles; now: 25 Parts, 12 Schedules, 470+ Articles.
- Preamble amended only once — 42nd Amendment, 1976 (added Socialist, Secular, Integrity).

Union Executive

- President elected by Electoral College of elected MPs + elected MLAs (Art. 54); term 5 yrs (Art. 56).
- Impeachment of President: Article 61; only ground — 'violation of the Constitution'.
- VP is ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha (Art. 64); elected only by MPs (Art. 66).
- PM appointed by President (Art. 75); CoM responsible to Lok Sabha (Art. 75(3)).
- 91st Amendment (2003) capped CoM at 15% of House strength.
- Attorney General — Article 76; India's highest law officer.

Parliament

- Lok Sabha max. 552, current 545. Rajya Sabha max. 250, current 245.
- Rajya Sabha is permanent; 1/3rd retire every 2 yrs; member term 6 yrs.
- Money Bill (Art. 110): LS only; RS max. 14-day hold.
- Joint Sitting (Art. 108) presided by Speaker; held only 3 times (1961, 1978, 2002).
- Article 85: max. 6-month gap between sessions.
- 104th Amendment (2019) abolished Anglo-Indian nominated seats.

State Executive

- Governor appointed by President (Art. 155); holds office 'during pleasure' (Art. 156).
- Governor's pardoning power (Art. 161) excludes death sentences (unlike President's Art. 72).
- Sarojini Naidu: first woman Governor of independent India (UP, 1947).

Judiciary

- Article 32: Right to Constitutional Remedies — a Fundamental Right itself.
- Article 226: HC writ jurisdiction — wider than Art. 32.
- Article 141: SC's law binding on all courts in India.
- SC judges retire at 65; HC judges retire at 62.

- Allahabad High Court: largest HC in India by judge strength; seat at Prayagraj, Bench at Lucknow.

Rights, DPSP & Duties

- 6 Fundamental Rights today (originally 7; Property removed by 44th Amdt., 1978 → Art. 300-A).
- Articles 20 & 21 cannot be suspended even during a National Emergency.
- DPSP: Art. 36–51, Part IV; borrowed from Irish Constitution; non-justiciable.
- Fundamental Duties: Art. 51A, Part IVA; added by 42nd Amdt. (1976); 11 duties today (11th added by 86th Amdt., 2002).

Emergency & Amendments

- National Emergency proclaimed 3 times: 1962, 1971, 1975.
- 44th Amendment (1978) changed 'internal disturbance' to 'armed rebellion'.
- Basic Structure Doctrine: Kesavananda Bharati case, 1973.
- S.R. Bommai case (1994): made President's Rule (Art. 356) subject to judicial review.
- Financial Emergency (Art. 360) has never been invoked in India.

Constitutional Bodies & Local Government

- CAG — Art. 148–151; 'Guardian of the Public Purse'; first CAG — V. Narahari Rao.
- ECI established 25 January 1950; became a 3-member body in 1989.
- 61st Amendment (1989): voting age reduced from 21 to 18 years.
- 73rd Amendment (1992): Panchayati Raj given constitutional status; in force 24 April 1993.
- 74th Amendment (1992): Municipalities given constitutional status; in force 1 June 1993.
- Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957): recommended 3-tier Panchayati Raj.
- Lokpal & Lokayuktas Act, 2013: a statutory (not constitutional) body.

National Symbols

- National Flag adopted: 22 July 1947. National Anthem & Song both adopted: 24 January 1950.
- National Emblem adopted: 26 January 1950.
- 'Satyameva Jayate' is from the Mundaka Upanishad.
- No officially notified National Game in India.

FREQUENTLY ASKED POLITY QUESTIONS (FAQ STYLE)

Q1. What is the difference between Fundamental Rights and DPSP?

Fundamental Rights (Part III) are justiciable and act as negative restraints on the State. DPSPs (Part IV) are non-justiciable but 'fundamental in governance' (Art. 37) — positive directions guiding socio-economic welfare.

Q2. How is a Money Bill different from a Financial Bill?

A Money Bill (Art. 110) deals exclusively with Art. 110(1) matters — taxation, borrowing, Consolidated Fund. A Financial Bill may contain Money Bill matters PLUS other provisions; only Financial Bill Type-I needs prior Presidential recommendation and LS-only introduction, like a Money Bill.

Q3. Can the President refuse to sign a Constitutional Amendment Bill?

No. Since the 24th Amendment, 1971, the President must give assent to a Constitutional Amendment Bill passed by Parliament (and ratified by States where required) — no veto power here.

Q4. What is the Basic Structure Doctrine?

From *Kesavananda Bharati vs State of Kerala* (1973): Parliament can amend the Constitution under Art. 368, but cannot destroy its 'basic structure' — supremacy of the Constitution, secularism, federalism, judicial review, separation of powers, free & fair elections.

Q5. What is the difference between the Fifth and Sixth Schedules?

Fifth Schedule: general provisions for Scheduled Areas/Tribes in most States. Sixth Schedule: special, more autonomous arrangements (Autonomous District/Regional Councils) specifically for tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram.

Q6. Why is the Indian Constitution called 'quasi-federal'?

It has federal features (power division via 7th Schedule, independent judiciary, written Constitution, bicameral Parliament) plus strong unitary features (single citizenship, all-powerful Centre during Emergency, Governor as Centre's agent, residuary powers with Centre). K.C. Wheare called it 'quasi-federal'.

Q7. What is the difference between Ordinance-making power and Emergency powers?

Ordinance power (Art. 123) is a NORMAL legislative tool used when Parliament is not in session, on Cabinet advice. Emergency powers (Art. 352, 356, 360) apply only in crisis situations and have far wider, structural effects on governance.

Q8. Who can remove a Supreme Court / High Court judge, and how?

Only Parliament — through an address by each House, supported by special majority, on the ground of 'proved misbehaviour or incapacity' (Art. 124(4)), followed by a Presidential order.

LAST-MINUTE REVISION SHEET

Use this single consolidated page as your final glance before entering the exam hall.

Numbers To Remember

Item	Number
Original Articles / Parts / Schedules	395 / 22 / 8
Current Parts / Schedules (approx.)	25 / 12
Fundamental Rights (originally / now)	7 / 6
Fundamental Duties (originally / now)	10 / 11
DPSP Articles	36–51 (16 Articles)
Languages in 8th Schedule	22 (originally 14)
Lok Sabha (max. / current)	552 / 545
Rajya Sabha (max. / current)	250 / 245
National Emergencies declared so far	3 (1962, 1971, 1975)
Joint Sitzings held so far	3 (1961, 1978, 2002)
Subjects in 11th Schedule (Panchayats)	29
Subjects in 12th Schedule (Municipalities)	18
Eligible voting age	18 years (since 61st Amdt., 1989)
Min. age — President/VP/Governor	35 years
Min. age — Lok Sabha/Assembly	25 years
Min. age — Rajya Sabha/Council	30 years

Amendment Numbers To Remember

Amdt. No.	One-Word Memory Hook
1st (1951)	Ninth Schedule
7th (1956)	States reorganised on linguistic basis
24th (1971)	President MUST sign amendment bills
42nd (1976)	Mini-Constitution; Fundamental Duties; DPSP additions
44th (1978)	Reversed Emergency excesses; Right to Property removed
52nd (1985)	Anti-Defection (10th Schedule)
61st (1989)	Voting age 21 → 18

Amdt. No.	One-Word Memory Hook
73rd / 74th (1992)	Panchayats / Municipalities
86th (2002)	Article 21A + 11th Fundamental Duty
91st (2003)	Council of Ministers capped at 15%
97th (2011)	Co-operative societies (Art. 43B)
101st (2016)	GST
103rd (2019)	10% EWS reservation
104th (2019)	Anglo-Indian seats abolished

Final Tips for Exam Day

- Article numbers are the highest-yield area — revise the Master Quick-Reference tables (Unit 15) one final time.
- Pay special attention to amendment numbers — RO/ARO papers frequently test 'which amendment did X' style questions.
- Double-check current officeholders (President, VP, CJI, CEC, Speaker) close to your exam date — these change.
- When in doubt between two close options (e.g., Article 32 vs 226, Fifth vs Sixth Schedule), recall the DISTINGUISHING feature, not just the number.
- Re-read all ★ EXAM FOCUS and 🧠 MEMORY TRICK boxes in this document the night before the exam — they capture the highest-frequency traps.

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY

Comprehensive Exam-Oriented Study Notes

Allahabad High Court RO | UPPCS | SSC | UPSC Prelims | State PCS

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CHAPTER 1: INDIA — BASIC FACTS & LOCATION

1.1 India's Position in the World

India lies in the **Northern** and **Eastern** hemispheres of the globe.

Aspect	Details
Latitudinal Extent (Mainland)	8°4'N to 37°6'N
Longitudinal Extent	68°7'E to 97°25'E
North-South Extent	3,214 km
East-West Extent	2,933 km
Lat/Long Difference	Both ~29° (interesting coincidence!)
Hemisphere	Northern + Eastern
Area	~32.8 lakh sq km (7th largest country)
World Position	2nd most populous; 7th largest by area

Why East-West Extent < North-South Despite Equal Degrees?

Longitude lines converge towards the poles. Therefore, 1° of longitude represents a **shorter distance** at higher latitudes than near the equator. India's eastern states are at higher latitudes — so the actual km distance (2,933 km) is less than the north-south extent (3,214 km), even though the angular difference (~29°) is the same.

EXAM FOCUS

Q: Latitudinal/Longitudinal extent of India?

Q: North-South vs East-West extent — which is more and why?

Q: In which hemispheres does India lie?

Trick: Lat difference = Long difference ≈ 29°; but N-S > E-W in km

1.2 India as a Tropical Nation

Despite extending up to 37°N (which lies in the warm temperate zone), India is classified as a **Tropical Nation**. Two key reasons:

Himalayas as a barrier — The Himalayas block cold Siberian (Tertiary) winds from reaching India, preventing the extreme cold typical of other temperate regions at similar latitudes.

Monsoon Winds — India experiences monsoonal rainfall driven by seasonal wind reversal, which is a characteristic feature of Tropical regions, not Temperate ones.

Non-geographic evidence: India's disease patterns, dietary habits, festivals, and cultural traits align with tropical nations globally.

EXAM FOCUS

Q: Is India a Tropical or Temperate nation? Why?

Answer: Tropical — due to Himalayas blocking cold winds + monsoonal climate

1.3 Standard Meridian & Indian Standard Time (IST)

India's longitudinal extent is 29° (~2 hours). This debate is ongoing on whether India needs **two time zones**.

Aspect	Detail
Standard Meridian	82.5°E ($82^\circ30'\text{E}$)
IST = GMT +	+ 5 hours 30 minutes
Passes through	Mirzapur (UP) — also called 'Clock Tower of India'
Reason for single time zone	Avoid administrative complexity, railway signal conflicts, national unity
Countries with similar size & multiple zones	USA (6 zones), Russia (11 zones), China (uses 1 zone despite size)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Standard Meridian = 82.5°E passes through Allahabad (Mirzapur district), UP

IST = UTC + 5:30

Arguments FOR two zones: NE states suffer daylight wastage, energy loss, disrupted circadian rhythm

Arguments AGAINST: Railway safety (collision risk), administrative cost, national unity concerns

1.4 Tropic of Cancer — States it Passes Through

The Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N) passes through **8 Indian states**. Remember with mnemonic: '**Mit Ra Par Gam Chha Jha**' (or: M-T-P-R-G-M-C-Z-J)

Sequence (West to East)	State
1	Gujarat
2	Rajasthan (touches southern tip only)
3	Madhya Pradesh
4	Chhattisgarh
5	Jharkhand
6	West Bengal
7	Tripura
8	Mizoram

🔥 EXAM FOCUS

Q: How many states does the Tropic of Cancer pass through? → 8 states

Q: Which states? → Gujarat, Rajasthan, MP, CG, Jharkhand, WB, Tripura, Mizoram

Mnemonic: Gu Ra Ma Chha Jha Pa Tri Mi

Note: The line enters India from west (Gujarat) to east (Mizoram)

1.5 Important Latitudinal Reference Line across India

A useful north-to-south alignment of key cities:

Shimla (Himachal Pradesh) — Northernmost reference

Delhi (National Capital)

Bhopal (MP Capital)

These cities lie on roughly the same meridian — showing India's vast N-S extent

CHAPTER 2: INDIA'S NEIGHBORS & INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARIES

2.1 Neighboring Countries — Quick Overview

Country	Border States	Special Notes
Pakistan	Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, J&K	Longest land border (3,323 km); Radcliffe Line (1947); Kori Creek dispute; Siachin issue
China	J&K, Himachal, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal	LAC (Line of Actual Control); Tibet Autonomous Region; Aksai Chin dispute
Nepal	Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, WB, Sikkim	Open border (Treaty of Sugauli 1816); Kalapani dispute; Nepal-India Treaty
Bhutan	Assam, Sikkim, Arunachal, WB	Friendly relations; Doklam issue (2017); Manas NP spans border
Bangladesh	WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura	Longest border ~4,156 km; Enclave exchange (100th Amendment)
Myanmar	Arunachal, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram	Natural border (Patkai Hills, Naga Hills, Mizo Hills, Lushai Hills)
Afghanistan	PoK (via Wakhan corridor)	India-Afg border through Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir
Sri Lanka	(Maritime boundary)	Palk Strait separates the two; Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu)
Maldives	(Maritime boundary)	8° channel between Maldives and Minicoy Island

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

China shares border with 5 Indian states: J&K, HP, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh

Bangladesh shares border with 5 states: WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura

Nepal shares border with 5 states: Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, WB, Sikkim

Myanmar shares border with 4 states: Arunachal, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram

Pakistan shares border with 4 states/UTs: Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, J&K

2.2 India-Nepal Border: Kalapani Dispute

Treaty of Sugauli (1816) — signed after Anglo-Nepalese War — demarcated the Kali River as Nepal's western boundary. However, the river changed course over time, leading to a **boundary dispute** over the Kalapani region.

Kalapani is located in **Pithoragarh district, Uttarakhand**

Currently administered by India; Nepal claims it in their political maps

Kailash Mansarovar Yatra route passes through this region

India-Nepal border largely follows the **Shivalik Range** (E to W)

2.3 India-Myanmar Border

This is a **natural border** formed by the **Purvanchal (Eastern) Hills**:

Patkai Bum hills — Arunachal Pradesh

Naga Hills — Nagaland (Highest peak: **Mount Saramati**)

Manipur Hills (Mani Hills) — Manipur → Location of **Loktak Lake** and **Keibul Lamjao NP**

Mizo Hills and Lushai Hills — Mizoram (Blue mountains due to blue-colored rocks → **Phawngpui Blue Mountain NP**)

A river originates from Patkai: **Chindwin River** → tributary of **Irrawaddy River** (Myanmar)

EXAM FOCUS

Mount Saramati = Highest peak of Nagaland (on Naga Hills)

Keibul Lamjao NP → only floating national park in the world → on Loktak Lake → famous for Sangai Deer

Irrawaddy Dolphin = Brackish water dolphin | Gangetic Dolphin = Fresh water dolphin

Phawngpui Blue Mountain NP — Mizoram

2.4 India-Bhutan Border

India and Bhutan share a friendly border along Assam, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, and West Bengal.

Manas National Park (Assam) extends into Bhutan as **Royal Manas National Park**

Doklam — A tri-junction area (India-Bhutan-China) that was a major standoff point in 2017

Bhutan is known for its GNH (Gross National Happiness) index and strong environmental commitment

2.5 India-Bangladesh Border: The Enclave Exchange

The **100th Constitutional Amendment Act (2015)** enabled exchange of enclaves between India and Bangladesh.

Bangladesh has the **longest** land border with India (~4,156 km)

India-Bangladesh border passes through WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura

EXAM FOCUS

100th Amendment — for land boundary agreement with Bangladesh (enclave exchange)

Bangladesh has longest land border with India among all neighbors

CHAPTER 3: PHYSICAL DIVISIONS OF INDIA

India's terrain can be divided into six major physiographic divisions:

Division	Key Features	Area
1. Himalayan Mountains	Young fold mountains; N boundary; arc shape	~5 lakh sq km
2. Northern Plains	Alluvial; most fertile; densely populated	~7 lakh sq km
3. Peninsular Plateau	Oldest landmass; stable; 600m avg elevation	~16 lakh sq km
4. Coastal Plains	West & East coasts; fishing; ports	~1.5 lakh sq km
5. Thar Desert	Arid; NW India; NW states	~1.75 lakh sq km
6. Islands	Andaman & Nicobar + Lakshadweep	~8,000 sq km

3.1 The Himalayas

Formation of the Himalayas

The Himalayas were formed by the **collision of the Indian Plate with the Eurasian Plate**. This is a convergent boundary — but unlike typical ocean-continent convergence, here **two continental plates collided**.

~85 million years ago, the Indian Peninsula broke away from Madagascar and started moving northward

The Indian Plate moved at very high speed, causing it to **lock under** the Eurasian Plate (NOT full subduction)

This caused **doubling of Earth's crust** (why there is no volcanic activity in Himalayas but high earthquake risk)

Multiple collision events = **series of parallel ranges** → not one range, but several

Himalayas are **Fold Mountains** (not volcanic)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Himalayas = Fold Mountains formed by Indian Plate + Eurasian Plate collision

No volcanoes in Himalayas — because crust doubled (magma cannot rise)

High earthquake risk due to continuing plate movement

Himalayas are youngest mountain range in India (~55 million years old)

Indian Plate was part of Gondwana Land originally

Divisions of the Himalayas (North to South)

Range	Also Known As	Avg Altitude	Key Features
Greater Himalayas	Himadri	6,000+ m	Highest peaks; Mt Everest, K2, Kanchenjunga; perpetual snow

Range	Also Known As	Avg Altitude	Key Features
Lesser Himalayas	Himachal	1,000–4,500 m	Shimla, Mussoorie, Nainital, Darjeeling; hill stations
Outer Himalayas	Shivalik	900–1,100 m	Youngest; youngest sedimentary; prone to erosion

Divisions of Himalayas (West to East)

Region	Location	Key Points
Punjab Himalaya	Between Indus and Sutlej	Dhauladhar, Pir Panjal ranges
Kumaon Himalaya	Between Sutlej and Kali	Nanda Devi (highest peak in India in open area — 7816m)
Nepal Himalaya	Between Kali and Teesta	Mt Everest (8848m), Kanchenjunga
Assam Himalaya	Between Teesta and Dihang	Namcha Barwa peak; syntaxial bend

Important Himalayan Passes

Pass	State/Location	Connects	Importance
Karakoram Pass	Ladakh (J&K)	India–China (Xinjiang)	Highest motorable pass; Silk Route
Zoji La	J&K	Srinagar to Ladakh	NH-1D; strategic pass; closed in winter
Rohtang Pass	HP (between Kullu & Lahaul-Spiti)	Manali to Keylong	Alternate: Atal Tunnel (2020)
Baralacha La	HP	Lahaul to Ladakh	On Manali-Leh Highway
Shipki La	HP	India–China (Tibet)	Sutlej river enters India here
Nathu La	Sikkim	India–China (Tibet)	Reopened for trade 2006
Bomdi La	Arunachal Pradesh	India–China (Tibet)	Strategic importance (1962 War)
Diphu Pass	Arunachal	India–Myanmar–China trijunction	Tri-junction point

EXAM FOCUS

Highest motorable pass in India: Khardung La (Ladakh) at ~5,359m

Atal Tunnel: Opened 2020; bypasses Rohtang Pass; world's longest road tunnel above 10,000 ft

Nathu La: Important for India-China border trade (Sikkim)

Shipki La: Sutlej enters India through this pass

Zoji La: Key pass connecting Kashmir Valley to Ladakh

3.2 Northern Plains (Indo-Gangetic Plains)

Also called: **Great Plains / Aggradational Plains / Northern Plains**. Formed by alluvial deposits of Himalayan rivers over millions of years.

Average elevation: **~200 m** above sea level (Ambala Ridge: 291m — watershed between Indus & Ganga drainage)

Stretches from Punjab in the west to Assam in the east (~2,400 km long, 240–320 km wide)

Types of Land in the Plains

Type	Description	Location/Features
Bhabar	Coarse gravel/pebble belt at foothills	8–16 km wide; rivers disappear underground; dry zone
Tarai	Wet marshy belt south of Bhabar	Streams reappear; dense vegetation; wildlife; good for farming
Bangar	Old alluvium (older deposits, elevated)	Higher areas; less fertile; kankars (lime nodules) present
Khadar	New alluvium (newer deposits, low-lying)	Near rivers; very fertile; floods annually; best farming

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Bhabar → Tarai → Bangar → Khadar (North to South sequence near Himalayas)

Khadar = most fertile soil — renewed every flood season

Bangar = older alluvium — contains Kankars (impure lime concretions)

UPSC/UPPCS repeatedly asks: What is Bhabar? What is Tarai? Sequence?

Sub-Divisions of Northern Plains (Doabs)

Doab (Interfluve)	Between Rivers	Location
Sindh Sagar Doab	Indus & Jhelum	Punjab (now Pakistan mostly)
Chaj Doab	Jhelum & Chenab	Punjab
Rechna Doab	Chenab & Ravi	Punjab
Bari Doab	Ravi & Beas	Punjab
Bist Doab / Jullundur Doab	Beas & Sutlej	Punjab (India side)
Yamuna-Ghaggar Doab	Yamuna & Ghaggar	Haryana Plains

Regional Sub-Plains of Gangetic Plains

Region	Location	Rivers/Features
Rohelkhand Plains	W UP — Ramganga basin	Named after Rohilla tribe
Yamuna-Ganga Doab	Between Yamuna & Ganga	Most important agricultural area
Yamuna-Chambal Doab	Between Yamuna & Chambal	Central UP/Rajasthan
Awadh Plains	Between Gomti & Ghaghra	Central UP — Lucknow region

Region	Location	Rivers/Features
Mithila Plains	Between Gandak & Kosi	Bihar — language: Maithili; Sita Mata connection
Magadh Plains	South of Son River	Bihar — ancient Magadha empire
Par Delta	Lower Ganga plains	West Bengal — deltaic region
Rar Plains	Adjacent to Chhota Nagpur	Laterite deposits; separates plateau from plains
Deltaic Plains	Ganga-Brahmaputra delta	Largest delta in world; Sundarbans

EXAM FOCUS

Q: What separates Chhota Nagpur Plateau from plains? → Rar Plains (laterite deposits)

Q: Mithila Plains — between which rivers? → Gandak and Kosi

Q: Doab meaning → land between two rivers ('do' = two, 'ab' = water)

Q: Chhos — what are they? → Gully erosion in Punjab plains caused by seasonal streams

Brahmaputra Plains (Assam)

Brahmaputra carries the largest amount of sediment in the world. Due to high sediment load it forms **braided channels** and creates river islands like **Majuli** — world's largest river island district in Assam.

EXAM FOCUS

Brahmaputra = world's largest sediment-carrying river

Majuli = largest river island district in India (Assam)

In Tibet: Brahmaputra = Yarlung Tsangpo | In Arunachal: Dihang | In Assam: Brahmaputra

3.3 Peninsular Plateau

Key Features

Oldest and most stable landmass of India — formed ~2.5 billion years ago (Archaean era)

Was originally part of **Gondwana Land** (before continental drift)

Formed by junction of ancient **Cratons** (Aravalli Craton, Singhbhum Craton, Dharwar Craton)

Average elevation: **600 m** above sea level

Covers ~16 lakh sq km (about half of India)

No volcanic activity; tectonically stable; composed of ancient crystalline/metamorphic rocks

Major Hills and Ranges of Peninsular India

Range	Location	Highest Peak / Notes
Aravalli	Rajasthan–Gujarat–Delhi	Guru Shikhar (1722m) in Mt Abu; oldest range in India
Vindhya	MP — N boundary of Deccan	Separates Ganga basin from Deccan plateau
Satpura	MP — between Narmada & Tapi	Pachmarhi (highest point in MP); Dhupgarh peak

Range	Location	Highest Peak / Notes
Western Ghats	Kerala-Karnataka-Goa-Maharashtra coast	Anaimudi (2695m) — highest peak in peninsular India
Eastern Ghats	AP-TN-Odisha coast	Jindhagada Peak (highest); discontinuous; lower than W Ghats
Nilgiri Hills	Where W & E Ghats meet (TN-Kerala)	Ooty (Udhagamandalam); Doddabetta peak (2637m)
Anaimalai Hills	TN-Kerala boundary	Anaimudi peak
Cardamom Hills	Kerala (Idukki)	Source of many Kerala rivers
Shevroy / Javadi Hills	TN	Part of Eastern Ghats system

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Aravalli = Oldest mountain range in India (and world — Precambrian)

Anaimudi (2695m) = Highest peak of Peninsular India / South India (Western Ghats)

Guru Shikhar (1722m) = Highest peak of Aravalli / Rajasthan

Western Ghats = UNESCO World Heritage Site (biodiversity hotspot)

Eastern Ghats are discontinuous (rivers cut through them flowing to Bay of Bengal)

Major Plateaus of India

Plateau	Location	Importance
Malwa Plateau	MP + Rajasthan	Between Aravalli and Vindhya; Chambal flows through
Chhota Nagpur Plateau	Jharkhand	Rich in minerals; coal, iron ore; Damodar valley coalfields
Deccan Plateau	Maharashtra, AP, Karnataka	Largest plateau in India; black soil (regur); Deccan Lava flows
Meghalaya Plateau	Meghalaya	Extension of Chhota Nagpur; separated by Brahmaputra plains; wettest place (Mawsynram/Cherrapunji)
Mysore Plateau	Karnataka	Dense forests; coffee and silk production
Telangana Plateau	Telangana	Deccan Trap basalts; Krishna-Godavari basin
Bundelkhand Plateau	UP + MP	Ravines and gullies; Chambal badlands
Baghelkhand Plateau	MP + CG	Coal deposits

🔥 EXAM FOCUS

Q: Which is India's largest plateau? → Deccan Plateau

Q: Mineral-rich plateau → Chhota Nagpur (called 'Ruhr of India')

Q: Wettest plateau region → Meghalaya (Mawsynram/Cherrapunji)

Q: Black cotton soil associated plateau → Deccan (from Deccan Trap basalt weathering)

3.4 Thar Desert (Great Indian Desert)

Aspect	Details
Location	Mostly Rajasthan; parts of Gujarat, Punjab, Haryana
Area	~2 lakh sq km
Annual Rainfall	<25 cm (arid zone)
Saline Lakes	Sambhar, Didwana, Kuchaman, Pachpadra, Degana (salt production)
Crops grown	Bajra, jowar, ragi (millets); pulses
Energy potential	Solar & wind energy hub
Mineral resources	Barmer & Jaisalmer — oil and natural gas fields
Region name	Semi-arid Rajasthan → 'Rajasthan Bangar'; Aravalli = semi-arid boundary

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Sambhar = largest inland saltwater lake in India (Rajasthan)

Luni River originates from Aravalli → flows to Rann of Kutch (Gujarat)

Barchans = crescent-shaped sand dunes (wind direction indicator)

UPSC has asked about saline lakes of Rajasthan — Sambhar, Didwana, Kuchaman, Pachpadra

3.5 Coastal Plains

Coast	Location	Features
Malabar Coast (West)	Kerala	Backwaters (Kayal); coconut; fishing; Vembanad Lake; Periyar; Pamba rivers
Konkan Coast (West)	Goa + S Maharashtra	Rocky; narrow; Goa beaches; Mandavi, Zuari rivers
Karnataka Coast (West)	Karnataka	Mangalore port; cashew; Netravati river
Gujarat Coast (West)	Gujarat	Gulf of Khambhat; Gulf of Kutch; Sabarmati; Mahi; Luni rivers
Coromandel Coast (East)	TN + South AP	Bay of Bengal; receives NE monsoon rains Oct-Dec; Palk Bay
Northern Circars (East)	North AP + Odisha	Chilika Lake; deltas of Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri

3.6 Islands of India

Andaman and Nicobar Islands (Bay of Bengal)

Feature	Details
Total Islands	572+ (only 38 inhabited)
Groups	Andaman (North) + Nicobar (South) — separated by 10° Channel
Capital	Port Blair (South Andaman)
Highest Peak	Saddle Peak (North Andaman) — ~732 m

Feature	Details
Active Volcano	Barren Island (only active volcano in South Asia)
Dormant Volcano	Narcondam Island
Renamed Islands	Ross Island → Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Island; Havelock → Swaraj Dweep; Neil Island → Shaheed Dweep
Formation	Submerged mountains (extension of Himalayan arc)

Channels between Andaman-Nicobar Islands

Channel	Separates
10° Channel	Little Andaman (S) from Car Nicobar (N) — most important
Duncan Passage	South Andaman and Little Andaman
St. George's Channel	Little Nicobar and Great Nicobar
Grand Channel	Great Nicobar and Sumatra (Indonesia)

Lakshadweep Islands (Arabian Sea)

Feature	Details
Total Islands	36 islands
Capital	Kavaratti
Type	Coral islands (Atolls) — formed on coral reefs
Smallest UT	Smallest Union Territory of India by area (~32 sq km)
Groups	Amindivi Islands + Laccadive Islands + Minicoy Island

Important Channels — Lakshadweep

Channel	Separates
9° Channel	Lakshadweep (main) and Minicoy Island
8° Channel	Minicoy Island and Maldives
11° Channel	Amindivi Islands and main Lakshadweep group

EXAM FOCUS

Barren Island = India's only active volcano (Andaman & Nicobar)

Narcondam = Dormant volcano (Andaman & Nicobar)

10° Channel = between Andaman and Nicobar groups

9° Channel = separates main Lakshadweep from Minicoy

Lakshadweep = smallest UT | Andaman & Nicobar = largest UT

Lakshadweep = Coral | Andaman = Submerged mountains (volcanic/sedimentary rock)

CHAPTER 4: INDIAN MONSOON

4.1 Origin of the Word 'Monsoon'

The word '**Monsoon**' is derived from the Arabic word '**Mausam**' (meaning 'season'). Ancient Arab traders navigating to India noticed seasonal reversal of winds — SW winds in summer (to India) and NE winds in winter (back to Arabia). This seasonal wind reversal became associated with 'mausam'.

4.2 Characteristics of Indian Monsoon

Characteristic	Description
Onset	Sudden — arrives over Kerala around June 1 (official onset date)
Retreat	Gradual — takes weeks to retreat; not sudden like onset
Break in Monsoon	1–2 week dry spells within monsoon season (July–August)
Variability	Rainfall amount varies year to year (may fail or be excess)
Duration	June to September (SW Monsoon); Oct–Dec in Tamil Nadu (NE Monsoon)

4.3 Factors Controlling Indian Monsoon (Modern Theory)

1. Tibetan Plateau

Tibet's high altitude causes intense **insolation** (solar heating) → generates an **intense low pressure** over Tibet. This acts as:

A **source of low pressure** → attracts moisture-laden winds from Indian Ocean

A **mechanical barrier** → deflects winds southward into the Indian subcontinent

2. Jet Streams

Jet Stream	Season	Effect
Sub-tropical Westerly Jet Stream	Winter	Flows S of Himalayas → brings Western Disturbances → winter rains in NW India
Tibetan Anticyclonic Circulation (Upper Easterly Jet)	Summer	Flows over India from E → helps monsoon surge northward

3. ITCZ (Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone)

The ITCZ is a low-pressure belt where NE and SE trade winds converge. In summer, the ITCZ **shifts northward to the sub-continent** (Thar Desert region), creating a powerful low-pressure trough that draws in the moisture-laden SW monsoon winds.

4. ENSO (El Nino Southern Oscillation)

Phenomenon	Effect on Indian Monsoon
El Nino (warm phase)	Weakens Indian monsoon → drought tendency in India

Phenomenon	Effect on Indian Monsoon
La Nina (cool phase)	Strengthens Indian monsoon → above-normal rainfall
Southern Oscillation	Pressure difference between Darwin (Aus) and Tahiti (Pacific)
IOD — Indian Ocean Dipole	Positive IOD: above-normal monsoon; Negative IOD: below-normal

EXAM FOCUS

El Nino → drought in India (weakens monsoon)

La Nina → floods in India (strengthens monsoon)

ITCZ shifts north in summer → triggers SW Monsoon

Mascarene High (near Madagascar in Indian Ocean) = source of high pressure driving monsoon winds

SW Monsoon arrives Kerala ~June 1; withdraws from NW India by mid-September

4.4 Branches of SW Monsoon

Branch	Path	States Covered
Arabian Sea Branch	Hits Western Ghats first; heaviest rain on windward side	Kerala, Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra, Gujarat
Bay of Bengal Branch	Hits Eastern India and curves NW	Odisha, WB, NE India, then UP, Punjab, Rajasthan

Rain Shadow effect: Eastern side of Western Ghats (leeward side) receives very little rain — hence Deccan Plateau is relatively dry.

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Mawsynram (Meghalaya) = Wettest place in India and world (avg ~11,871 mm/year)

Cherrapunji = Second wettest; historically recorded highest rainfall

Chennai receives most rain from NE Monsoon (Oct–Dec), not SW Monsoon

Jaisalmer = driest place in India (Thar Desert)

CHAPTER 5: SOILS OF INDIA

5.1 Factors Affecting Soil Formation

Factor	Influence
Parent Rock (Geology)	Determines mineral composition of soil
Climate	Controls weathering rate; rainfall → leaching; temperature → decomposition
Topography	Plains = deep homogeneous soil; Mountains = shallow heterogeneous soil
Biotic Factors	Vegetation → humus content; bacteria → decomposition
Time	More time = more mature/deep soil

5.2 Soil Profile (Horizons)

Horizon	Name	Description
O Horizon	Organic Layer	Surface layer; undecomposed/partly decomposed leaf litter, dead matter
A Horizon	Top Soil	Most fertile; all minerals present; humus content here; zone of eluviation (E layer within A)
E Layer	Zone of Eluviation	Within A horizon; minerals leach out downward
B Horizon	Sub Soil	Zone of illuviation; iron, aluminum, humic compounds accumulate here
C Horizon	Parent Material	Partially weathered rock; less altered than above
R Horizon	Bedrock	Unweathered solid rock

5.3 Types of Soils in India (8 types as per ICAR)

Soil Type	Distribution	Characteristics	Key Crops
Alluvial Soil	N Plains (UP, Bihar, Punjab, WB), river deltas	Most extensive; Bangar (old) & Khadar (new); Kankars in Bangar; highly fertile	Wheat, rice, sugarcane, cotton, jute
Black Soil (Regur)	Deccan Plateau (Maharashtra, MP, Gujarat, AP)	Formed from Deccan Lava (basalt); swells when wet, cracks when dry; self-ploughing; high clay content	Cotton (best soil for cotton); soybean
Red & Yellow Soil	Eastern MP, Odisha, S AP, Kerala, Tamil Nadu	Formed on ancient crystalline rocks; red due to iron oxides; poor in N, P, humus	Rice, millet, tobacco, groundnut
Laterite Soil	Kerala, Karnataka, TN, Odisha highlands (humid tropics)	Formed by intense leaching in high rainfall; hard when dry; poor in N, Ca; rich in Fe, Al	Tea, coffee, rubber, cashew
Arid/Desert Soil	Rajasthan, S Punjab, N Gujarat	Sandy; low humus; high salt content; irrigation makes fertile	Bajra, pulses with irrigation

Soil Type	Distribution	Characteristics	Key Crops
Saline/Alkaline Soil	Arid areas, coastal areas	Reh/Usar/Thur soil; high salt; poor fertility; waterlogging issues	Problem soil — needs reclamation
Peaty/Marshy Soil	Kerala, Bengal, Bihar lowlands	High organic/humus content; waterlogged; acidic	Rice, vegetables
Forest/Mountain Soil	Himalayan + Eastern Ghats forests	Varies with altitude; thin; high organic matter	Tea, coffee, spices in lower altitudes

EXAM FOCUS

Q: Which soil is best for cotton? → Black (Regur) soil

Q: Which soil covers largest area in India? → Alluvial soil

Q: Laterite soil is formed by → intense leaching in heavy rainfall areas

Q: Self-ploughing property → Black soil (swells + cracks)

Q: Podzolization → process in coniferous forests where sesqui-oxides of Fe & Al leach, leaving silica+calcium

Q: Laterization → process in high rainfall where SiO₂ and Ca leach, leaving Fe and Al oxides

Q: Reh/Usar = Saline soil found in Indo-Gangetic Plains

CHAPTER 6: NATURAL VEGETATION OF INDIA

6.1 Forest Cover

According to India State of Forest Report, forest & tree cover = ~24.6% of India's total geographical area. Constitutional provision: Article 51-A (g) → fundamental duty to protect environment/forest/wildlife.

6.2 Types of Forests

Forest Type	Rainfall	Location	Key Trees/Features
Tropical Evergreen	200+ cm; no dry season	N-E India, Western Ghats windward side, A&N Islands	Ebony, mahogany, rosewood; dense canopy; no leaf-shedding season; highest biodiversity
Tropical Deciduous (Moist)	100–200 cm	E MP, Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, N-E India	Teak, sal, sandalwood; shed leaves in dry season; most commercially important
Tropical Deciduous (Dry)	70–100 cm	Central India plains (UP, Bihar, Rajasthan, MP)	Sal, kendu, neem, peepal; more open canopy
Tropical Thorn Scrub	<70 cm	Rajasthan, Gujarat, Punjab, Haryana dry areas	Khejri (state tree of Rajasthan), cacti, babul (Acacia)
Montane Temperate	Altitude-based (900–2700m)	Himalayas, Nilgiris	Oak, chestnut, deodar, pine, rhododendron
Alpine	Above 3600m	High Himalayas	Juniper, silver fir, birch; scrub at snowline
Mangrove / Tidal	Coastal+tidal zone	Sundarbans (WB), Gujarat, Andhra, Odisha	Sundari tree; salt-tolerant; oxygen roots (pneumatophores); habitat for tigers, crocodiles
Littoral / Swamp	Coastal areas	Along sea coasts, lagoons	Coconut, pandanus; brackish water species

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Sundarbans = world's largest mangrove forest (India + Bangladesh); UNESCO WH Site

Sundari tree → Sundarbans name derived from it

Western Ghats = biodiversity hotspot (one of 36 globally)

India has 18 biosphere reserves recognized by UNESCO Man and Biosphere Programme

Largest forest area by state: Madhya Pradesh

Highest % forest cover: Mizoram (~85%)

CHAPTER 7: DRAINAGE SYSTEM OF INDIA

7.1 Classification of Indian Rivers

Basis	Types
By Origin	Himalayan Rivers (Perennial — snow/glacier fed) vs Peninsular Rivers (Seasonal — rain-fed)
By Drainage Basin	Bay of Bengal drainage vs Arabian Sea drainage vs Inland drainage
By Flow	Antecedent (pre-dates mountain — cuts through) vs Superimposed (overlaid on rock) vs Consequent (follows slope)
By Pattern	Dendritic, Radial, Centripetal, Trellis, Parallel

Drainage Patterns

Pattern	Description	Example
Dendritic	Tree-like branching; on uniform rock	Ganga, Indus
Radial	Rivers flow outward from a central hill	Amarkantak hills → Narmada, Son, Mahanadi radiate outward
Centripetal	Rivers flow inward to a depression/lake	Rivers of Rann of Kutch, Loktak Lake basin
Trellis	Tributaries join at right angles	Rivers of folded Appalachian type
Angular	Between rectangular and trellis	River systems in jointed rocks

7.2 Major Himalayan Rivers

Indus River System

Feature	Details
Origin	Bokhar Chu Glacier near Kailash Mansarovar Lake (Tibet)
Length	~3180 km (total); ~1114 km in India
Flow direction	Flows NW through Ladakh → enters Pakistan; meets Arabian Sea near Karachi
Left bank tributaries (in India)	Zaskar, Shyok, Nubra, Gilgit (in Ladakh)
Right bank (Punjab 5 rivers)	Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej
Treaty	Indus Waters Treaty 1960 (India-Pakistan mediated by World Bank)
Gorge formed	Indus Gorge — deepest gorge in the world between Ladakh and Gilgit

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Indus Waters Treaty (1960): India gets E rivers (Sutlej, Beas, Ravi); Pakistan gets W rivers (Indus, Jhelum, Chenab)

Indus Gorge = world's deepest gorge

Sutlej enters India via Shipki La Pass
 Satluj + Beas join = forms Sutlej in Pakistan → then joins Indus
 Ranjit Sagar Dam = on Ravi River (J&K)

Ganga River System

Feature	Details
Origin	Gangotri Glacier (Bhagirathi + Alaknanda join at Devprayag = Ganga)
Length	~2525 km in India; largest by discharge in India
States covered	Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, Jharkhand, WB
Major Left bank tributaries	Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghra (Karnali), Gandak, Kosi, Mahananda
Major Right bank tributaries	Yamuna, Son, Damodar (joins Hooghly)
National River	Ganga declared national river in 2008
Key tributaries' origins	Yamuna: Yamunotri glacier; Kosi: Nepal Himalayas (Sorrow of Bihar); Son: Amarkantak

Prayagraj Sangam: Ganga, Yamuna, and mythological Saraswati meet here — site of Kumbh Mela.

River	Origin	Notable Features
Yamuna	Yamunotri Glacier (Uttarakhand)	Longest tributary of Ganga; Delhi, Agra, Mathura on banks; joins at Prayagraj
Ghaghra/Karnali	Nepal Himalayas	Meets Ganga near Chapra (Bihar); highest discharge tributary
Gandak/Narayani	Nepal	Joins Ganga near Patna
Kosi	Nepal (meets 5 rivers)	'Sorrow of Bihar' — changes course frequently; flood-prone
Chambal	Vindhya/Janapav Hills (MP)	Flows through ravines; tributes to Yamuna; Chambal WL Sanctuary; Gandhi Sagar Dam
Son	Amarkantak Plateau	Right bank tributary; joins near Patna
Ramganga	Nainital Hills (Uttarakhand)	Right bank; Rohelkhand Plains formed by its alluvium

EXAM FOCUS

Ganga = National River | Gangetic Dolphin = National Aquatic Animal
 Haridwar = where Ganga enters plains | Rishikesh = rapids for rafting
 Kosi = 'Sorrow of Bihar' — deposits sediment + changes course = floods
 Yamuna = longest tributary of Ganga
 Son River forms Magadh Plains (south of Son)
 Chambal = originates from Vindhyas (Janapav Hill, MP) → ravines → Yamuna

Brahmaputra River System

Feature	Details
Origin	Chemayungdung (Chema Yungdung) Glacier, Tibet
Names by region	Tibet: Yarlung Tsangpo → Arunachal: Dihang (Siang) → Assam: Brahmaputra → Bangladesh: Jamuna
Total length	~2900 km (one of the longest rivers in the world)
Key feature	Antecedent river; older than Himalayas; syntaxial bend at Namcha Barwa
Sediment	World's largest sediment-carrying river
Major island	Majuli (world's largest river island district — Assam)
Left bank tributaries	Lohit, Dibang, Dihang, Dhansiri
Right bank tributaries	Subansiri, Kameng, Manas, Sankosh, Teesta
Bangladesh	Joins Ganga (as Padma) + Meghna → Bay of Bengal; world's largest delta (Sundarbans)

EXAM FOCUS

Brahmaputra = largest river by water volume/discharge in India

Namcha Barwa = syntaxial bend — eastern most point of Himalayas

Teesta River → tributary of Brahmaputra; dispute between India-Bangladesh-Sikkim

Manas River → important tributary; Manas National Park on its banks (Assam/Bhutan border)

Tista = Teesta; important for West Bengal & Sikkim

7.3 Peninsular Rivers

East-Flowing Peninsular Rivers

River	Origin	Tributaries	Mouth/States
Mahanadi	Raipur district, Chhattisgarh	Seonath, Hasdeo, Mand, Ib (left); Jonk, Ong, Tel (right)	Bay of Bengal (Odisha); Hirakud Dam
Godavari	Trimbakeshwar (Nasik, Maharashtra)	Indravati, Pranhita (Ward+Wainganga+Penganga), Sabari	Bay of Bengal (AP); 'Dakshin Ganga'
Krishna	Mahabaleshwar (Maharashtra)	Ghataprabha, Malaprabha, Koyna, Bhima, Tungabhadra	Bay of Bengal (AP/Telangana); Nagarjuna Sagar Dam
Kaveri (Cauvery)	Brahmagiri Hills (Coorg, Karnataka)	Hemavati, Arkavati, Shimsha (left); Kabini, Bhavani, Amravati (right)	Bay of Bengal (TN); KRS Dam; Cauvery water dispute
Suvarnarekha	Ranchi Plateau (Jharkhand)	—	Bay of Bengal (Odisha/WB)
Brahmani	Junction of Sankh+South Koel (Jharkhand)	—	Bay of Bengal (Odisha)

River	Origin	Tributaries	Mouth/States
Baitarni	Eastern Ghats (Odisha)	—	Bay of Bengal (Odisha)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Godavari = Largest peninsular river | 'Dakshin Ganga' (Ganges of South)
 Hirakud Dam (Odisha) = longest dam in India — on Mahanadi
 Nagarjuna Sagar Dam = on Krishna River (Telangana/AP)
 KRS Dam (Krishnarajasagar) = on Kaveri River (Karnataka) — Cauvery dispute
 Tungabhadra (trib. of Krishna) → Hampi is on its banks
 Shivsamudram Waterfalls = on Kaveri River (Karnataka)
 Indravati Nat. Park = on Indravati River (Chhattisgarh); Project Tiger
 Koleroo Lake (AP) = freshwater lake formed at delta of Godavari+Krishna

West-Flowing Peninsular Rivers

River	Origin	Flow / Features	Mouth
Narmada	Amarkantak Plateau (MP)	Rift valley river (between Vindhya & Satpura); Dhuandhar Falls; Sardar Sarovar Dam; Indira Sagar Dam; Tawa (L.bank), Kolar (R.bank) tributaries	Gulf of Khambhat (Arabian Sea)
Tapti (Tapi)	Betul Plateau (MP)	Also rift valley (S of Satpura); parallel to Narmada	Gulf of Khambhat (Arabian Sea)
Luni	Aravalli (near Ajmer, Rajasthan)	Only river of Rajasthan that reaches sea; saline after Balotra	Rann of Kutch
Sabarmati	Udaipur (Aravalli, Rajasthan)	Ahmedabad, Gandhi Ashram on banks; Dharoi Dam	Gulf of Khambhat
Mahi	Vindhya Range (MP)	Crosses Tropic of Cancer twice; Kadana Dam	Gulf of Khambhat
Periyar	Cardamom Hills (Kerala)	Longest river of Kerala; Periyar NP (Tiger Reserve)	Arabian Sea
Bharathapuzha	Anaimalai Hills (Kerala)	2nd longest river of Kerala	Arabian Sea
Pamba	Kerala Highlands	Pamba falls into Vembanad Lake; Sabarimala Temple on banks	Vembanad Lake → Arabian Sea
Mandavi / Mahadayi	Western Ghats (Goa/Karnataka)	Panaji is on Mandavi River; casino boats here	Arabian Sea (Goa)
Zuari	Western Ghats (Goa)	Meets Mandavi; Old Goa between two rivers	Arabian Sea (Goa)
Sharavati	Sahyadri/Western Ghats (Karnataka)	Jog Falls (Gersoppa Falls) on Sharavati — highest plunge waterfall in India	Arabian Sea

Narmada & Tapti = west-flowing rift valley rivers (flow in grabens between parallel faults)

Narmada: Sardar Sarovar Dam (Gujarat) + Indira Sagar Dam (MP)

Mahi crosses Tropic of Cancer TWICE — unique feature

Jog Falls (Gersoppa Falls) = on Sharavati River, Karnataka = highest plunge waterfall (~253m)

Pamba River → Sabarimala Temple (in news for Supreme Court judgment)

Luni River = only river of Rajasthan; becomes saline/brackish after Balotra

Sabarmati Ashram (Gandhi) = on Sabarmati River, Ahmedabad

Zuari + Mandavi = rivers of Goa

CHAPTER 8: IMPORTANT LAKES OF INDIA

Lake	State	Type	River/Notes
Chilika Lake	Odisha	Brackish (Lagoon); largest brackish lake in India; Ramsar site	Bay of Bengal coast; flamingos; Irrawaddy dolphin
Vembanad Lake	Kerala	Brackish (Backwater); longest lake in India (~96km)	Pamba, Meenachil rivers; Kuttanad (below sea level farming)
Kolleru Lake	Andhra Pradesh	Freshwater; deltaic lake of Godavari+Krishna	Natural freshwater lake; Ramsar site
Pulicat Lake	Andhra Pradesh / Tamil Nadu	Brackish; 2nd largest saltwater lake	Flamingo Festival; Sriharikota (ISRO) is on a sandbar
Loktak Lake	Manipur	Freshwater + Phumdis (floating mass of vegetation)	Keibul Lamjao NP (floating NP); Sangai Deer
Wular Lake	J&K	Freshwater; largest freshwater lake in India	On Jhelum River
Dal Lake	J&K	Freshwater; famous houseboat lake	On Jhelum tributary; tourism
Pangong Tso	Ladakh (India+China)	Saline; changes color (blue-green); 60% in China	At ~4350m altitude; India-China LAC passes through it
Tso Moriri	Ladakh	High altitude lake	Ramsar site; wetland conservation
Sambhar Lake	Rajasthan	Saltwater; largest inland salt lake in India	Salt production; Ramsar site
Pushkar Lake	Rajasthan	Freshwater	Sacred; Brahma Temple; Camel Fair
Pichola Lake	Rajasthan (Udaipur)	Artificial	Famous tourist lake; Lake Palace hotel
Bhoj Tal (Upper/Lower Lake)	MP (Bhopal)	Artificial	Bhopal = 'City of Lakes'
Hussain Sagar	Telangana (Hyderabad)	Artificial	On Musi River tributary; Buddha statue in center
Govind Sagar	Himachal Pradesh	Artificial reservoir	Bhakra Nangal Dam on Sutlej River
Lonar Lake	Maharashtra	Saline + Alkaline; impact crater lake	Only hypervelocity impact crater in basaltic rock; Ramsar site
Shivajisagar / Koyna Reservoir	Maharashtra	Artificial	Koyna Dam on Krishna tributary
Deepor Beel	Assam	Freshwater; wetland	On Brahmaputra; Ramsar site; elephant habitat

Lake	State	Type	River/Notes
Renuka Lake	Himachal Pradesh	Natural; famous pilgrimage	Largest natural lake in HP
Sattal Lake	Uttarakhand (Nainital)	Freshwater; cluster of 7 lakes	Migratory birds
Kanwar Lake	Bihar	Oxbow lake on Gandak River	Wetland; water birds

EXAM FOCUS

Wular Lake = largest freshwater lake in India (J&K, on Jhelum)
 Chilika Lake = largest brackish water / coastal lagoon in India (Odisha)
 Sambhar = largest inland saltwater lake in India (Rajasthan)
 Vembanad = longest lake in India by length (~96 km)
 Lonar Lake = only meteorite impact crater lake in basaltic rock (Maharashtra)
 Keibul Lamjao NP = world's only floating National Park (on Loktak Lake, Manipur)
 Phumdis = floating mass of soil, vegetation on Loktak Lake
 Pangong Tso = 60% in China (in news during India-China Galwan crisis)
 Kolleru + Sambhar + Chilika = Ramsar wetland sites

CHAPTER 9: MAJOR DAMS OF INDIA

Dam	River	State	Notable Feature
Tehri Dam	Bhagirathi (Ganga)	Uttarakhand	Highest dam in India (~261m); largest reservoir
Bhakra Nangal	Sutlej	HP/Punjab border	Tallest gravity dam in Asia; Gobind Sagar reservoir
Hirakud	Mahanadi	Odisha	Longest dam in India (~4.8 km)
Sardar Sarovar	Narmada	Gujarat	Controversial; Narmada Bachao Andolan; 2nd largest in India
Indira Sagar	Narmada	MP	Largest reservoir in India by storage
Nagarjuna Sagar	Krishna	Telangana/AP	One of world's largest masonry dams
Krishna Raja Sagar (KRS)	Kaveri	Karnataka	Visvesvaraya Dam; water to Bengaluru/Mysuru
Idukki	Periyar	Kerala	Arch dam (largest in Asia); hydropower
Gandhi Sagar	Chambal	MP	Chambal Valley Project
Jawahar Sagar	Chambal	Rajasthan	Part of Chambal Valley Project
Rana Pratap Sagar	Chambal	Rajasthan	—
Tawa Dam	Tawa (trib. of Narmada)	MP	—
Koyna Dam	Koyna (trib. of Krishna)	Maharashtra	Reservoir: Shivajisagar; caused earthquake 1967
Tungabhadra Dam	Tungabhadra	Karnataka	Hampi area
Mettur Dam	Kaveri	Tamil Nadu	Oldest dam in South India
Rihand Dam	Rihand (trib. of Son)	UP	Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar — largest man-made lake (volume) in India
Nathpa Jhakri	Sutlej	HP	Largest hydroelectric project in India
Ranjit Sagar	Ravi	J&K	Thein Dam
Dulhasti	Chenab	J&K	—
Baglihar	Chenab	J&K	—

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Tehri = Tallest dam in India (~261m) | Bhakra = Tallest GRAVITY dam
Hirakud = Longest dam in India (~4.8 km)

Indira Sagar = Largest reservoir in India (by storage capacity)

Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar (Rihand Dam) = Largest man-made lake in India by volume/area

Idukki = Largest arch dam in Asia (Kerala)

Koyna earthquake 1967 = Reservoir-induced seismicity

All 3 Chambal dams (Gandhi Sagar + Rana Pratap + Jawahar Sagar) are in MP/Rajasthan

CHAPTER 10: NATIONAL PARKS, WILDLIFE & BIOSPHERE RESERVES

10.1 Major National Parks of India

National Park	State	Famous For
Jim Corbett NP	Uttarakhand	India's oldest NP (1936); Bengal Tiger; Project Tiger (1st)
Kaziranga NP	Assam	One-horned Rhinoceros (largest population); UNESCO WH; Brahmaputra
Sundarban NP	West Bengal	Royal Bengal Tiger; Mangroves; UNESCO WH; Gangetic Delta
Gir Forest NP	Gujarat	Only habitat of Asiatic Lion in wild; Sasan Gir
Keibul Lamjao NP	Manipur	World's only floating NP; Sangai/Eld's Deer; on Loktak Lake
Hemis NP	Ladakh (J&K)	Snow Leopard; largest NP in India
Periyar NP	Kerala	Elephants; Tigers; Periyar River; TR
Bandipur NP	Karnataka	Tigers; Elephants; adjoins Mudumalai & Nagarhole
Nagarhole NP	Karnataka	Elephants; Kabini River; Rajiv Gandhi NP
Pench NP	MP/Maharashtra border	Tigers; Kipling's Jungle Book setting
Kanha NP	MP	Tigers; Barasingha (hardground deer)
Bandhavgarh NP	MP	Highest tiger density in India
Panna NP	MP	Tigers; Ken River; TR
Nauradehi WS (MP)	MP	India's proposed cheetah reintroduction site
Sariska NP	Rajasthan	Tigers; Alwar district; TR
Ranthambore NP	Rajasthan	Tigers; Ranthambore Fort; TR
Keoladeo Ghana NP	Rajasthan	Siberian crane; migratory birds; UNESCO WH; Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary
Manas NP	Assam	Tiger + Rhinoceros + Elephant; UNESCO WH; Project Tiger; on Bhutan border
Indravati NP	Chhattisgarh	Wild Buffalo; on Indravati River; TR
Simlipal NP	Odisha	Tigers; Elephants; Barehipani Falls
Eravikulam NP	Kerala	Nilgiri Tahr; Anamudi peak
Silent Valley NP	Kerala	Lion-tailed Macaque; no roads inside
Great Himalayan NP	HP	UNESCO WH; Snow Leopard; Western Himalayan biodiversity
Dachigam NP	J&K	Hangul (Kashmir Stag)
Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary	Rajasthan	Migratory birds; UNESCO WH

National Park	State	Famous For
Fangpui (Phawngpui) Blue Mountain NP	Mizoram	Blue rocks; highest peak of Mizoram

🔥 EXAM FOCUS

Jim Corbett = India's FIRST National Park (1936); 1st Project Tiger park (1973)

Kaziranga = largest population of one-horned rhinos in the world

Gir = only habitat of Asiatic Lion

Keibul Lamjao = world's only floating National Park

Hemis = largest National Park in India (Ladakh)

Keoladeo Ghana = UNESCO WH; Siberian Crane migration destination

Manas NP spans India-Bhutan border (Royal Manas NP in Bhutan)

Sundarbans = largest mangrove + Bengal Tiger habitat; UNESCO WH

Simlipal NP = India's 2nd largest biosphere reserve

10.2 Tiger Reserves (Project Tiger — launched 1973)

India has the **highest number of wild tigers** in the world (>3,000 as of 2022). Project Tiger was launched in 1973 under PM Indira Gandhi. NTCA (National Tiger Conservation Authority) manages tiger reserves.

States with most Tiger Reserves: **Madhya Pradesh** → 'Tiger State of India'

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

India has 54 Tiger Reserves (as of 2023)

First Tiger Reserve = Jim Corbett (1973)

Maximum tigers = MP (Madhya Pradesh) — 'Tiger State'

Maharashtra's Umred-Pauni-Karhandla = Jai the Tiger

Orang NP (Assam) = Mini Kaziranga — rhinos + tigers

10.3 UNESCO Biosphere Reserves in India

Biosphere Reserve	State
Sundarbans	West Bengal
Gulf of Mannar	Tamil Nadu
Nilgiris	TN + Kerala + Karnataka
Nokrek	Meghalaya
Nanda Devi	Uttarakhand
Manas	Assam
Simlipal	Odisha
Dibru-Saikhowa	Assam
Dihang-Dibang	Arunachal Pradesh
Khangchendzonga	Sikkim

Biosphere Reserve	State
Panna	MP
Achanakmar-Amarkantak	MP + CG
Agasthyamalai	Kerala + TN
Great Nicobar	Andaman & Nicobar
Pachmarhi	MP
Kanha-Pench	MP

10.4 Ramsar Wetland Sites

India has **75+ Ramsar Sites** (as of 2023) — highest number in Asia. Key sites:

Ramsar Site	State	Notable Feature
Chilika Lake	Odisha	Largest coastal wetland; Irrawaddy dolphin; flamingo
Keoladeo Ghana	Rajasthan	Migratory birds; Siberian crane
Sambhar Lake	Rajasthan	Salt production; flamingo
Vembanad-Kol	Kerala	Largest wetland in India; backwaters
Wular Lake	J&K	Largest freshwater lake
Loktak Lake	Manipur	Floating phumdis
Harike Wetland	Punjab	Junction of Sutlej and Beas
Deepor Beel	Assam	Freshwater lake; elephants
Tso Moriri	Ladakh	High altitude wetland; migratory birds
Lonar Lake	Maharashtra	Unique meteor crater lake; saline + alkaline
Renuka Lake	Himachal	Smallest Ramsar site in India
Nalsarovar	Gujarat	Migratory birds; flamingo

EXAM FOCUS

India = Most Ramsar wetland sites in Asia

1st Ramsar sites in India: Chilika (Odisha) & Keoladeo (Rajasthan) — 1981

Ramsar Convention (1971) — signed at Ramsar, Iran

Renuka Lake (HP) = smallest Ramsar site in India

Vembanad-Kol (Kerala) = largest Ramsar site in India

Lonar Lake added 2020 — unique alkaline + saline + meteor crater

CHAPTER 11: POPULATION & SETTLEMENTS (OVERVIEW)

Aspect	Data / Facts
Census 2011 Population	121.07 crore (1.21 billion)
Decadal Growth Rate (2001-11)	17.64% (declined from 21.54% in 1991-2001)
Density (2011)	382 persons per sq km
Most populous state	UP (Uttar Pradesh)
Least populous state	Sikkim
Highest density	Bihar (1106/sq km)
Lowest density	Arunachal Pradesh (17/sq km)
Most literate state	Kerala (94%)
Least literate	Bihar (~61%)
Sex Ratio (2011)	940 females per 1000 males
Best sex ratio	Kerala (1084)
Worst sex ratio	Haryana (879)
Urban Population	31.16% (as per 2011)
India's population share (world)	~18% of world in ~2.4% of land

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

UPSC/UPPCS frequently asks: most populous, most dense, least dense states

India became world's most populous country (surpassing China) in 2023

UP = most populous state; Bihar = highest density; Arunachal = lowest density

Kerala = highest literacy + best sex ratio + highest life expectancy

As per India Census: rural population still ~69% despite urbanization

CHAPTER 12: WATERFALLS & OTHER IMPORTANT FACTS

12.1 Major Waterfalls

Waterfall	River	State	Height	Notes
Jog Falls (Gersoppa)	Sharavati	Karnataka	~253m	Highest plunge waterfall in India
Nohkalikai Falls	Near Cherrapunji	Meghalaya	~340m	India's tallest waterfall (free fall)
Dhuandhar Falls	Narmada	MP	~30m	'Smoke cascade'; near Bhedaghat, Jabalpur
Dudhsagar Falls	Mandavi	Goa/Karnataka	~310m	Milky white; on Konkan Railway line
Chitrakote Falls	Indravati	Chhattisgarh	~90m	Widest waterfall in India; 'India's Niagara'
Sivasamudram Falls	Kaveri	Karnataka	~98m	Hydropower; Bluff Island
Athirappilly Falls	Chalakudy	Kerala	~80m	Niagara of India (Kerala)
Barehipani Falls	Budhabalanga	Odisha	~399m	2nd highest waterfall; in Simlipal NP
Thalaiyar Falls	Manjalar	Tamil Nadu	~297m	Rat Tail Falls; deepest gorge in India

EXAM FOCUS

Jog/Gersoppa = Highest PLUNGE waterfall in India (Sharavati, Karnataka)

Nohkalikai = Highest TOTAL fall in India (Meghalaya, near Cherrapunji)

Dhuandhar Falls = Narmada River, MP (Bhedaghat — Jabalpur)

Chitrakote Falls = Widest waterfall in India (CG) — 'India's Niagara'

Dudhsagar = can be seen from Konkan Railway trains (Goa/Karnataka border)

12.2 India's Straits and Channels

Strait / Channel	Connects / Separates	Notes
Palk Strait	India and Sri Lanka	Between Gulf of Mannar and Bay of Bengal; Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu)
10° Channel	Little Andaman and Car Nicobar	Main division between Andaman and Nicobar groups
Duncan Passage	South Andaman and Little Andaman	
9° Channel	Lakshadweep & Minicoy	
8° Channel	Minicoy & Maldives	

Strait / Channel	Connects / Separates	Notes
Grand Channel	Great Nicobar & Sumatra	India's southernmost point near here (Indira Point)

12.3 India's Extreme Points

Direction	Point	Location
Northernmost	Indira Col	Siachen Glacier, J&K
Southernmost (mainland)	Cape Comorin (Kanyakumari)	Tamil Nadu — confluence of 3 seas
Southernmost (India incl. islands)	Indira Point / Pygmalion Point	Great Nicobar Island (submerged in 2004 Tsunami)
Easternmost	Kibithu (Kibitu)	Arunachal Pradesh
Westernmost	Sir Creek / Guhar Moti	Gujarat (Rann of Kutch)

EXAM FOCUS

Kanyakumari = southernmost tip of mainland India; 3 seas (Arabian Sea, Bay of Bengal, Indian Ocean) meet

Indira Point = India's southernmost point (Great Nicobar) — submerged 2004 Tsunami

Kibithu = easternmost point of India (Arunachal Pradesh)

Indira Col (or Dafadar) = northernmost point (disputed because Siachen)

CHAPTER 13: STATES & UNION TERRITORIES — EXAM REFERENCE

State/UT	Capital	Major River	State Animal	State Bird	National Park/WLS
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	Ganga, Yamuna, Ghaghra	Swamp Deer (Barasingha)	Sarus Crane	Dudhwa NP
Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal	Narmada, Tapti, Chambal	Barasingha (Hard Ground)	Indian Paradise Flycatcher	Kanha, Bandhavgarh, Panna NP
Maharashtra	Mumbai	Godavari, Krishna, Tapti	Giant Squirrel	Yellow-footed Green Pigeon	Sanjay Gandhi NP
Rajasthan	Jaipur	Chambal, Luni, Banas	Chinkara	Great Indian Bustard	Ranthambore, Sariska NP
Gujarat	Gandhinagar	Sabarmati, Mahi, Narmada	Asiatic Lion	Greater Flamingo	Gir Forest NP
Bihar	Patna	Ganga, Son, Gandak, Kosi	Gaur	House Sparrow	Valmiki NP
West Bengal	Kolkata	Ganga/Hooghly, Teesta	Fishing Cat	White-breasted Kingfisher	Sundarbans NP, Gorumara NP
Assam	Dispur	Brahmaputra, Barak	Indian One-horned Rhino	White-winged Wood Duck	Kaziranga NP, Manas NP
Karnataka	Bengaluru	Krishna, Kaveri, Tungabhadra	Indian Elephant	Indian Roller	Bandipur, Nagarhole NP
Andhra Pradesh	Amaravati	Krishna, Godavari	Blackbuck	Rose-ringed Parakeet	Sri Venkateswara NP
Telangana	Hyderabad	Krishna, Godavari, Musi	Spotted Deer (Chital)	Palapitta (Blue Rock Pigeon)	Mrugavani NP
Tamil Nadu	Chennai	Kaveri, Palar, Vaigai	Nilgiri Tahr	Emerald Dove	Mudumalai NP, Anamalai NP
Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram	Periyar, Pamba, Bharathapuzha	Indian Elephant	Great Hornbill	Periyar NP, Silent Valley NP
Odisha	Bhubaneswar	Mahanadi, Brahmani, Baitarni	Sambar Deer	Indian Roller (Neelakantha)	Simlipal NP, Bhitarkanika NP
Jharkhand	Ranchi	Damodar, Subanarekha	Indian Elephant	Koel (Asian Koel)	Betla NP
Chhattisgarh	Raipur	Mahanadi, Indravati, Sheonath	Wild Buffalo	Hill Myna	Indravati NP, Kanger Valley NP

State/UT	Capital	Major River	State Animal	State Bird	National Park/WLS
Punjab	Chandigarh	Sutlej, Beas, Ravi	Blackbuck	Northern Goshawk	Harike Wetland
Haryana	Chandigarh	Yamuna, Ghaggar	Blackbuck	Black Francolin	Sultanpur Bird Sanctuary
Himachal Pradesh	Shimla	Sutlej, Ravi, Beas, Chenab	Snow Leopard	Western Tragopan	Great Himalayan NP, Pin Valley NP
Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Ganga (Bhagirathi+Alaknanda), Yamuna	Musk Deer	Himalayan Monal	Jim Corbett NP, Nanda Devi BR
J&K (UT)	Srinagar (S), Jammu (W)	Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Indus	Hangul (Kashmir Stag)	Black-necked Crane	Dachigam NP, Hemis NP (Ladakh)
Sikkim	Gangtok	Teesta, Rangit	Red Panda	Blood Pheasant	Khangchend zonga NP
Meghalaya	Shillong	Uiam, Shillong	Clouded Leopard	Hill Myna	Balpakram NP
Arunachal Pradesh	Itanagar	Brahmaputra (Siang/Dihang), Subansiri	Gayal (Mithun)	Great Hornbill	Namdapha NP
Nagaland	Kohima	Dhansiri, Doyang	Mithun	Blyth's Tragopan	Intanki NP
Manipur	Imphal	Imphal, Barak	Sangai Deer	Hume's Pheasant	Keibul Lamjao NP
Mizoram	Aizawl	Tlawng, Kolodyne	Malayan Giant Squirrel	Mrs Hume's Pheasant	Phawngpui Blue Mountain NP
Tripura	Agartala	Haora, Gumti	Phayre's Langur	Green Imperial Pigeon	Clouded Leopard NP
Goa	Panaji	Mandavi, Zuari	Gaur	Black-crested Bulbul	Bhagwan Mahavir WS
Lakshadweep (UT)	Kavaratti	—	Butterfly Fish	Noddy Tern	—
A&N Islands (UT)	Port Blair	—	Dugong (Sea Cow)	Andaman Wood Pigeon	Campbell Bay NP, Galathea NP
Delhi (UT)	New Delhi	Yamuna	Nilgai	House Sparrow	Asola Bhatti Wildlife Sanctuary
Chandigarh (UT)	Chandigarh	—	Indian Grey Mongoose	Indian Grey Hornbill	—

EXAM FOCUS

Chandigarh = shared capital of Punjab and Haryana

Dehradun = capital of Uttarakhand (shifted from Uttarkashi)
MP and CG share a border; CG was carved out of MP in 2000
Jharkhand = carved out of Bihar in 2000 | Uttarakhand = from UP in 2000
Goa = smallest state by area | Sikkim = least population
UP = largest state by population | Rajasthan = largest state by area

CHAPTER 14: ENVIRONMENT — LAWS, CONVENTIONS & GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

14.1 Constitutional Provisions on Environment

Article	Provision
Art. 48-A (DPSP)	State shall endeavour to protect and improve environment and safeguard forests and wildlife
Art. 51-A(g) (FD)	Fundamental Duty of citizens to protect environment, forests, rivers, wildlife
Art. 21	Right to Life includes right to live in clean/healthy environment (SC expanded)
Art. 246, 7th Schedule	Environment is in Concurrent List (both Centre and States can legislate)
100th Amendment (2015)	Land Boundary Agreement with Bangladesh — exchange of enclaves

14.2 Important Environmental Laws

Law / Act	Year	Key Provision
Wildlife Protection Act	1972	Protection of wild animals, birds, plants; schedules I-VI; NBWL
Water (Prevention & Control of Pollution) Act	1974	CPCB and SPCBs established
Forest (Conservation) Act	1980	Restrictions on diversion of forest land for non-forest use
Air (Prevention & Control of Pollution) Act	1981	Standards for air quality; CPCB
Environment (Protection) Act	1986	Umbrella act; post-Bhopal Gas Tragedy; Central Gov power to regulate
Biological Diversity Act	2002	Access and benefit sharing; NBA, SBBs, BMCs
Forest Rights Act (FRA)	2006	Rights of tribal communities over forest land/resources
National Green Tribunal Act	2010	NGT established; fast-track environmental cases

14.3 International Conventions

Convention	Year	Subject
Ramsar Convention	1971	Protection of Wetlands of International Importance
CITES	1973	International trade in endangered species (flora & fauna)
Bonn Convention (CMS)	1979	Migratory species conservation
Vienna Convention + Montreal Protocol	1985 / 1987	Ozone layer protection; phase-out of CFCs
Basel Convention	1989	Control of hazardous wastes & disposal

Convention	Year	Subject
Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)	1992	Biodiversity conservation; access and benefit sharing
UNFCCC	1992	Framework for combating climate change
Kyoto Protocol	1997	GHG reduction targets (developed countries)
Paris Agreement	2015	Limit global warming to 1.5-2°C above pre-industrial levels; NDCs
Kunming-Montreal GBF	2022	Biodiversity targets; 30x30 protection goal

14.4 Government Schemes Related to Environment & Geography

Scheme	Key Details
Project Tiger (1973)	Conservation of Bengal Tiger; 54 reserves; NTCA oversight
Project Elephant (1992)	Elephant conservation; 33 elephant reserves
Project Crocodile (1975)	3 crocodile species protection (Mugger, Saltwater, Gharial)
Project Dolphin (2020)	Gangetic Dolphin (river) + Oceanic Dolphin conservation
CAMPA	Compensatory Afforestation Fund; Rs 40,000 cr+ collected
National Water Mission	One of 8 missions under National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC 2008)
Namami Gange Programme	Integrated Ganga River rejuvenation (₹20,000 crore); 2015
AMRUT	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation; urban water infrastructure
PM Van Dhan Yojana	Forest produce for tribal livelihoods
Cheetah Reintroduction	Cheetahs from Namibia introduced at Kuno NP (MP) — 2022

EXAM FOCUS

India's National Animal = Bengal Tiger | National Bird = Indian Peacock | National Flower = Lotus
National Aquatic Animal = Ganges River Dolphin | National Tree = Banyan | National Fruit = Mango
Project Tiger = 1973 (India's first major conservation project); PM Indira Gandhi
Cheetah Reintroduction = Kuno NP, MP (2022) — Namibia + South Africa cheetahs
Gharial = Critically Endangered; found in Chambal, Girwa (Katarniaghat WS, UP), Mahanadi
Great Indian Bustard = Critically Endangered; Rajasthan; affected by power lines

CHAPTER 15: WORLD GEOGRAPHY — QUICK REFERENCE

15.1 Continents

Continent	Area (sq km)	Largest Country	Highest Point	Lowest Point	Notes
Asia	44.6 million	Russia	Everest (8848m, Nepal/China)	Dead Sea	Largest continent; most populous
Africa	30.4 million	Algeria	Kilimanjaro (5895m, Tanzania)	Lake Assal (Djibouti)	2nd largest; Sahara (largest hot desert)
North America	24.7 million	Canada	Denali (6190m, Alaska/USA)	Death Valley (California)	Includes Central America
South America	17.8 million	Brazil	Aconcagua (6961m, Argentina)	Laguna del Carbón	Amazon River; Atacama Desert
Antarctica	14 million	—	Vinson Massif (4892m)	—	Coldest; 70% of world's fresh water (ice)
Europe	10.5 million	Russia (partly)	Mont Blanc (4808m, France/Italy)	Caspian Sea shore	Smallest continent (excl Australia)
Australia	7.7 million	Australia	Mawson Peak / Mt Kosciuszko	Lake Eyre	Smallest continent; also a country

15.2 Major Deserts of the World

Desert	Continent	Type	Key Features
Sahara	Africa	Hot	Largest hot desert; covers ~9.2 million sq km; 11 countries
Arabian Desert	Asia	Hot	Rub al Khali (Empty Quarter) — largest continuous sand desert
Gobi	Asia	Cold	Mongolia + China; rocky desert; fossil-rich
Patagonian	S America	Cold	Argentina; largest cold desert in S America
Great Australian	Australia	Hot	Sandy; largest desert in Australia

Desert	Continent	Type	Key Features
Atacama	S America (Chile)	Cold coastal	Driest non-polar desert; Chilean coast
Kalahari	S Africa	Semi-arid	Botswana + S Africa; wildlife rich
Thar	S Asia (India/Pak)	Hot	Great Indian Desert; 7th largest
Antarctic	Antarctica	Cold	Largest cold desert in world (~14 million sq km)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Largest hot desert = Sahara | Largest cold desert = Antarctic

Driest desert (non-polar) = Atacama (Chile)

Arabian desert contains Rub al Khali — world's largest unbroken sand sea

Gobi Desert = Mongolia/China — fossil discoveries (dinosaur eggs)

Thar = 7th largest desert in world; 'Sea of Sand' (Marusthali)

15.3 Major Mountain Ranges of the World

Mountain Range	Continent	Highest Peak	Notes
Himalayas	Asia	Everest (8848m)	Includes K2 (2nd), Kanchenjunga (3rd); youngest fold mountains
Andes	South America	Aconcagua (6961m)	Longest mountain range; Pacific coast
Rockies	North America	Elbert (4399m)	Western USA/Canada; Continental Divide
Alps	Europe	Mont Blanc (4808m)	France/Switzerland/Italy; Rhine, Rhone, Po rivers originate
Atlas	Africa	Toubkal (4167m)	NW Africa; Morocco/Algeria/Tunisia
Ural Mountains	Asia/Europe boundary	Narodnaya (1895m)	Divides Asia from Europe
Caucasus	Europe/Asia	Elbrus (5642m)	Highest peak in Europe (if Caucasus = Europe)
Appalachian	North America	Mitchell (2037m)	Eastern USA; oldest mountain range in N America
Great Dividing Range	Australia	Kosciuszko (2228m)	Australia's main mountain barrier

15.4 Ocean Currents

Current	Ocean	Type (W/C)	Effect
Gulf Stream	Atlantic	Warm	Keeps W Europe mild; world's strongest ocean current
Labrador Current	Atlantic	Cold	Meets Gulf Stream; fog off Newfoundland; good fishing
Canary Current	Atlantic	Cold	SW of Europe/NW Africa; N-bound cold current
N Atlantic Drift	Atlantic	Warm	Extension of Gulf Stream; keeps UK warm
Brazil Current	Atlantic	Warm	South American coast; warm
Benguela Current	Atlantic	Cold	W coast of S Africa; upwelling; rich fish
Kuroshio Current	Pacific	Warm	Japan; NE Pacific; warm
North Pacific Current	Pacific	Warm	Extension of Kuroshio
California Current	Pacific	Cold	W USA coast; cold
Peru/Humboldt Current	Pacific	Cold	W South America; anchoveta fishing; El Nino affects it
Indian Ocean Currents	Indian Ocean	Seasonal	Reverse with monsoon; N. Equatorial, Somali Current (changes direction with monsoon)

EXAM FOCUS

Warm currents flow from equator to poles; Cold currents from poles to equator
 Warm current coasts = moist/mild climate | Cold current coasts = fog/desert (Atacama, Namib)
 Gulf Stream = warms Western Europe | Labrador = creates Grand Banks fishing
 Peru/Humboldt Current → disrupted by El Nino → drought in India
 Somali Current (Indian Ocean) reverses direction with monsoon season

15.5 Major Rivers of the World

River	Continent	Length	Key Facts
Nile	Africa	~6650 km	Longest river in world; flows N into Mediterranean
Amazon	S America	~6400 km	Largest by discharge; tropical rainforest basin
Yangtze	Asia	~6300 km	Longest river in Asia; 3 Gorges Dam
Mississippi-Missouri	N America	~6275 km	Longest in N America
Yenisei	Asia	~5539 km	Siberia; flows into Arctic Ocean
Yellow River (Huang He)	Asia	~5464 km	Cradle of Chinese civilization; 'China's Sorrow'
Ob-Irtysh	Asia	~5410 km	Siberia; drains into Arctic

River	Continent	Length	Key Facts
Congo	Africa	~4700 km	2nd largest by discharge; deepest river
Amur	Asia	~4444 km	Russia-China border
Mekong	Asia	~4350 km	SE Asia; passes 6 countries; Lancang in China
Volga	Europe	~3690 km	Longest river in Europe; Russia; Caspian Sea
Rhine	Europe	~1230 km	W Europe; major navigable river; Alps to North Sea
Danube	Europe	~2860 km	2nd longest in Europe; flows E into Black Sea
Zambezi	Africa	~2574 km	Victoria Falls; Mozambique channel
Irrawaddy	Asia	~2170 km	Myanmar; drains into Andaman Sea

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Nile (Africa) = Longest river in world (~6650 km)

Amazon (S America) = Largest river by volume/discharge

Yangtze (China) = Longest river in Asia; Three Gorges Dam on it

Volga (Russia) = Longest river in Europe

Congo (Africa) = Deepest river in the world

Victoria Falls = on Zambezi River (Zimbabwe/Zambia border) — largest waterfall by volume

CHAPTER 16: MASTER ONE-LINERS FOR LAST-MINUTE REVISION

India — Basic Geography

- ⚡ India's Standard Meridian = 82.5°E → passes through Mirzapur (UP)
- ⚡ India's latitudinal extent: $8^{\circ}4'\text{N}$ to $37^{\circ}6'\text{N}$ (mainland); Longitudinal: $68^{\circ}7'\text{E}$ to $97^{\circ}25'\text{E}$
- ⚡ N-S distance = 3,214 km; E-W distance = 2,933 km
- ⚡ India is in Northern + Eastern hemisphere
- ⚡ Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N) passes through 8 states: Guj, Raj, MP, CG, Jharkhand, WB, Tripura, Mizoram
- ⚡ IST = GMT + 5:30 hours (82.5°E Standard Meridian)

Mountains & Passes

- ⚡ Highest peak in India = K2 (if J&K claimed) OR Kanchenjunga (8586m) in Indian territory
- ⚡ Highest peak in Peninsular India = Anaimudi (2695m) — Western Ghats, Kerala
- ⚡ Highest peak in Aravalli = Guru Shikhar (1722m) — Rajasthan
- ⚡ Aravalli = Oldest mountain range in India
- ⚡ Western Ghats + Eastern Ghats meet at Nilgiris (TN/Kerala)
- ⚡ Satpura = between Narmada (N) and Tapti (S)
- ⚡ Nanda Devi (7816m) = Highest peak in India in fully Indian territory (Uttarakhand)

Rivers

- ⚡ Ganga = National River; Gangetic Dolphin = National Aquatic Animal
- ⚡ Yamuna = longest tributary of Ganga
- ⚡ Kosi = Sorrow of Bihar (frequent flooding)
- ⚡ Godavari = Dakshin Ganga (largest peninsular river)
- ⚡ Narmada + Tapti = only major west-flowing rift valley rivers
- ⚡ Mahi = crosses Tropic of Cancer TWICE
- ⚡ Jog Falls (Sharavati, Karnataka) = highest plunge waterfall in India
- ⚡ Brahmaputra = world's largest sediment-carrying river; Majuli = largest river island
- ⚡ Indus Waters Treaty (1960) = India gets E rivers; Pakistan gets W rivers
- ⚡ Chambal = originates from Vindhya Range (Janapav Hill, MP)
- ⚡ Sabarmati = Gandhi Ashram at Ahmedabad; flows into Gulf of Khambhat
- ⚡ Luni = only river of Rajasthan reaching sea (becomes saline after Balotra)
- ⚡ Sharavati = Jog Falls | Narmada = Dhuandhar Falls (Jabalpur/Bhedaghat)

Soils & Forests

- ⚡ Black soil = best for cotton; self-ploughing; from Deccan basalt
- ⚡ Laterite soil = high rainfall areas; leaching removes Ca and Si; Fe and Al remain
- ⚡ Alluvial soil = most widespread in India; most fertile; khadar > bangar
- ⚡ Sundarbans = largest mangrove forest in the world
- ⚡ Western Ghats = UNESCO World Heritage Biodiversity Hotspot
- ⚡ Mawsynram (Meghalaya) = wettest place in India and world
- ⚡ Largest state by forest area = Madhya Pradesh

Lakes & Dams

- ⚡ Wular Lake (J&K) = largest freshwater lake in India
- ⚡ Chilika Lake (Odisha) = largest brackish water lagoon in India; 1st Ramsar site
- ⚡ Sambhar Lake (Rajasthan) = largest inland saltwater lake
- ⚡ Loktak Lake (Manipur) + Keibul Lamjao NP = world's only floating national park
- ⚡ Lonar Lake (Maharashtra) = meteorite crater lake; saline + alkaline
- ⚡ Pangong Tso (Ladakh) = 60% in China; ~4350m altitude
- ⚡ Tehri Dam = highest dam in India (~261m) | Hirakud = longest dam
- ⚡ Bhakra Nangal = tallest gravity dam in Asia; reservoir = Gobind Sagar
- ⚡ Indira Sagar Dam (Narmada, MP) = largest reservoir in India by capacity

Wildlife & Environment

- ⚡ Jim Corbett = India's first national park (1936); 1st Project Tiger park (1973)
- ⚡ Kaziranga = largest population of one-horned rhinos; UNESCO WH
- ⚡ Gir Forest = only habitat of Asiatic Lion in wild
- ⚡ Keibul Lamjao NP = world's only floating NP (Manipur)
- ⚡ Barren Island = India's only active volcano (Andaman)
- ⚡ Narcondam Island = dormant volcano (Andaman)
- ⚡ 10° channel = divides Andaman from Nicobar
- ⚡ Lakshadweep = coral islands; 36 islands; smallest UT; 9° channel separates from Minicoy
- ⚡ India has 54 Tiger Reserves + 75+ Ramsar Sites
- ⚡ Project Tiger = 1973 | Project Elephant = 1992 | Project Crocodile = 1975
- ⚡ Cheetah reintroduction = Kuno NP, Madhya Pradesh (2022)

Neighbors & Borders

- ⚡ Bangladesh = longest land border with India
- ⚡ China shares border with 5 states: J&K, HP, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal

- ⚡ Treaty of Sugauli (1816) = Anglo-Nepalese War; Kali River = W Nepal boundary
- ⚡ 100th Constitutional Amendment (2015) = India-Bangladesh land boundary agreement
- ⚡ Manas NP (Assam) extends into Bhutan as Royal Manas NP
- ⚡ Kalapani = Uttarakhand (Pithoragarh district); disputed with Nepal
- ⚡ Mount Saramati = highest peak of Nagaland (Naga Hills)
- ⚡ Palk Strait separates India from Sri Lanka; Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu) = limestone shoals

END OF DOCUMENT — BEST OF LUCK FOR YOUR EXAMINATION!

INDIAN GEOGRAPHY

Comprehensive Exam-Oriented Study Notes

Allahabad High Court RO | UPPCS | SSC | UPSC Prelims | State PCS

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CHAPTER 1: INDIA — BASIC FACTS & LOCATION

1.1 India's Position in the World

India lies in the **Northern** and **Eastern** hemispheres of the globe.

Aspect	Details
Latitudinal Extent (Mainland)	8°4'N to 37°6'N
Longitudinal Extent	68°7'E to 97°25'E
North-South Extent	3,214 km
East-West Extent	2,933 km
Lat/Long Difference	Both ~29° (interesting coincidence!)
Hemisphere	Northern + Eastern
Area	~32.8 lakh sq km (7th largest country)
World Position	2nd most populous; 7th largest by area

Why East-West Extent < North-South Despite Equal Degrees?

Longitude lines converge towards the poles. Therefore, 1° of longitude represents a **shorter distance** at higher latitudes than near the equator. India's eastern states are at higher latitudes — so the actual km distance (2,933 km) is less than the north-south extent (3,214 km), even though the angular difference (~29°) is the same.

EXAM FOCUS

Q: Latitudinal/Longitudinal extent of India?

Q: North-South vs East-West extent — which is more and why?

Q: In which hemispheres does India lie?

Trick: Lat difference = Long difference ≈ 29°; but N-S > E-W in km

1.2 India as a Tropical Nation

Despite extending up to 37°N (which lies in the warm temperate zone), India is classified as a **Tropical Nation**. Two key reasons:

Himalayas as a barrier — The Himalayas block cold Siberian (Tertiary) winds from reaching India, preventing the extreme cold typical of other temperate regions at similar latitudes.

Monsoon Winds — India experiences monsoonal rainfall driven by seasonal wind reversal, which is a characteristic feature of Tropical regions, not Temperate ones.

Non-geographic evidence: India's disease patterns, dietary habits, festivals, and cultural traits align with tropical nations globally.

EXAM FOCUS

Q: Is India a Tropical or Temperate nation? Why?

Answer: Tropical — due to Himalayas blocking cold winds + monsoonal climate

1.3 Standard Meridian & Indian Standard Time (IST)

India's longitudinal extent is 29° (~2 hours). This debate is ongoing on whether India needs **two time zones**.

Aspect	Detail
Standard Meridian	82.5°E ($82^\circ30'\text{E}$)
IST = GMT +	+ 5 hours 30 minutes
Passes through	Mirzapur (UP) — also called 'Clock Tower of India'
Reason for single time zone	Avoid administrative complexity, railway signal conflicts, national unity
Countries with similar size & multiple zones	USA (6 zones), Russia (11 zones), China (uses 1 zone despite size)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Standard Meridian = 82.5°E passes through Allahabad (Mirzapur district), UP

IST = UTC + 5:30

Arguments FOR two zones: NE states suffer daylight wastage, energy loss, disrupted circadian rhythm

Arguments AGAINST: Railway safety (collision risk), administrative cost, national unity concerns

1.4 Tropic of Cancer — States it Passes Through

The Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N) passes through **8 Indian states**. Remember with mnemonic: '**Mit Ra Par Gam Chha Jha**' (or: M-T-P-R-G-M-C-Z-J)

Sequence (West to East)	State
1	Gujarat
2	Rajasthan (touches southern tip only)
3	Madhya Pradesh
4	Chhattisgarh
5	Jharkhand
6	West Bengal
7	Tripura
8	Mizoram

🔥 EXAM FOCUS

Q: How many states does the Tropic of Cancer pass through? → 8 states

Q: Which states? → Gujarat, Rajasthan, MP, CG, Jharkhand, WB, Tripura, Mizoram

Mnemonic: Gu Ra Ma Chha Jha Pa Tri Mi

Note: The line enters India from west (Gujarat) to east (Mizoram)

1.5 Important Latitudinal Reference Line across India

A useful north-to-south alignment of key cities:

Shimla (Himachal Pradesh) — Northernmost reference

Delhi (National Capital)

Bhopal (MP Capital)

These cities lie on roughly the same meridian — showing India's vast N-S extent

CHAPTER 2: INDIA'S NEIGHBORS & INTERNATIONAL BOUNDARIES

2.1 Neighboring Countries — Quick Overview

Country	Border States	Special Notes
Pakistan	Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, J&K	Longest land border (3,323 km); Radcliffe Line (1947); Kori Creek dispute; Siachin issue
China	J&K, Himachal, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal	LAC (Line of Actual Control); Tibet Autonomous Region; Aksai Chin dispute
Nepal	Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, WB, Sikkim	Open border (Treaty of Sugauli 1816); Kalapani dispute; Nepal-India Treaty
Bhutan	Assam, Sikkim, Arunachal, WB	Friendly relations; Doklam issue (2017); Manas NP spans border
Bangladesh	WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura	Longest border ~4,156 km; Enclave exchange (100th Amendment)
Myanmar	Arunachal, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram	Natural border (Patkai Hills, Naga Hills, Mizo Hills, Lushai Hills)
Afghanistan	PoK (via Wakhan corridor)	India-Afg border through Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir
Sri Lanka	(Maritime boundary)	Palk Strait separates the two; Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu)
Maldives	(Maritime boundary)	8° channel between Maldives and Minicoy Island

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

China shares border with 5 Indian states: J&K, HP, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh

Bangladesh shares border with 5 states: WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura

Nepal shares border with 5 states: Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, WB, Sikkim

Myanmar shares border with 4 states: Arunachal, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram

Pakistan shares border with 4 states/UTs: Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, J&K

2.2 India-Nepal Border: Kalapani Dispute

Treaty of Sugauli (1816) — signed after Anglo-Nepalese War — demarcated the Kali River as Nepal's western boundary. However, the river changed course over time, leading to a **boundary dispute** over the Kalapani region.

Kalapani is located in **Pithoragarh district, Uttarakhand**

Currently administered by India; Nepal claims it in their political maps

Kailash Mansarovar Yatra route passes through this region

India-Nepal border largely follows the **Shivalik Range** (E to W)

2.3 India-Myanmar Border

This is a **natural border** formed by the **Purvanchal (Eastern) Hills**:

Patkai Bum hills — Arunachal Pradesh

Naga Hills — Nagaland (Highest peak: **Mount Saramati**)

Manipur Hills (Mani Hills) — Manipur → Location of **Loktak Lake** and **Keibul Lamjao NP**

Mizo Hills and Lushai Hills — Mizoram (Blue mountains due to blue-colored rocks → **Phawngpui Blue Mountain NP**)

A river originates from Patkai: **Chindwin River** → tributary of **Irrawaddy River** (Myanmar)

EXAM FOCUS

Mount Saramati = Highest peak of Nagaland (on Naga Hills)

Keibul Lamjao NP → only floating national park in the world → on Loktak Lake → famous for Sangai Deer

Irrawaddy Dolphin = Brackish water dolphin | Gangetic Dolphin = Fresh water dolphin

Phawngpui Blue Mountain NP — Mizoram

2.4 India-Bhutan Border

India and Bhutan share a friendly border along Assam, Sikkim, Arunachal Pradesh, and West Bengal.

Manas National Park (Assam) extends into Bhutan as **Royal Manas National Park**

Doklam — A tri-junction area (India-Bhutan-China) that was a major standoff point in 2017

Bhutan is known for its GNH (Gross National Happiness) index and strong environmental commitment

2.5 India-Bangladesh Border: The Enclave Exchange

The **100th Constitutional Amendment Act (2015)** enabled exchange of enclaves between India and Bangladesh.

Bangladesh has the **longest** land border with India (~4,156 km)

India-Bangladesh border passes through WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura

EXAM FOCUS

100th Amendment — for land boundary agreement with Bangladesh (enclave exchange)

Bangladesh has longest land border with India among all neighbors

CHAPTER 3: PHYSICAL DIVISIONS OF INDIA

India's terrain can be divided into six major physiographic divisions:

Division	Key Features	Area
1. Himalayan Mountains	Young fold mountains; N boundary; arc shape	~5 lakh sq km
2. Northern Plains	Alluvial; most fertile; densely populated	~7 lakh sq km
3. Peninsular Plateau	Oldest landmass; stable; 600m avg elevation	~16 lakh sq km
4. Coastal Plains	West & East coasts; fishing; ports	~1.5 lakh sq km
5. Thar Desert	Arid; NW India; NW states	~1.75 lakh sq km
6. Islands	Andaman & Nicobar + Lakshadweep	~8,000 sq km

3.1 The Himalayas

Formation of the Himalayas

The Himalayas were formed by the **collision of the Indian Plate with the Eurasian Plate**. This is a convergent boundary — but unlike typical ocean-continent convergence, here **two continental plates collided**.

~85 million years ago, the Indian Peninsula broke away from Madagascar and started moving northward

The Indian Plate moved at very high speed, causing it to **lock under** the Eurasian Plate (NOT full subduction)

This caused **doubling of Earth's crust** (why there is no volcanic activity in Himalayas but high earthquake risk)

Multiple collision events = **series of parallel ranges** → not one range, but several

Himalayas are **Fold Mountains** (not volcanic)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Himalayas = Fold Mountains formed by Indian Plate + Eurasian Plate collision

No volcanoes in Himalayas — because crust doubled (magma cannot rise)

High earthquake risk due to continuing plate movement

Himalayas are youngest mountain range in India (~55 million years old)

Indian Plate was part of Gondwana Land originally

Divisions of the Himalayas (North to South)

Range	Also Known As	Avg Altitude	Key Features
Greater Himalayas	Himadri	6,000+ m	Highest peaks; Mt Everest, K2, Kanchenjunga; perpetual snow

Range	Also Known As	Avg Altitude	Key Features
Lesser Himalayas	Himachal	1,000–4,500 m	Shimla, Mussoorie, Nainital, Darjeeling; hill stations
Outer Himalayas	Shivalik	900–1,100 m	Youngest; youngest sedimentary; prone to erosion

Divisions of Himalayas (West to East)

Region	Location	Key Points
Punjab Himalaya	Between Indus and Sutlej	Dhauladhar, Pir Panjal ranges
Kumaon Himalaya	Between Sutlej and Kali	Nanda Devi (highest peak in India in open area — 7816m)
Nepal Himalaya	Between Kali and Teesta	Mt Everest (8848m), Kanchenjunga
Assam Himalaya	Between Teesta and Dihang	Namcha Barwa peak; syntaxial bend

Important Himalayan Passes

Pass	State/Location	Connects	Importance
Karakoram Pass	Ladakh (J&K)	India–China (Xinjiang)	Highest motorable pass; Silk Route
Zoji La	J&K	Srinagar to Ladakh	NH-1D; strategic pass; closed in winter
Rohtang Pass	HP (between Kullu & Lahaul-Spiti)	Manali to Keylong	Alternate: Atal Tunnel (2020)
Baralacha La	HP	Lahaul to Ladakh	On Manali-Leh Highway
Shipki La	HP	India–China (Tibet)	Sutlej river enters India here
Nathu La	Sikkim	India–China (Tibet)	Reopened for trade 2006
Bomdi La	Arunachal Pradesh	India–China (Tibet)	Strategic importance (1962 War)
Diphu Pass	Arunachal	India–Myanmar–China trijunction	Tri-junction point

EXAM FOCUS

Highest motorable pass in India: Khardung La (Ladakh) at ~5,359m

Atal Tunnel: Opened 2020; bypasses Rohtang Pass; world's longest road tunnel above 10,000 ft

Nathu La: Important for India-China border trade (Sikkim)

Shipki La: Sutlej enters India through this pass

Zoji La: Key pass connecting Kashmir Valley to Ladakh

3.2 Northern Plains (Indo-Gangetic Plains)

Also called: **Great Plains / Aggradational Plains / Northern Plains**. Formed by alluvial deposits of Himalayan rivers over millions of years.

Average elevation: **~200 m** above sea level (Ambala Ridge: 291m — watershed between Indus & Ganga drainage)

Stretches from Punjab in the west to Assam in the east (~2,400 km long, 240–320 km wide)

Types of Land in the Plains

Type	Description	Location/Features
Bhabar	Coarse gravel/pebble belt at foothills	8–16 km wide; rivers disappear underground; dry zone
Tarai	Wet marshy belt south of Bhabar	Streams reappear; dense vegetation; wildlife; good for farming
Bangar	Old alluvium (older deposits, elevated)	Higher areas; less fertile; kankars (lime nodules) present
Khadar	New alluvium (newer deposits, low-lying)	Near rivers; very fertile; floods annually; best farming

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Bhabar → Tarai → Bangar → Khadar (North to South sequence near Himalayas)

Khadar = most fertile soil — renewed every flood season

Bangar = older alluvium — contains Kankars (impure lime concretions)

UPSC/UPPCS repeatedly asks: What is Bhabar? What is Tarai? Sequence?

Sub-Divisions of Northern Plains (Doabs)

Doab (Interfluve)	Between Rivers	Location
Sindh Sagar Doab	Indus & Jhelum	Punjab (now Pakistan mostly)
Chaj Doab	Jhelum & Chenab	Punjab
Rechna Doab	Chenab & Ravi	Punjab
Bari Doab	Ravi & Beas	Punjab
Bist Doab / Jullundur Doab	Beas & Sutlej	Punjab (India side)
Yamuna-Ghaggar Doab	Yamuna & Ghaggar	Haryana Plains

Regional Sub-Plains of Gangetic Plains

Region	Location	Rivers/Features
Rohelkhand Plains	W UP — Ramganga basin	Named after Rohilla tribe
Yamuna-Ganga Doab	Between Yamuna & Ganga	Most important agricultural area
Yamuna-Chambal Doab	Between Yamuna & Chambal	Central UP/Rajasthan
Awadh Plains	Between Gomti & Ghaghra	Central UP — Lucknow region

Region	Location	Rivers/Features
Mithila Plains	Between Gandak & Kosi	Bihar — language: Maithili; Sita Mata connection
Magadh Plains	South of Son River	Bihar — ancient Magadha empire
Par Delta	Lower Ganga plains	West Bengal — deltaic region
Rar Plains	Adjacent to Chhota Nagpur	Laterite deposits; separates plateau from plains
Deltaic Plains	Ganga-Brahmaputra delta	Largest delta in world; Sundarbans

EXAM FOCUS

Q: What separates Chhota Nagpur Plateau from plains? → Rar Plains (laterite deposits)

Q: Mithila Plains — between which rivers? → Gandak and Kosi

Q: Doab meaning → land between two rivers ('do' = two, 'ab' = water)

Q: Chhos — what are they? → Gully erosion in Punjab plains caused by seasonal streams

Brahmaputra Plains (Assam)

Brahmaputra carries the largest amount of sediment in the world. Due to high sediment load it forms **braided channels** and creates river islands like **Majuli** — world's largest river island district in Assam.

EXAM FOCUS

Brahmaputra = world's largest sediment-carrying river

Majuli = largest river island district in India (Assam)

In Tibet: Brahmaputra = Yarlung Tsangpo | In Arunachal: Dihang | In Assam: Brahmaputra

3.3 Peninsular Plateau

Key Features

Oldest and most stable landmass of India — formed ~2.5 billion years ago (Archaean era)

Was originally part of **Gondwana Land** (before continental drift)

Formed by junction of ancient **Cratons** (Aravalli Craton, Singhbhum Craton, Dharwar Craton)

Average elevation: **600 m** above sea level

Covers ~16 lakh sq km (about half of India)

No volcanic activity; tectonically stable; composed of ancient crystalline/metamorphic rocks

Major Hills and Ranges of Peninsular India

Range	Location	Highest Peak / Notes
Aravalli	Rajasthan–Gujarat–Delhi	Guru Shikhar (1722m) in Mt Abu; oldest range in India
Vindhya	MP — N boundary of Deccan	Separates Ganga basin from Deccan plateau
Satpura	MP — between Narmada & Tapi	Pachmarhi (highest point in MP); Dhupgarh peak

Range	Location	Highest Peak / Notes
Western Ghats	Kerala-Karnataka-Goa-Maharashtra coast	Anaimudi (2695m) — highest peak in peninsular India
Eastern Ghats	AP-TN-Odisha coast	Jindhagada Peak (highest); discontinuous; lower than W Ghats
Nilgiri Hills	Where W & E Ghats meet (TN-Kerala)	Ooty (Udhagamandalam); Doddabetta peak (2637m)
Anaimalai Hills	TN-Kerala boundary	Anaimudi peak
Cardamom Hills	Kerala (Idukki)	Source of many Kerala rivers
Shevroy / Javadi Hills	TN	Part of Eastern Ghats system

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Aravalli = Oldest mountain range in India (and world — Precambrian)

Anaimudi (2695m) = Highest peak of Peninsular India / South India (Western Ghats)

Guru Shikhar (1722m) = Highest peak of Aravalli / Rajasthan

Western Ghats = UNESCO World Heritage Site (biodiversity hotspot)

Eastern Ghats are discontinuous (rivers cut through them flowing to Bay of Bengal)

Major Plateaus of India

Plateau	Location	Importance
Malwa Plateau	MP + Rajasthan	Between Aravalli and Vindhya; Chambal flows through
Chhota Nagpur Plateau	Jharkhand	Rich in minerals; coal, iron ore; Damodar valley coalfields
Deccan Plateau	Maharashtra, AP, Karnataka	Largest plateau in India; black soil (regur); Deccan Lava flows
Meghalaya Plateau	Meghalaya	Extension of Chhota Nagpur; separated by Brahmaputra plains; wettest place (Mawsynram/Cherrapunji)
Mysore Plateau	Karnataka	Dense forests; coffee and silk production
Telangana Plateau	Telangana	Deccan Trap basalts; Krishna-Godavari basin
Bundelkhand Plateau	UP + MP	Ravines and gullies; Chambal badlands
Baghelkhand Plateau	MP + CG	Coal deposits

🔥 EXAM FOCUS

Q: Which is India's largest plateau? → Deccan Plateau

Q: Mineral-rich plateau → Chhota Nagpur (called 'Ruhr of India')

Q: Wettest plateau region → Meghalaya (Mawsynram/Cherrapunji)

Q: Black cotton soil associated plateau → Deccan (from Deccan Trap basalt weathering)

3.4 Thar Desert (Great Indian Desert)

Aspect	Details
Location	Mostly Rajasthan; parts of Gujarat, Punjab, Haryana
Area	~2 lakh sq km
Annual Rainfall	<25 cm (arid zone)
Saline Lakes	Sambhar, Didwana, Kuchaman, Pachpadra, Degana (salt production)
Crops grown	Bajra, jowar, ragi (millets); pulses
Energy potential	Solar & wind energy hub
Mineral resources	Barmer & Jaisalmer — oil and natural gas fields
Region name	Semi-arid Rajasthan → 'Rajasthan Bangar'; Aravalli = semi-arid boundary

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Sambhar = largest inland saltwater lake in India (Rajasthan)

Luni River originates from Aravalli → flows to Rann of Kutch (Gujarat)

Barchans = crescent-shaped sand dunes (wind direction indicator)

UPSC has asked about saline lakes of Rajasthan — Sambhar, Didwana, Kuchaman, Pachpadra

3.5 Coastal Plains

Coast	Location	Features
Malabar Coast (West)	Kerala	Backwaters (Kayal); coconut; fishing; Vembanad Lake; Periyar; Pamba rivers
Konkan Coast (West)	Goa + S Maharashtra	Rocky; narrow; Goa beaches; Mandavi, Zuari rivers
Karnataka Coast (West)	Karnataka	Mangalore port; cashew; Netravati river
Gujarat Coast (West)	Gujarat	Gulf of Khambhat; Gulf of Kutch; Sabarmati; Mahi; Luni rivers
Coromandel Coast (East)	TN + South AP	Bay of Bengal; receives NE monsoon rains Oct-Dec; Palk Bay
Northern Circars (East)	North AP + Odisha	Chilika Lake; deltas of Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, Kaveri

3.6 Islands of India

Andaman and Nicobar Islands (Bay of Bengal)

Feature	Details
Total Islands	572+ (only 38 inhabited)
Groups	Andaman (North) + Nicobar (South) — separated by 10° Channel
Capital	Port Blair (South Andaman)
Highest Peak	Saddle Peak (North Andaman) — ~732 m

Feature	Details
Active Volcano	Barren Island (only active volcano in South Asia)
Dormant Volcano	Narcondam Island
Renamed Islands	Ross Island → Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Island; Havelock → Swaraj Dweep; Neil Island → Shaheed Dweep
Formation	Submerged mountains (extension of Himalayan arc)

Channels between Andaman-Nicobar Islands

Channel	Separates
10° Channel	Little Andaman (S) from Car Nicobar (N) — most important
Duncan Passage	South Andaman and Little Andaman
St. George's Channel	Little Nicobar and Great Nicobar
Grand Channel	Great Nicobar and Sumatra (Indonesia)

Lakshadweep Islands (Arabian Sea)

Feature	Details
Total Islands	36 islands
Capital	Kavaratti
Type	Coral islands (Atolls) — formed on coral reefs
Smallest UT	Smallest Union Territory of India by area (~32 sq km)
Groups	Amindivi Islands + Laccadive Islands + Minicoy Island

Important Channels — Lakshadweep

Channel	Separates
9° Channel	Lakshadweep (main) and Minicoy Island
8° Channel	Minicoy Island and Maldives
11° Channel	Amindivi Islands and main Lakshadweep group

EXAM FOCUS

Barren Island = India's only active volcano (Andaman & Nicobar)

Narcondam = Dormant volcano (Andaman & Nicobar)

10° Channel = between Andaman and Nicobar groups

9° Channel = separates main Lakshadweep from Minicoy

Lakshadweep = smallest UT | Andaman & Nicobar = largest UT

Lakshadweep = Coral | Andaman = Submerged mountains (volcanic/sedimentary rock)

CHAPTER 4: INDIAN MONSOON

4.1 Origin of the Word 'Monsoon'

The word '**Monsoon**' is derived from the Arabic word '**Mausam**' (meaning 'season'). Ancient Arab traders navigating to India noticed seasonal reversal of winds — SW winds in summer (to India) and NE winds in winter (back to Arabia). This seasonal wind reversal became associated with 'mausam'.

4.2 Characteristics of Indian Monsoon

Characteristic	Description
Onset	Sudden — arrives over Kerala around June 1 (official onset date)
Retreat	Gradual — takes weeks to retreat; not sudden like onset
Break in Monsoon	1–2 week dry spells within monsoon season (July–August)
Variability	Rainfall amount varies year to year (may fail or be excess)
Duration	June to September (SW Monsoon); Oct–Dec in Tamil Nadu (NE Monsoon)

4.3 Factors Controlling Indian Monsoon (Modern Theory)

1. Tibetan Plateau

Tibet's high altitude causes intense **insolation** (solar heating) → generates an **intense low pressure** over Tibet. This acts as:

A **source of low pressure** → attracts moisture-laden winds from Indian Ocean

A **mechanical barrier** → deflects winds southward into the Indian subcontinent

2. Jet Streams

Jet Stream	Season	Effect
Sub-tropical Westerly Jet Stream	Winter	Flows S of Himalayas → brings Western Disturbances → winter rains in NW India
Tibetan Anticyclonic Circulation (Upper Easterly Jet)	Summer	Flows over India from E → helps monsoon surge northward

3. ITCZ (Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone)

The ITCZ is a low-pressure belt where NE and SE trade winds converge. In summer, the ITCZ **shifts northward to the sub-continent** (Thar Desert region), creating a powerful low-pressure trough that draws in the moisture-laden SW monsoon winds.

4. ENSO (El Nino Southern Oscillation)

Phenomenon	Effect on Indian Monsoon
El Nino (warm phase)	Weakens Indian monsoon → drought tendency in India

Phenomenon	Effect on Indian Monsoon
La Nina (cool phase)	Strengthens Indian monsoon → above-normal rainfall
Southern Oscillation	Pressure difference between Darwin (Aus) and Tahiti (Pacific)
IOD — Indian Ocean Dipole	Positive IOD: above-normal monsoon; Negative IOD: below-normal

EXAM FOCUS

El Nino → drought in India (weakens monsoon)

La Nina → floods in India (strengthens monsoon)

ITCZ shifts north in summer → triggers SW Monsoon

Mascarene High (near Madagascar in Indian Ocean) = source of high pressure driving monsoon winds

SW Monsoon arrives Kerala ~June 1; withdraws from NW India by mid-September

4.4 Branches of SW Monsoon

Branch	Path	States Covered
Arabian Sea Branch	Hits Western Ghats first; heaviest rain on windward side	Kerala, Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra, Gujarat
Bay of Bengal Branch	Hits Eastern India and curves NW	Odisha, WB, NE India, then UP, Punjab, Rajasthan

Rain Shadow effect: Eastern side of Western Ghats (leeward side) receives very little rain — hence Deccan Plateau is relatively dry.

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Mawsynram (Meghalaya) = Wettest place in India and world (avg ~11,871 mm/year)

Cherrapunji = Second wettest; historically recorded highest rainfall

Chennai receives most rain from NE Monsoon (Oct–Dec), not SW Monsoon

Jaisalmer = driest place in India (Thar Desert)

CHAPTER 5: SOILS OF INDIA

5.1 Factors Affecting Soil Formation

Factor	Influence
Parent Rock (Geology)	Determines mineral composition of soil
Climate	Controls weathering rate; rainfall → leaching; temperature → decomposition
Topography	Plains = deep homogeneous soil; Mountains = shallow heterogeneous soil
Biotic Factors	Vegetation → humus content; bacteria → decomposition
Time	More time = more mature/deep soil

5.2 Soil Profile (Horizons)

Horizon	Name	Description
O Horizon	Organic Layer	Surface layer; undecomposed/partly decomposed leaf litter, dead matter
A Horizon	Top Soil	Most fertile; all minerals present; humus content here; zone of eluviation (E layer within A)
E Layer	Zone of Eluviation	Within A horizon; minerals leach out downward
B Horizon	Sub Soil	Zone of illuviation; iron, aluminum, humic compounds accumulate here
C Horizon	Parent Material	Partially weathered rock; less altered than above
R Horizon	Bedrock	Unweathered solid rock

5.3 Types of Soils in India (8 types as per ICAR)

Soil Type	Distribution	Characteristics	Key Crops
Alluvial Soil	N Plains (UP, Bihar, Punjab, WB), river deltas	Most extensive; Bangar (old) & Khadar (new); Kankars in Bangar; highly fertile	Wheat, rice, sugarcane, cotton, jute
Black Soil (Regur)	Deccan Plateau (Maharashtra, MP, Gujarat, AP)	Formed from Deccan Lava (basalt); swells when wet, cracks when dry; self-ploughing; high clay content	Cotton (best soil for cotton); soybean
Red & Yellow Soil	Eastern MP, Odisha, S AP, Kerala, Tamil Nadu	Formed on ancient crystalline rocks; red due to iron oxides; poor in N, P, humus	Rice, millet, tobacco, groundnut
Laterite Soil	Kerala, Karnataka, TN, Odisha highlands (humid tropics)	Formed by intense leaching in high rainfall; hard when dry; poor in N, Ca; rich in Fe, Al	Tea, coffee, rubber, cashew
Arid/Desert Soil	Rajasthan, S Punjab, N Gujarat	Sandy; low humus; high salt content; irrigation makes fertile	Bajra, pulses with irrigation

Soil Type	Distribution	Characteristics	Key Crops
Saline/Alkaline Soil	Arid areas, coastal areas	Reh/Usar/Thur soil; high salt; poor fertility; waterlogging issues	Problem soil — needs reclamation
Peaty/Marshy Soil	Kerala, Bengal, Bihar lowlands	High organic/humus content; waterlogged; acidic	Rice, vegetables
Forest/Mountain Soil	Himalayan + Eastern Ghats forests	Varies with altitude; thin; high organic matter	Tea, coffee, spices in lower altitudes

EXAM FOCUS

Q: Which soil is best for cotton? → Black (Regur) soil

Q: Which soil covers largest area in India? → Alluvial soil

Q: Laterite soil is formed by → intense leaching in heavy rainfall areas

Q: Self-ploughing property → Black soil (swells + cracks)

Q: Podzolization → process in coniferous forests where sesqui-oxides of Fe & Al leach, leaving silica+calcium

Q: Laterization → process in high rainfall where SiO₂ and Ca leach, leaving Fe and Al oxides

Q: Reh/Usar = Saline soil found in Indo-Gangetic Plains

CHAPTER 6: NATURAL VEGETATION OF INDIA

6.1 Forest Cover

According to India State of Forest Report, forest & tree cover = ~24.6% of India's total geographical area. Constitutional provision: Article 51-A (g) → fundamental duty to protect environment/forest/wildlife.

6.2 Types of Forests

Forest Type	Rainfall	Location	Key Trees/Features
Tropical Evergreen	200+ cm; no dry season	N-E India, Western Ghats windward side, A&N Islands	Ebony, mahogany, rosewood; dense canopy; no leaf-shedding season; highest biodiversity
Tropical Deciduous (Moist)	100–200 cm	E MP, Jharkhand, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, N-E India	Teak, sal, sandalwood; shed leaves in dry season; most commercially important
Tropical Deciduous (Dry)	70–100 cm	Central India plains (UP, Bihar, Rajasthan, MP)	Sal, kendu, neem, peepal; more open canopy
Tropical Thorn Scrub	<70 cm	Rajasthan, Gujarat, Punjab, Haryana dry areas	Khejri (state tree of Rajasthan), cacti, babul (Acacia)
Montane Temperate	Altitude-based (900–2700m)	Himalayas, Nilgiris	Oak, chestnut, deodar, pine, rhododendron
Alpine	Above 3600m	High Himalayas	Juniper, silver fir, birch; scrub at snowline
Mangrove / Tidal	Coastal+tidal zone	Sundarbans (WB), Gujarat, Andhra, Odisha	Sundari tree; salt-tolerant; oxygen roots (pneumatophores); habitat for tigers, crocodiles
Littoral / Swamp	Coastal areas	Along sea coasts, lagoons	Coconut, pandanus; brackish water species

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Sundarbans = world's largest mangrove forest (India + Bangladesh); UNESCO WH Site

Sundari tree → Sundarbans name derived from it

Western Ghats = biodiversity hotspot (one of 36 globally)

India has 18 biosphere reserves recognized by UNESCO Man and Biosphere Programme

Largest forest area by state: Madhya Pradesh

Highest % forest cover: Mizoram (~85%)

CHAPTER 7: DRAINAGE SYSTEM OF INDIA

7.1 Classification of Indian Rivers

Basis	Types
By Origin	Himalayan Rivers (Perennial — snow/glacier fed) vs Peninsular Rivers (Seasonal — rain-fed)
By Drainage Basin	Bay of Bengal drainage vs Arabian Sea drainage vs Inland drainage
By Flow	Antecedent (pre-dates mountain — cuts through) vs Superimposed (overlaid on rock) vs Consequent (follows slope)
By Pattern	Dendritic, Radial, Centripetal, Trellis, Parallel

Drainage Patterns

Pattern	Description	Example
Dendritic	Tree-like branching; on uniform rock	Ganga, Indus
Radial	Rivers flow outward from a central hill	Amarkantak hills → Narmada, Son, Mahanadi radiate outward
Centripetal	Rivers flow inward to a depression/lake	Rivers of Rann of Kutch, Loktak Lake basin
Trellis	Tributaries join at right angles	Rivers of folded Appalachian type
Angular	Between rectangular and trellis	River systems in jointed rocks

7.2 Major Himalayan Rivers

Indus River System

Feature	Details
Origin	Bokhar Chu Glacier near Kailash Mansarovar Lake (Tibet)
Length	~3180 km (total); ~1114 km in India
Flow direction	Flows NW through Ladakh → enters Pakistan; meets Arabian Sea near Karachi
Left bank tributaries (in India)	Zaskar, Shyok, Nubra, Gilgit (in Ladakh)
Right bank (Punjab 5 rivers)	Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej
Treaty	Indus Waters Treaty 1960 (India-Pakistan mediated by World Bank)
Gorge formed	Indus Gorge — deepest gorge in the world between Ladakh and Gilgit

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Indus Waters Treaty (1960): India gets E rivers (Sutlej, Beas, Ravi); Pakistan gets W rivers (Indus, Jhelum, Chenab)

Indus Gorge = world's deepest gorge

Sutlej enters India via Shipki La Pass
 Satluj + Beas join = forms Sutlej in Pakistan → then joins Indus
 Ranjit Sagar Dam = on Ravi River (J&K)

Ganga River System

Feature	Details
Origin	Gangotri Glacier (Bhagirathi + Alaknanda join at Devprayag = Ganga)
Length	~2525 km in India; largest by discharge in India
States covered	Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, Jharkhand, WB
Major Left bank tributaries	Ramganga, Gomti, Ghaghra (Karnali), Gandak, Kosi, Mahananda
Major Right bank tributaries	Yamuna, Son, Damodar (joins Hooghly)
National River	Ganga declared national river in 2008
Key tributaries' origins	Yamuna: Yamunotri glacier; Kosi: Nepal Himalayas (Sorrow of Bihar); Son: Amarkantak

Prayagraj Sangam: Ganga, Yamuna, and mythological Saraswati meet here — site of Kumbh Mela.

River	Origin	Notable Features
Yamuna	Yamunotri Glacier (Uttarakhand)	Longest tributary of Ganga; Delhi, Agra, Mathura on banks; joins at Prayagraj
Ghaghra/Karnali	Nepal Himalayas	Meets Ganga near Chapra (Bihar); highest discharge tributary
Gandak/Narayani	Nepal	Joins Ganga near Patna
Kosi	Nepal (meets 5 rivers)	'Sorrow of Bihar' — changes course frequently; flood-prone
Chambal	Vindhya/Janapav Hills (MP)	Flows through ravines; tributes to Yamuna; Chambal WL Sanctuary; Gandhi Sagar Dam
Son	Amarkantak Plateau	Right bank tributary; joins near Patna
Ramganga	Nainital Hills (Uttarakhand)	Right bank; Rohelkhand Plains formed by its alluvium

EXAM FOCUS

Ganga = National River | Gangetic Dolphin = National Aquatic Animal
 Haridwar = where Ganga enters plains | Rishikesh = rapids for rafting
 Kosi = 'Sorrow of Bihar' — deposits sediment + changes course = floods
 Yamuna = longest tributary of Ganga
 Son River forms Magadh Plains (south of Son)
 Chambal = originates from Vindhyas (Janapav Hill, MP) → ravines → Yamuna

Brahmaputra River System

Feature	Details
Origin	Chemayungdung (Chema Yungdung) Glacier, Tibet
Names by region	Tibet: Yarlung Tsangpo → Arunachal: Dihang (Siang) → Assam: Brahmaputra → Bangladesh: Jamuna
Total length	~2900 km (one of the longest rivers in the world)
Key feature	Antecedent river; older than Himalayas; syntaxial bend at Namcha Barwa
Sediment	World's largest sediment-carrying river
Major island	Majuli (world's largest river island district — Assam)
Left bank tributaries	Lohit, Dibang, Dihang, Dhansiri
Right bank tributaries	Subansiri, Kameng, Manas, Sankosh, Teesta
Bangladesh	Joins Ganga (as Padma) + Meghna → Bay of Bengal; world's largest delta (Sundarbans)

EXAM FOCUS

Brahmaputra = largest river by water volume/discharge in India

Namcha Barwa = syntaxial bend — eastern most point of Himalayas

Teesta River → tributary of Brahmaputra; dispute between India-Bangladesh-Sikkim

Manas River → important tributary; Manas National Park on its banks (Assam/Bhutan border)

Tista = Teesta; important for West Bengal & Sikkim

7.3 Peninsular Rivers

East-Flowing Peninsular Rivers

River	Origin	Tributaries	Mouth/States
Mahanadi	Raipur district, Chhattisgarh	Seonath, Hasdeo, Mand, Ib (left); Jonk, Ong, Tel (right)	Bay of Bengal (Odisha); Hirakud Dam
Godavari	Trimbakeshwar (Nasik, Maharashtra)	Indravati, Pranhita (Ward+Wainganga+Penganga), Sabari	Bay of Bengal (AP); 'Dakshin Ganga'
Krishna	Mahabaleshwar (Maharashtra)	Ghataprabha, Malaprabha, Koyna, Bhima, Tungabhadra	Bay of Bengal (AP/Telangana); Nagarjuna Sagar Dam
Kaveri (Cauvery)	Brahmagiri Hills (Coorg, Karnataka)	Hemavati, Arkavati, Shimsha (left); Kabini, Bhavani, Amravati (right)	Bay of Bengal (TN); KRS Dam; Cauvery water dispute
Suvarnarekha	Ranchi Plateau (Jharkhand)	—	Bay of Bengal (Odisha/WB)
Brahmani	Junction of Sankh+South Koel (Jharkhand)	—	Bay of Bengal (Odisha)

River	Origin	Tributaries	Mouth/States
Baitarni	Eastern Ghats (Odisha)	—	Bay of Bengal (Odisha)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Godavari = Largest peninsular river | 'Dakshin Ganga' (Ganges of South)
 Hirakud Dam (Odisha) = longest dam in India — on Mahanadi
 Nagarjuna Sagar Dam = on Krishna River (Telangana/AP)
 KRS Dam (Krishnarajasagar) = on Kaveri River (Karnataka) — Cauvery dispute
 Tungabhadra (trib. of Krishna) → Hampi is on its banks
 Shivsamudram Waterfalls = on Kaveri River (Karnataka)
 Indravati Nat. Park = on Indravati River (Chhattisgarh); Project Tiger
 Kolleru Lake (AP) = freshwater lake formed at delta of Godavari+Krishna

West-Flowing Peninsular Rivers

River	Origin	Flow / Features	Mouth
Narmada	Amarkantak Plateau (MP)	Rift valley river (between Vindhya & Satpura); Dhuandhar Falls; Sardar Sarovar Dam; Indira Sagar Dam; Tawa (L.bank), Kolar (R.bank) tributaries	Gulf of Khambhat (Arabian Sea)
Tapti (Tapi)	Betul Plateau (MP)	Also rift valley (S of Satpura); parallel to Narmada	Gulf of Khambhat (Arabian Sea)
Luni	Aravalli (near Ajmer, Rajasthan)	Only river of Rajasthan that reaches sea; saline after Balotra	Rann of Kutch
Sabarmati	Udaipur (Aravalli, Rajasthan)	Ahmedabad, Gandhi Ashram on banks; Dharoi Dam	Gulf of Khambhat
Mahi	Vindhya Range (MP)	Crosses Tropic of Cancer twice; Kadana Dam	Gulf of Khambhat
Periyar	Cardamom Hills (Kerala)	Longest river of Kerala; Periyar NP (Tiger Reserve)	Arabian Sea
Bharathapuzha	Anaimalai Hills (Kerala)	2nd longest river of Kerala	Arabian Sea
Pamba	Kerala Highlands	Pamba falls into Vembanad Lake; Sabarimala Temple on banks	Vembanad Lake → Arabian Sea
Mandavi / Mahadayi	Western Ghats (Goa/Karnataka)	Panaji is on Mandavi River; casino boats here	Arabian Sea (Goa)
Zuari	Western Ghats (Goa)	Meets Mandavi; Old Goa between two rivers	Arabian Sea (Goa)
Sharavati	Sahyadri/Western Ghats (Karnataka)	Jog Falls (Gersoppa Falls) on Sharavati — highest plunge waterfall in India	Arabian Sea

Narmada & Tapti = west-flowing rift valley rivers (flow in grabens between parallel faults)

Narmada: Sardar Sarovar Dam (Gujarat) + Indira Sagar Dam (MP)

Mahi crosses Tropic of Cancer TWICE — unique feature

Jog Falls (Gersoppa Falls) = on Sharavati River, Karnataka = highest plunge waterfall (~253m)

Pamba River → Sabarimala Temple (in news for Supreme Court judgment)

Luni River = only river of Rajasthan; becomes saline/brackish after Balotra

Sabarmati Ashram (Gandhi) = on Sabarmati River, Ahmedabad

Zuari + Mandavi = rivers of Goa

CHAPTER 8: IMPORTANT LAKES OF INDIA

Lake	State	Type	River/Notes
Chilika Lake	Odisha	Brackish (Lagoon); largest brackish lake in India; Ramsar site	Bay of Bengal coast; flamingos; Irrawaddy dolphin
Vembanad Lake	Kerala	Brackish (Backwater); longest lake in India (~96km)	Pamba, Meenachil rivers; Kuttanad (below sea level farming)
Kolleru Lake	Andhra Pradesh	Freshwater; deltaic lake of Godavari+Krishna	Natural freshwater lake; Ramsar site
Pulicat Lake	Andhra Pradesh / Tamil Nadu	Brackish; 2nd largest saltwater lake	Flamingo Festival; Sriharikota (ISRO) is on a sandbar
Loktak Lake	Manipur	Freshwater + Phumdis (floating mass of vegetation)	Keibul Lamjao NP (floating NP); Sangai Deer
Wular Lake	J&K	Freshwater; largest freshwater lake in India	On Jhelum River
Dal Lake	J&K	Freshwater; famous houseboat lake	On Jhelum tributary; tourism
Pangong Tso	Ladakh (India+China)	Saline; changes color (blue-green); 60% in China	At ~4350m altitude; India-China LAC passes through it
Tso Moriri	Ladakh	High altitude lake	Ramsar site; wetland conservation
Sambhar Lake	Rajasthan	Saltwater; largest inland salt lake in India	Salt production; Ramsar site
Pushkar Lake	Rajasthan	Freshwater	Sacred; Brahma Temple; Camel Fair
Pichola Lake	Rajasthan (Udaipur)	Artificial	Famous tourist lake; Lake Palace hotel
Bhoj Tal (Upper/Lower Lake)	MP (Bhopal)	Artificial	Bhopal = 'City of Lakes'
Hussain Sagar	Telangana (Hyderabad)	Artificial	On Musi River tributary; Buddha statue in center
Govind Sagar	Himachal Pradesh	Artificial reservoir	Bhakra Nangal Dam on Sutlej River
Lonar Lake	Maharashtra	Saline + Alkaline; impact crater lake	Only hypervelocity impact crater in basaltic rock; Ramsar site
Shivajisagar / Koyna Reservoir	Maharashtra	Artificial	Koyna Dam on Krishna tributary
Deepor Beel	Assam	Freshwater; wetland	On Brahmaputra; Ramsar site; elephant habitat

Lake	State	Type	River/Notes
Renuka Lake	Himachal Pradesh	Natural; famous pilgrimage	Largest natural lake in HP
Sattal Lake	Uttarakhand (Nainital)	Freshwater; cluster of 7 lakes	Migratory birds
Kanwar Lake	Bihar	Oxbow lake on Gandak River	Wetland; water birds

EXAM FOCUS

Wular Lake = largest freshwater lake in India (J&K, on Jhelum)
 Chilika Lake = largest brackish water / coastal lagoon in India (Odisha)
 Sambhar = largest inland saltwater lake in India (Rajasthan)
 Vembanad = longest lake in India by length (~96 km)
 Lonar Lake = only meteorite impact crater lake in basaltic rock (Maharashtra)
 Keibul Lamjao NP = world's only floating National Park (on Loktak Lake, Manipur)
 Phumdis = floating mass of soil, vegetation on Loktak Lake
 Pangong Tso = 60% in China (in news during India-China Galwan crisis)
 Kolleru + Sambhar + Chilika = Ramsar wetland sites

CHAPTER 9: MAJOR DAMS OF INDIA

Dam	River	State	Notable Feature
Tehri Dam	Bhagirathi (Ganga)	Uttarakhand	Highest dam in India (~261m); largest reservoir
Bhakra Nangal	Sutlej	HP/Punjab border	Tallest gravity dam in Asia; Gobind Sagar reservoir
Hirakud	Mahanadi	Odisha	Longest dam in India (~4.8 km)
Sardar Sarovar	Narmada	Gujarat	Controversial; Narmada Bachao Andolan; 2nd largest in India
Indira Sagar	Narmada	MP	Largest reservoir in India by storage
Nagarjuna Sagar	Krishna	Telangana/AP	One of world's largest masonry dams
Krishna Raja Sagar (KRS)	Kaveri	Karnataka	Visvesvaraya Dam; water to Bengaluru/Mysuru
Idukki	Periyar	Kerala	Arch dam (largest in Asia); hydropower
Gandhi Sagar	Chambal	MP	Chambal Valley Project
Jawahar Sagar	Chambal	Rajasthan	Part of Chambal Valley Project
Rana Pratap Sagar	Chambal	Rajasthan	—
Tawa Dam	Tawa (trib. of Narmada)	MP	—
Koyna Dam	Koyna (trib. of Krishna)	Maharashtra	Reservoir: Shivajisagar; caused earthquake 1967
Tungabhadra Dam	Tungabhadra	Karnataka	Hampi area
Mettur Dam	Kaveri	Tamil Nadu	Oldest dam in South India
Rihand Dam	Rihand (trib. of Son)	UP	Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar — largest man-made lake (volume) in India
Nathpa Jhakri	Sutlej	HP	Largest hydroelectric project in India
Ranjit Sagar	Ravi	J&K	Thein Dam
Dulhasti	Chenab	J&K	—
Baglihar	Chenab	J&K	—

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Tehri = Tallest dam in India (~261m) | Bhakra = Tallest GRAVITY dam
Hirakud = Longest dam in India (~4.8 km)

Indira Sagar = Largest reservoir in India (by storage capacity)

Govind Ballabh Pant Sagar (Rihand Dam) = Largest man-made lake in India by volume/area

Idukki = Largest arch dam in Asia (Kerala)

Koyna earthquake 1967 = Reservoir-induced seismicity

All 3 Chambal dams (Gandhi Sagar + Rana Pratap + Jawahar Sagar) are in MP/Rajasthan

CHAPTER 10: NATIONAL PARKS, WILDLIFE & BIOSPHERE RESERVES

10.1 Major National Parks of India

National Park	State	Famous For
Jim Corbett NP	Uttarakhand	India's oldest NP (1936); Bengal Tiger; Project Tiger (1st)
Kaziranga NP	Assam	One-horned Rhinoceros (largest population); UNESCO WH; Brahmaputra
Sundarban NP	West Bengal	Royal Bengal Tiger; Mangroves; UNESCO WH; Gangetic Delta
Gir Forest NP	Gujarat	Only habitat of Asiatic Lion in wild; Sasan Gir
Keibul Lamjao NP	Manipur	World's only floating NP; Sangai/Eld's Deer; on Loktak Lake
Hemis NP	Ladakh (J&K)	Snow Leopard; largest NP in India
Periyar NP	Kerala	Elephants; Tigers; Periyar River; TR
Bandipur NP	Karnataka	Tigers; Elephants; adjoins Mudumalai & Nagarhole
Nagarhole NP	Karnataka	Elephants; Kabini River; Rajiv Gandhi NP
Pench NP	MP/Maharashtra border	Tigers; Kipling's Jungle Book setting
Kanha NP	MP	Tigers; Barasingha (hardground deer)
Bandhavgarh NP	MP	Highest tiger density in India
Panna NP	MP	Tigers; Ken River; TR
Nauradehi WS (MP)	MP	India's proposed cheetah reintroduction site
Sariska NP	Rajasthan	Tigers; Alwar district; TR
Ranthambore NP	Rajasthan	Tigers; Ranthambore Fort; TR
Keoladeo Ghana NP	Rajasthan	Siberian crane; migratory birds; UNESCO WH; Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary
Manas NP	Assam	Tiger + Rhinoceros + Elephant; UNESCO WH; Project Tiger; on Bhutan border
Indravati NP	Chhattisgarh	Wild Buffalo; on Indravati River; TR
Simlipal NP	Odisha	Tigers; Elephants; Barehipani Falls
Eravikulam NP	Kerala	Nilgiri Tahr; Anamudi peak
Silent Valley NP	Kerala	Lion-tailed Macaque; no roads inside
Great Himalayan NP	HP	UNESCO WH; Snow Leopard; Western Himalayan biodiversity
Dachigam NP	J&K	Hangul (Kashmir Stag)
Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary	Rajasthan	Migratory birds; UNESCO WH

National Park	State	Famous For
Fangpui (Phawngpui) Blue Mountain NP	Mizoram	Blue rocks; highest peak of Mizoram

🔥 EXAM FOCUS

Jim Corbett = India's FIRST National Park (1936); 1st Project Tiger park (1973)

Kaziranga = largest population of one-horned rhinos in the world

Gir = only habitat of Asiatic Lion

Keibul Lamjao = world's only floating National Park

Hemis = largest National Park in India (Ladakh)

Keoladeo Ghana = UNESCO WH; Siberian Crane migration destination

Manas NP spans India-Bhutan border (Royal Manas NP in Bhutan)

Sundarbans = largest mangrove + Bengal Tiger habitat; UNESCO WH

Simlipal NP = India's 2nd largest biosphere reserve

10.2 Tiger Reserves (Project Tiger — launched 1973)

India has the **highest number of wild tigers** in the world (>3,000 as of 2022). Project Tiger was launched in 1973 under PM Indira Gandhi. NTCA (National Tiger Conservation Authority) manages tiger reserves.

States with most Tiger Reserves: **Madhya Pradesh** → 'Tiger State of India'

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

India has 54 Tiger Reserves (as of 2023)

First Tiger Reserve = Jim Corbett (1973)

Maximum tigers = MP (Madhya Pradesh) — 'Tiger State'

Maharashtra's Umred-Pauni-Karhandla = Jai the Tiger

Orang NP (Assam) = Mini Kaziranga — rhinos + tigers

10.3 UNESCO Biosphere Reserves in India

Biosphere Reserve	State
Sundarbans	West Bengal
Gulf of Mannar	Tamil Nadu
Nilgiris	TN + Kerala + Karnataka
Nokrek	Meghalaya
Nanda Devi	Uttarakhand
Manas	Assam
Simlipal	Odisha
Dibru-Saikhowa	Assam
Dihang-Dibang	Arunachal Pradesh
Khangchendzonga	Sikkim

Biosphere Reserve	State
Panna	MP
Achanakmar-Amarkantak	MP + CG
Agasthyamalai	Kerala + TN
Great Nicobar	Andaman & Nicobar
Pachmarhi	MP
Kanha-Pench	MP

10.4 Ramsar Wetland Sites

India has **75+ Ramsar Sites** (as of 2023) — highest number in Asia. Key sites:

Ramsar Site	State	Notable Feature
Chilika Lake	Odisha	Largest coastal wetland; Irrawaddy dolphin; flamingo
Keoladeo Ghana	Rajasthan	Migratory birds; Siberian crane
Sambhar Lake	Rajasthan	Salt production; flamingo
Vembanad-Kol	Kerala	Largest wetland in India; backwaters
Wular Lake	J&K	Largest freshwater lake
Loktak Lake	Manipur	Floating phumdis
Harike Wetland	Punjab	Junction of Sutlej and Beas
Deepor Beel	Assam	Freshwater lake; elephants
Tso Moriri	Ladakh	High altitude wetland; migratory birds
Lonar Lake	Maharashtra	Unique meteor crater lake; saline + alkaline
Renuka Lake	Himachal	Smallest Ramsar site in India
Nalsarovar	Gujarat	Migratory birds; flamingo

EXAM FOCUS

India = Most Ramsar wetland sites in Asia

1st Ramsar sites in India: Chilika (Odisha) & Keoladeo (Rajasthan) — 1981

Ramsar Convention (1971) — signed at Ramsar, Iran

Renuka Lake (HP) = smallest Ramsar site in India

Vembanad-Kol (Kerala) = largest Ramsar site in India

Lonar Lake added 2020 — unique alkaline + saline + meteor crater

CHAPTER 11: POPULATION & SETTLEMENTS (OVERVIEW)

Aspect	Data / Facts
Census 2011 Population	121.07 crore (1.21 billion)
Decadal Growth Rate (2001-11)	17.64% (declined from 21.54% in 1991-2001)
Density (2011)	382 persons per sq km
Most populous state	UP (Uttar Pradesh)
Least populous state	Sikkim
Highest density	Bihar (1106/sq km)
Lowest density	Arunachal Pradesh (17/sq km)
Most literate state	Kerala (94%)
Least literate	Bihar (~61%)
Sex Ratio (2011)	940 females per 1000 males
Best sex ratio	Kerala (1084)
Worst sex ratio	Haryana (879)
Urban Population	31.16% (as per 2011)
India's population share (world)	~18% of world in ~2.4% of land

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

UPSC/UPPCS frequently asks: most populous, most dense, least dense states

India became world's most populous country (surpassing China) in 2023

UP = most populous state; Bihar = highest density; Arunachal = lowest density

Kerala = highest literacy + best sex ratio + highest life expectancy

As per India Census: rural population still ~69% despite urbanization

CHAPTER 12: WATERFALLS & OTHER IMPORTANT FACTS

12.1 Major Waterfalls

Waterfall	River	State	Height	Notes
Jog Falls (Gersoppa)	Sharavati	Karnataka	~253m	Highest plunge waterfall in India
Nohkalikai Falls	Near Cherrapunji	Meghalaya	~340m	India's tallest waterfall (free fall)
Dhuandhar Falls	Narmada	MP	~30m	'Smoke cascade'; near Bhedaghat, Jabalpur
Dudhsagar Falls	Mandavi	Goa/Karnataka	~310m	Milky white; on Konkan Railway line
Chitrakote Falls	Indravati	Chhattisgarh	~90m	Widest waterfall in India; 'India's Niagara'
Sivasamudram Falls	Kaveri	Karnataka	~98m	Hydropower; Bluff Island
Athirappilly Falls	Chalakudy	Kerala	~80m	Niagara of India (Kerala)
Barehipani Falls	Budhabalanga	Odisha	~399m	2nd highest waterfall; in Simlipal NP
Thalaiyar Falls	Manjalar	Tamil Nadu	~297m	Rat Tail Falls; deepest gorge in India

EXAM FOCUS

Jog/Gersoppa = Highest PLUNGE waterfall in India (Sharavati, Karnataka)

Nohkalikai = Highest TOTAL fall in India (Meghalaya, near Cherrapunji)

Dhuandhar Falls = Narmada River, MP (Bhedaghat — Jabalpur)

Chitrakote Falls = Widest waterfall in India (CG) — 'India's Niagara'

Dudhsagar = can be seen from Konkan Railway trains (Goa/Karnataka border)

12.2 India's Straits and Channels

Strait / Channel	Connects / Separates	Notes
Palk Strait	India and Sri Lanka	Between Gulf of Mannar and Bay of Bengal; Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu)
10° Channel	Little Andaman and Car Nicobar	Main division between Andaman and Nicobar groups
Duncan Passage	South Andaman and Little Andaman	
9° Channel	Lakshadweep & Minicoy	
8° Channel	Minicoy & Maldives	

Strait / Channel	Connects / Separates	Notes
Grand Channel	Great Nicobar & Sumatra	India's southernmost point near here (Indira Point)

12.3 India's Extreme Points

Direction	Point	Location
Northernmost	Indira Col	Siachen Glacier, J&K
Southernmost (mainland)	Cape Comorin (Kanyakumari)	Tamil Nadu — confluence of 3 seas
Southernmost (India incl. islands)	Indira Point / Pygmalion Point	Great Nicobar Island (submerged in 2004 Tsunami)
Easternmost	Kibithu (Kibitu)	Arunachal Pradesh
Westernmost	Sir Creek / Guhar Moti	Gujarat (Rann of Kutch)

EXAM FOCUS

Kanyakumari = southernmost tip of mainland India; 3 seas (Arabian Sea, Bay of Bengal, Indian Ocean) meet

Indira Point = India's southernmost point (Great Nicobar) — submerged 2004 Tsunami

Kibithu = easternmost point of India (Arunachal Pradesh)

Indira Col (or Dafadar) = northernmost point (disputed because Siachen)

CHAPTER 13: STATES & UNION TERRITORIES — EXAM REFERENCE

State/UT	Capital	Major River	State Animal	State Bird	National Park/WLS
Uttar Pradesh	Lucknow	Ganga, Yamuna, Ghaghra	Swamp Deer (Barasingha)	Sarus Crane	Dudhwa NP
Madhya Pradesh	Bhopal	Narmada, Tapti, Chambal	Barasingha (Hard Ground)	Indian Paradise Flycatcher	Kanha, Bandhavgarh, Panna NP
Maharashtra	Mumbai	Godavari, Krishna, Tapti	Giant Squirrel	Yellow-footed Green Pigeon	Sanjay Gandhi NP
Rajasthan	Jaipur	Chambal, Luni, Banas	Chinkara	Great Indian Bustard	Ranthambore, Sariska NP
Gujarat	Gandhinagar	Sabarmati, Mahi, Narmada	Asiatic Lion	Greater Flamingo	Gir Forest NP
Bihar	Patna	Ganga, Son, Gandak, Kosi	Gaur	House Sparrow	Valmiki NP
West Bengal	Kolkata	Ganga/Hooghly, Teesta	Fishing Cat	White-breasted Kingfisher	Sundarbans NP, Gorumara NP
Assam	Dispur	Brahmaputra, Barak	Indian One-horned Rhino	White-winged Wood Duck	Kaziranga NP, Manas NP
Karnataka	Bengaluru	Krishna, Kaveri, Tungabhadra	Indian Elephant	Indian Roller	Bandipur, Nagarhole NP
Andhra Pradesh	Amaravati	Krishna, Godavari	Blackbuck	Rose-ringed Parakeet	Sri Venkateswara NP
Telangana	Hyderabad	Krishna, Godavari, Musi	Spotted Deer (Chital)	Palapitta (Blue Rock Pigeon)	Mrugavani NP
Tamil Nadu	Chennai	Kaveri, Palar, Vaigai	Nilgiri Tahr	Emerald Dove	Mudumalai NP, Anamalai NP
Kerala	Thiruvananthapuram	Periyar, Pamba, Bharathapuzha	Indian Elephant	Great Hornbill	Periyar NP, Silent Valley NP
Odisha	Bhubaneswar	Mahanadi, Brahmani, Baitarni	Sambar Deer	Indian Roller (Neelakantha)	Simlipal NP, Bhitarkanika NP
Jharkhand	Ranchi	Damodar, Subanarekha	Indian Elephant	Koel (Asian Koel)	Betla NP
Chhattisgarh	Raipur	Mahanadi, Indravati, Sheonath	Wild Buffalo	Hill Myna	Indravati NP, Kanger Valley NP

State/UT	Capital	Major River	State Animal	State Bird	National Park/WLS
Punjab	Chandigarh	Sutlej, Beas, Ravi	Blackbuck	Northern Goshawk	Harike Wetland
Haryana	Chandigarh	Yamuna, Ghaggar	Blackbuck	Black Francolin	Sultanpur Bird Sanctuary
Himachal Pradesh	Shimla	Sutlej, Ravi, Beas, Chenab	Snow Leopard	Western Tragopan	Great Himalayan NP, Pin Valley NP
Uttarakhand	Dehradun	Ganga (Bhagirathi+Alaknanda), Yamuna	Musk Deer	Himalayan Monal	Jim Corbett NP, Nanda Devi BR
J&K (UT)	Srinagar (S), Jammu (W)	Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Indus	Hangul (Kashmir Stag)	Black-necked Crane	Dachigam NP, Hemis NP (Ladakh)
Sikkim	Gangtok	Teesta, Rangit	Red Panda	Blood Pheasant	Khangchend zonga NP
Meghalaya	Shillong	Uiam, Shillong	Clouded Leopard	Hill Myna	Balpakram NP
Arunachal Pradesh	Itanagar	Brahmaputra (Siang/Dihang), Subansiri	Gayal (Mithun)	Great Hornbill	Namdapha NP
Nagaland	Kohima	Dhansiri, Doyang	Mithun	Blyth's Tragopan	Intanki NP
Manipur	Imphal	Imphal, Barak	Sangai Deer	Hume's Pheasant	Keibul Lamjao NP
Mizoram	Aizawl	Tlawng, Kolodyne	Malayan Giant Squirrel	Mrs Hume's Pheasant	Phawngpui Blue Mountain NP
Tripura	Agartala	Haora, Gumti	Phayre's Langur	Green Imperial Pigeon	Clouded Leopard NP
Goa	Panaji	Mandavi, Zuari	Gaur	Black-crested Bulbul	Bhagwan Mahavir WS
Lakshadweep (UT)	Kavaratti	—	Butterfly Fish	Noddy Tern	—
A&N Islands (UT)	Port Blair	—	Dugong (Sea Cow)	Andaman Wood Pigeon	Campbell Bay NP, Galathea NP
Delhi (UT)	New Delhi	Yamuna	Nilgai	House Sparrow	Asola Bhatti Wildlife Sanctuary
Chandigarh (UT)	Chandigarh	—	Indian Grey Mongoose	Indian Grey Hornbill	—

EXAM FOCUS

Chandigarh = shared capital of Punjab and Haryana

Dehradun = capital of Uttarakhand (shifted from Uttarkashi)
MP and CG share a border; CG was carved out of MP in 2000
Jharkhand = carved out of Bihar in 2000 | Uttarakhand = from UP in 2000
Goa = smallest state by area | Sikkim = least population
UP = largest state by population | Rajasthan = largest state by area

CHAPTER 14: ENVIRONMENT — LAWS, CONVENTIONS & GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

14.1 Constitutional Provisions on Environment

Article	Provision
Art. 48-A (DPSP)	State shall endeavour to protect and improve environment and safeguard forests and wildlife
Art. 51-A(g) (FD)	Fundamental Duty of citizens to protect environment, forests, rivers, wildlife
Art. 21	Right to Life includes right to live in clean/healthy environment (SC expanded)
Art. 246, 7th Schedule	Environment is in Concurrent List (both Centre and States can legislate)
100th Amendment (2015)	Land Boundary Agreement with Bangladesh — exchange of enclaves

14.2 Important Environmental Laws

Law / Act	Year	Key Provision
Wildlife Protection Act	1972	Protection of wild animals, birds, plants; schedules I-VI; NBWL
Water (Prevention & Control of Pollution) Act	1974	CPCB and SPCBs established
Forest (Conservation) Act	1980	Restrictions on diversion of forest land for non-forest use
Air (Prevention & Control of Pollution) Act	1981	Standards for air quality; CPCB
Environment (Protection) Act	1986	Umbrella act; post-Bhopal Gas Tragedy; Central Gov power to regulate
Biological Diversity Act	2002	Access and benefit sharing; NBA, SBBs, BMCs
Forest Rights Act (FRA)	2006	Rights of tribal communities over forest land/resources
National Green Tribunal Act	2010	NGT established; fast-track environmental cases

14.3 International Conventions

Convention	Year	Subject
Ramsar Convention	1971	Protection of Wetlands of International Importance
CITES	1973	International trade in endangered species (flora & fauna)
Bonn Convention (CMS)	1979	Migratory species conservation
Vienna Convention + Montreal Protocol	1985 / 1987	Ozone layer protection; phase-out of CFCs
Basel Convention	1989	Control of hazardous wastes & disposal

Convention	Year	Subject
Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)	1992	Biodiversity conservation; access and benefit sharing
UNFCCC	1992	Framework for combating climate change
Kyoto Protocol	1997	GHG reduction targets (developed countries)
Paris Agreement	2015	Limit global warming to 1.5-2°C above pre-industrial levels; NDCs
Kunming-Montreal GBF	2022	Biodiversity targets; 30x30 protection goal

14.4 Government Schemes Related to Environment & Geography

Scheme	Key Details
Project Tiger (1973)	Conservation of Bengal Tiger; 54 reserves; NTCA oversight
Project Elephant (1992)	Elephant conservation; 33 elephant reserves
Project Crocodile (1975)	3 crocodile species protection (Mugger, Saltwater, Gharial)
Project Dolphin (2020)	Gangetic Dolphin (river) + Oceanic Dolphin conservation
CAMPA	Compensatory Afforestation Fund; Rs 40,000 cr+ collected
National Water Mission	One of 8 missions under National Action Plan on Climate Change (NAPCC 2008)
Namami Gange Programme	Integrated Ganga River rejuvenation (₹20,000 crore); 2015
AMRUT	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation; urban water infrastructure
PM Van Dhan Yojana	Forest produce for tribal livelihoods
Cheetah Reintroduction	Cheetahs from Namibia introduced at Kuno NP (MP) — 2022

EXAM FOCUS

India's National Animal = Bengal Tiger | National Bird = Indian Peacock | National Flower = Lotus
National Aquatic Animal = Ganges River Dolphin | National Tree = Banyan | National Fruit = Mango
Project Tiger = 1973 (India's first major conservation project); PM Indira Gandhi
Cheetah Reintroduction = Kuno NP, MP (2022) — Namibia + South Africa cheetahs
Gharial = Critically Endangered; found in Chambal, Girwa (Katarniaghat WS, UP), Mahanadi
Great Indian Bustard = Critically Endangered; Rajasthan; affected by power lines

CHAPTER 15: WORLD GEOGRAPHY — QUICK REFERENCE

15.1 Continents

Continent	Area (sq km)	Largest Country	Highest Point	Lowest Point	Notes
Asia	44.6 million	Russia	Everest (8848m, Nepal/China)	Dead Sea	Largest continent; most populous
Africa	30.4 million	Algeria	Kilimanjaro (5895m, Tanzania)	Lake Assal (Djibouti)	2nd largest; Sahara (largest hot desert)
North America	24.7 million	Canada	Denali (6190m, Alaska/USA)	Death Valley (California)	Includes Central America
South America	17.8 million	Brazil	Aconcagua (6961m, Argentina)	Laguna del Carbón	Amazon River; Atacama Desert
Antarctica	14 million	—	Vinson Massif (4892m)	—	Coldest; 70% of world's fresh water (ice)
Europe	10.5 million	Russia (partly)	Mont Blanc (4808m, France/Italy)	Caspian Sea shore	Smallest continent (excl Australia)
Australia	7.7 million	Australia	Mawson Peak / Mt Kosciuszko	Lake Eyre	Smallest continent; also a country

15.2 Major Deserts of the World

Desert	Continent	Type	Key Features
Sahara	Africa	Hot	Largest hot desert; covers ~9.2 million sq km; 11 countries
Arabian Desert	Asia	Hot	Rub al Khali (Empty Quarter) — largest continuous sand desert
Gobi	Asia	Cold	Mongolia + China; rocky desert; fossil-rich
Patagonian	S America	Cold	Argentina; largest cold desert in S America
Great Australian	Australia	Hot	Sandy; largest desert in Australia

Desert	Continent	Type	Key Features
Atacama	S America (Chile)	Cold coastal	Driest non-polar desert; Chilean coast
Kalahari	S Africa	Semi-arid	Botswana + S Africa; wildlife rich
Thar	S Asia (India/Pak)	Hot	Great Indian Desert; 7th largest
Antarctic	Antarctica	Cold	Largest cold desert in world (~14 million sq km)

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Largest hot desert = Sahara | Largest cold desert = Antarctic

Driest desert (non-polar) = Atacama (Chile)

Arabian desert contains Rub al Khali — world's largest unbroken sand sea

Gobi Desert = Mongolia/China — fossil discoveries (dinosaur eggs)

Thar = 7th largest desert in world; 'Sea of Sand' (Marusthali)

15.3 Major Mountain Ranges of the World

Mountain Range	Continent	Highest Peak	Notes
Himalayas	Asia	Everest (8848m)	Includes K2 (2nd), Kanchenjunga (3rd); youngest fold mountains
Andes	South America	Aconcagua (6961m)	Longest mountain range; Pacific coast
Rockies	North America	Elbert (4399m)	Western USA/Canada; Continental Divide
Alps	Europe	Mont Blanc (4808m)	France/Switzerland/Italy; Rhine, Rhone, Po rivers originate
Atlas	Africa	Toubkal (4167m)	NW Africa; Morocco/Algeria/Tunisia
Ural Mountains	Asia/Europe boundary	Narodnaya (1895m)	Divides Asia from Europe
Caucasus	Europe/Asia	Elbrus (5642m)	Highest peak in Europe (if Caucasus = Europe)
Appalachian	North America	Mitchell (2037m)	Eastern USA; oldest mountain range in N America
Great Dividing Range	Australia	Kosciuszko (2228m)	Australia's main mountain barrier

15.4 Ocean Currents

Current	Ocean	Type (W/C)	Effect
Gulf Stream	Atlantic	Warm	Keeps W Europe mild; world's strongest ocean current
Labrador Current	Atlantic	Cold	Meets Gulf Stream; fog off Newfoundland; good fishing
Canary Current	Atlantic	Cold	SW of Europe/NW Africa; N-bound cold current
N Atlantic Drift	Atlantic	Warm	Extension of Gulf Stream; keeps UK warm
Brazil Current	Atlantic	Warm	South American coast; warm
Benguela Current	Atlantic	Cold	W coast of S Africa; upwelling; rich fish
Kuroshio Current	Pacific	Warm	Japan; NE Pacific; warm
North Pacific Current	Pacific	Warm	Extension of Kuroshio
California Current	Pacific	Cold	W USA coast; cold
Peru/Humboldt Current	Pacific	Cold	W South America; anchoveta fishing; El Nino affects it
Indian Ocean Currents	Indian Ocean	Seasonal	Reverse with monsoon; N. Equatorial, Somali Current (changes direction with monsoon)

EXAM FOCUS

Warm currents flow from equator to poles; Cold currents from poles to equator
 Warm current coasts = moist/mild climate | Cold current coasts = fog/desert (Atacama, Namib)
 Gulf Stream = warms Western Europe | Labrador = creates Grand Banks fishing
 Peru/Humboldt Current → disrupted by El Nino → drought in India
 Somali Current (Indian Ocean) reverses direction with monsoon season

15.5 Major Rivers of the World

River	Continent	Length	Key Facts
Nile	Africa	~6650 km	Longest river in world; flows N into Mediterranean
Amazon	S America	~6400 km	Largest by discharge; tropical rainforest basin
Yangtze	Asia	~6300 km	Longest river in Asia; 3 Gorges Dam
Mississippi-Missouri	N America	~6275 km	Longest in N America
Yenisei	Asia	~5539 km	Siberia; flows into Arctic Ocean
Yellow River (Huang He)	Asia	~5464 km	Cradle of Chinese civilization; 'China's Sorrow'
Ob-Irtysh	Asia	~5410 km	Siberia; drains into Arctic

River	Continent	Length	Key Facts
Congo	Africa	~4700 km	2nd largest by discharge; deepest river
Amur	Asia	~4444 km	Russia-China border
Mekong	Asia	~4350 km	SE Asia; passes 6 countries; Lancang in China
Volga	Europe	~3690 km	Longest river in Europe; Russia; Caspian Sea
Rhine	Europe	~1230 km	W Europe; major navigable river; Alps to North Sea
Danube	Europe	~2860 km	2nd longest in Europe; flows E into Black Sea
Zambezi	Africa	~2574 km	Victoria Falls; Mozambique channel
Irrawaddy	Asia	~2170 km	Myanmar; drains into Andaman Sea

★ Frequently Asked in Exams

Nile (Africa) = Longest river in world (~6650 km)

Amazon (S America) = Largest river by volume/discharge

Yangtze (China) = Longest river in Asia; Three Gorges Dam on it

Volga (Russia) = Longest river in Europe

Congo (Africa) = Deepest river in the world

Victoria Falls = on Zambezi River (Zimbabwe/Zambia border) — largest waterfall by volume

CHAPTER 16: MASTER ONE-LINERS FOR LAST-MINUTE REVISION

India — Basic Geography

- ⚡ India's Standard Meridian = 82.5°E → passes through Mirzapur (UP)
- ⚡ India's latitudinal extent: $8^{\circ}4'\text{N}$ to $37^{\circ}6'\text{N}$ (mainland); Longitudinal: $68^{\circ}7'\text{E}$ to $97^{\circ}25'\text{E}$
- ⚡ N-S distance = 3,214 km; E-W distance = 2,933 km
- ⚡ India is in Northern + Eastern hemisphere
- ⚡ Tropic of Cancer (23.5°N) passes through 8 states: Guj, Raj, MP, CG, Jharkhand, WB, Tripura, Mizoram
- ⚡ IST = GMT + 5:30 hours (82.5°E Standard Meridian)

Mountains & Passes

- ⚡ Highest peak in India = K2 (if J&K claimed) OR Kanchenjunga (8586m) in Indian territory
- ⚡ Highest peak in Peninsular India = Anaimudi (2695m) — Western Ghats, Kerala
- ⚡ Highest peak in Aravalli = Guru Shikhar (1722m) — Rajasthan
- ⚡ Aravalli = Oldest mountain range in India
- ⚡ Western Ghats + Eastern Ghats meet at Nilgiris (TN/Kerala)
- ⚡ Satpura = between Narmada (N) and Tapti (S)
- ⚡ Nanda Devi (7816m) = Highest peak in India in fully Indian territory (Uttarakhand)

Rivers

- ⚡ Ganga = National River; Gangetic Dolphin = National Aquatic Animal
- ⚡ Yamuna = longest tributary of Ganga
- ⚡ Kosi = Sorrow of Bihar (frequent flooding)
- ⚡ Godavari = Dakshin Ganga (largest peninsular river)
- ⚡ Narmada + Tapti = only major west-flowing rift valley rivers
- ⚡ Mahi = crosses Tropic of Cancer TWICE
- ⚡ Jog Falls (Sharavati, Karnataka) = highest plunge waterfall in India
- ⚡ Brahmaputra = world's largest sediment-carrying river; Majuli = largest river island
- ⚡ Indus Waters Treaty (1960) = India gets E rivers; Pakistan gets W rivers
- ⚡ Chambal = originates from Vindhya Range (Janapav Hill, MP)
- ⚡ Sabarmati = Gandhi Ashram at Ahmedabad; flows into Gulf of Khambhat
- ⚡ Luni = only river of Rajasthan reaching sea (becomes saline after Balotra)
- ⚡ Sharavati = Jog Falls | Narmada = Dhuandhar Falls (Jabalpur/Bhedaghat)

Soils & Forests

- ⚡ Black soil = best for cotton; self-ploughing; from Deccan basalt
- ⚡ Laterite soil = high rainfall areas; leaching removes Ca and Si; Fe and Al remain
- ⚡ Alluvial soil = most widespread in India; most fertile; khadar > bangar
- ⚡ Sundarbans = largest mangrove forest in the world
- ⚡ Western Ghats = UNESCO World Heritage Biodiversity Hotspot
- ⚡ Mawsynram (Meghalaya) = wettest place in India and world
- ⚡ Largest state by forest area = Madhya Pradesh

Lakes & Dams

- ⚡ Wular Lake (J&K) = largest freshwater lake in India
- ⚡ Chilika Lake (Odisha) = largest brackish water lagoon in India; 1st Ramsar site
- ⚡ Sambhar Lake (Rajasthan) = largest inland saltwater lake
- ⚡ Loktak Lake (Manipur) + Keibul Lamjao NP = world's only floating national park
- ⚡ Lonar Lake (Maharashtra) = meteorite crater lake; saline + alkaline
- ⚡ Pangong Tso (Ladakh) = 60% in China; ~4350m altitude
- ⚡ Tehri Dam = highest dam in India (~261m) | Hirakud = longest dam
- ⚡ Bhakra Nangal = tallest gravity dam in Asia; reservoir = Gobind Sagar
- ⚡ Indira Sagar Dam (Narmada, MP) = largest reservoir in India by capacity

Wildlife & Environment

- ⚡ Jim Corbett = India's first national park (1936); 1st Project Tiger park (1973)
- ⚡ Kaziranga = largest population of one-horned rhinos; UNESCO WH
- ⚡ Gir Forest = only habitat of Asiatic Lion in wild
- ⚡ Keibul Lamjao NP = world's only floating NP (Manipur)
- ⚡ Barren Island = India's only active volcano (Andaman)
- ⚡ Narcondam Island = dormant volcano (Andaman)
- ⚡ 10° channel = divides Andaman from Nicobar
- ⚡ Lakshadweep = coral islands; 36 islands; smallest UT; 9° channel separates from Minicoy
- ⚡ India has 54 Tiger Reserves + 75+ Ramsar Sites
- ⚡ Project Tiger = 1973 | Project Elephant = 1992 | Project Crocodile = 1975
- ⚡ Cheetah reintroduction = Kuno NP, Madhya Pradesh (2022)

Neighbors & Borders

- ⚡ Bangladesh = longest land border with India
- ⚡ China shares border with 5 states: J&K, HP, Uttarakhand, Sikkim, Arunachal

- ⚡ Treaty of Sugauli (1816) = Anglo-Nepalese War; Kali River = W Nepal boundary
- ⚡ 100th Constitutional Amendment (2015) = India-Bangladesh land boundary agreement
- ⚡ Manas NP (Assam) extends into Bhutan as Royal Manas NP
- ⚡ Kalapani = Uttarakhand (Pithoragarh district); disputed with Nepal
- ⚡ Mount Saramati = highest peak of Nagaland (Naga Hills)
- ⚡ Palk Strait separates India from Sri Lanka; Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu) = limestone shoals

END OF DOCUMENT — BEST OF LUCK FOR YOUR EXAMINATION!

INDIAN NATIONAL MOVEMENT

Comprehensive Exam-Oriented Study Notes

For Allahabad High Court RO | UPPCS | RO/ARO | SSC CGL/CHSL | UPSC Prelims |
Railway Exams

Based on Modern Indian History Lecture Transcript

Enhanced with Standard References: NCERT | Spectrum Modern India | Bipin Chandra

CHAPTER 1: ADVENT OF EUROPEANS IN INDIA

1.1 Background: Why Europeans Came to India

India had long-standing trade relations with Europe. These were disrupted when the Ottoman Empire captured Constantinople (modern Istanbul) in 1453, blocking the traditional land trade routes between Europe and Asia. This forced European nations to find new sea routes to India.

► Key Reasons for European Arrival

- Trade disruption due to Ottoman conquest of Constantinople (1453)
- Huge European demand for Indian spices (pepper, cardamom, cloves) and textiles
- Arab and Turkish middlemen controlled trade routes, reducing European profits
- Renaissance in Europe: scientific thinking, exploration, and navigation advances
- Portuguese and Spanish monarchs actively funded sea exploration expeditions

1.2 Sequence of European Arrivals in India

European Power	Year of Arrival	Key Entry Point	Exam Significance
Portuguese	1498	Calicut (Kozhikode) – Vasco da Gama	First Europeans to arrive; most exam questions
Dutch	1605	Masulipatnam	Defeated by English at Battle of Beedara (1759)
English	1608	Surat	Founded East India Company (1600); most significant
Danish	1620	Tranquebar (Tamil Nadu)	Least significant; sold to British in 1845
French	1668	Surat, then Masulipatnam	Last to arrive; biggest rival to British

★ SEQUENCE TRICK: P-D-E-D-F → 'Please Do Enjoy Danish Food' (Portuguese, Dutch, English, Danish, French)

★ Portuguese arrived 1498, French arrived 1668 — difference of 170 years

★ Danish settlements sold to British in 1845 — least impactful European power

★ Vasco da Gama's voyage to India sponsored by King Manuel I of Portugal

1.3 Portuguese in India

► Key Facts — Portuguese

- Vasco da Gama first arrived at Calicut (1498); second voyage 1502
- Alfonso de Albuquerque: most important Portuguese governor; captured Goa (1510)
- Goa became the capital of Portuguese India
- Portuguese introduced the Cartaz system (sea-pass system), controlling Indian Ocean trade

- Battle of Swally/Suvali (1612): English defeated Portuguese fleet near Surat — Portuguese decline began
- Portuguese legacy: Introduced tobacco, potato, and cashew to India; Christian missionaries active

1.4 British East India Company — Establishment & Early Expansion

► Formation of East India Company

- Founded: 31 December 1600 by Queen Elizabeth I's Royal Charter
- Original name: The Governor and Company of Merchants of London Trading into the East Indies
- First factory in India: Surat (1608) — Captain Hawkins/William Hawkins sent by James I
- Thomas Best defeated Portuguese at Battle of Swally (1612) — secured Surat factory
- Sir Thomas Roe visited Mughal Emperor Jahangir's court (1615) — got trading rights

► Key British Settlements (Chronological)

Settlement	Year	Key Fact
Surat	1608/1613	First factory; base for western India trade
Madras (Fort St. George)	1639	Founded by Francis Day; first fortified settlement
Orissa (Hariharpur, Balasore)	1633	British factories in eastern India
Bombay	1668	Received as dowry from Portugal; King Charles II gave to EIC at £10/year rent
Calcutta (Fort William)	1700	Three villages: Sutanati + Govindpur + Kalikata merged to form Calcutta

★ High Exam Fact — Bombay

- King Charles II of England married Catherine of Braganza (Portuguese princess)
- Portugal gifted Bombay as part of the dowry in 1661
- Charles II transferred Bombay to East India Company in 1668 at £10 annual rent
- Bombay later became the headquarters of the Western Presidency

1.5 Farrukhsiyar's Farman (1717) — 'Magna Carta of British Rule'

Year	1717
Mughal Emperor	Farrukhsiyar (later Mughal ruler)
British Representative	John Surman (Governor, Fort William)
Background	Farrukhsiyar was ill; British doctors cured him; he granted favours in return
Benefits to EIC	Free trade in Bengal for Rs 3,000/year; coins of Bombay valid in Bengal; right to rent 38 villages around Calcutta; free trade in Surat for Rs 10,000/year

Historical Name	Called 'Magna Carta of British Rule in India' by historian William Hunter
Exam Importance	Frequently asked in UPPCS, SSC, UPSC — identify the name, year, and benefits

1.6 Anglo-French Rivalry — Carnatic Wars

► French East India Company (Compagnie des Indes)

- Founded 1664 under King Louis XIV; his minister Colbert organized it
- First official in India: Francois Caron — came to Surat (1667)
- Francois Martin: Founder of French Empire in India; established Pondicherry (1674)
- French capital in India: Pondicherry; also had Chandernagore (1673) in Bengal
- Death of Francois Martin (1706) created a power vacuum; British expanded rapidly
- Dupleix (Joseph Francois Dupleix): French Governor General appointed 1742; most ambitious; began political interference in native states

► Three Carnatic Wars — Summary

War	Period	Cause	Result	Key Battle/Treaty
First Carnatic War	1746–1748	Austrian Succession War in Europe; spilt into India	Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748); Madras restored to British	French captured Madras (1746); La Bourdonnais
Second Carnatic War	1749–1754	Succession disputes in Hyderabad & Carnatic	Dupleix recalled to France (1754); French influence declined	Siege of Trichinopoly; Robert Clive rose to prominence
Third Carnatic War	1756–1763	Seven Years' War in Europe	French completely defeated; Treaty of Paris (1763) ended French power	Battle of Wandiwash (1760); Coote defeated Lally

★ Battle of Wandiwash (1760): British General Eyre Coote defeated French General Lally — decisive battle

★ Treaty of Paris (1763): French power in India ended; could only keep factories in Pondicherry, Karikal, Mahe, Yanam, Chandernagore

★ Dupleix was the first European to realize the political potential of Indian native states — revolutionary idea

★ Robert Clive established his reputation during the Second Carnatic War (1749-1754)

CHAPTER 2: BRITISH CONQUEST OF INDIA — KEY WARS & POLICIES

2.1 Battle of Plassey (1757) — Foundation of British Empire

Date	23 June 1757
Location	Plassey (Palashi), Bengal
British Commander	Robert Clive (Lord Clive)
Nawab of Bengal	Siraj-ud-Daula
Cause	Black Hole Tragedy (1756); Clive's political conspiracy with Mir Jafar
Key Betrayer	Mir Jafar (Commander of Nawab's army) — bribed by Clive
Result	Siraj-ud-Daula defeated and killed; Mir Jafar made Nawab
Significance	Laid foundation of British political power in India; considered a 'political transaction not a real battle'
Exam Importance	One of the most frequently tested events in ALL competitive exams

2.2 Battle of Buxar (1764) — More Decisive than Plassey

Date	22 October 1764
Location	Buxar (Bihar)
British Commander	Major Hector Munro
Alliance Against British	Mir Qasim (Bengal) + Shuja-ud-Daula (Awadh) + Shah Alam II (Mughal Emperor)
Result	British won decisively; Treaty of Allahabad (1765) signed
Treaty of Allahabad	Shah Alam II granted Diwani rights (revenue collection) of Bengal, Bihar, Orissa to EIC
Why More Important than Plassey	At Plassey, EIC defeated one Nawab. At Buxar, EIC defeated a combined force including the Mughal Emperor — established real supremacy
Exam Importance	Frequently asked comparison: Buxar vs Plassey; 'Diwani rights' most tested concept

2.3 Major Anglo-Mysore Wars (1767–1799)

War	Year	Ruler	British Governor	Key Outcome
First Anglo-Mysore War	1767–69	Hyder Ali	Madras Council	Treaty of Madras; Hyder Ali stronger
Second Anglo-Mysore War	1780–84	Hyder Ali / Tipu Sultan	Warren Hastings	Treaty of Mangalore (1784); British humiliated

War	Year	Ruler	British Governor	Key Outcome
Third Anglo-Mysore War	1790–92	Tipu Sultan	Cornwallis	Treaty of Srirangapatnam; Tipu lost half his kingdom and two sons as hostages
Fourth Anglo-Mysore War	1799	Tipu Sultan	Wellesley	Tipu Sultan died defending Srirangapatnam (4 May 1799); Mysore partitioned

★ Tipu Sultan — 'Tiger of Mysore'; first Indian ruler to use rockets in warfare (Mysorean rockets)

★ Tipu Sultan died on 4 May 1799 — date is frequently asked

★ Treaty of Mangalore (1784) — only treaty where British accepted humiliating terms from an Indian ruler

★ Hyder Ali — father of Tipu Sultan; uneducated but military genius; introduced French military training

★ Mysore Palace was given to the old Hindu Wodeyar dynasty after Tipu's death

2.4 Anglo-Maratha Wars (1775–1818)

War	Period	Governor General	Treaty / Result
First Anglo-Maratha War	1775–82	Warren Hastings	Treaty of Salbai (1782); status quo maintained
Second Anglo-Maratha War	1803–05	Wellesley	Treaty of Bassein (1802) triggered it; Marathas weakened; Delhi and Agra came to British
Third Anglo-Maratha War	1817–18	Hastings (Lord Moira)	Marathas completely defeated; Peshwa abolished; Maratha power ended

2.5 Subsidiary Alliance — Wellesley's Masterstroke

► Key Features of Subsidiary Alliance

- Introduced by Lord Wellesley (Governor General 1798-1805)
- Indian ruler had to accept British troops stationed in his territory
- Ruler paid 'subsidy' to maintain the British troops; if unable to pay, had to cede territory
- Ruler could not make foreign alliances without British permission
- Indian ruler had to accept a British Resident at his court
- Benefit to British: Ruler became fully dependent; British expanded territory without war

► States That Accepted Subsidiary Alliance (Chronological)

State	Year	Key Fact
Hyderabad	1798	First state to accept — most important exam fact
Mysore	1799	After Fourth Anglo-Mysore War
Tanjore	1799	South Indian state

State	Year	Key Fact
Awadh	1801	Nawab surrendered half his territory
Peshwa (Marathas)	1802	Treaty of Bassein — signed after defeat by Holkar

★ FIRST state to accept Subsidiary Alliance = HYDERABAD (1798) — Most frequently asked

★ Subsidiary Alliance concept inspired by French Governor Dupleix's earlier ideas

★ Lord Wellesley called himself 'the Great Mughal of India' due to his expansionist vision

★ Subsidiary Alliance eliminated the accountability of Indian rulers to their own people

2.6 Doctrine of Lapse — Lord Dalhousie (1848–1856)

► Key Provisions

- If a ruler died without a natural male heir, the state would be 'lapsed' (annexed) to British India
- Adopted sons could not inherit the throne under this policy
- Lord Dalhousie annexed maximum territories using this doctrine

► States Annexed Under Doctrine of Lapse

State	Year of Annexation	Reason
Satara	1848	No natural heir
Jaitpur & Sambhalpur	1849	No natural heir
Baghat	1850	No natural heir
Udaipur	1852	No natural heir
Jhansi	1853	Rani Lakshmibai's adopted son not recognized
Nagpur	1854	No natural heir
Awadh	1856	Misgovernance (NOT doctrine of lapse — annexed on charge of misrule)

★ Awadh was NOT annexed under Doctrine of Lapse — it was annexed for alleged misrule in 1856

★ Rani Lakshmibai of Jhansi — her son Damodar Rao's adoption not recognized; she joined 1857 revolt

★ Dalhousie also introduced railways (1853), telegraph (1853), and Postal Act (1854) in India

★ Satara was the FIRST state annexed under Doctrine of Lapse (1848)

2.7 Anglo-Sikh Wars & Conquest of Punjab

War	Year	Governor General	Treaty/Result
First Anglo-Sikh War	1845–46	Hardinge	Treaty of Lahore (1846); Ranjit Singh's empire weakened; Kashmir sold to Gulab Singh for Rs 75 lakh — Treaty of Amritsar
Second Anglo-Sikh War	1848–49	Dalhousie	Punjab annexed; Koh-i-Noor diamond taken to England; Punjab Board of Administration established

2.8 Other Wars & Expansions

► Anglo-Nepal Wars

- Anglo-Nepal War: 1814–1816 (Lord Hastings)
- Treaty of Sugauli (1815): Nepal gave up Sikkim, Himachal, Uttarakhand, and Terai region
- British Resident established at Kathmandu
- Gurkha soldiers recruited into British Indian Army — still continue today

► Anglo-Burmese Wars

War	Year	Governor General	Result
First Anglo-Burmese War	1824–26	Amherst	Treaty of Yandabo (1826); Arakan and Tenasserim taken
Second Anglo-Burmese War	1852	Dalhousie	Lower Burma annexed
Third Anglo-Burmese War	1885	Dufferin	Burma completely annexed; became part of British India in 1885; separated in 1937

► Anglo-Afghan Wars

War	Year	Governor General	Policy/Result
First Anglo-Afghan War	1838–42	Auckland	Forward Policy; British defeated; Dost Mohammad restored
Second Anglo-Afghan War	1878–80	Lytton	Masterly Inactivity policy replaced by Forward Policy; Treaty of Gandamak (1879)
Third Anglo-Afghan War	1919	Chelmsford	Afghan independence acknowledged

★ Durand Line (1893): Boundary between British India and Afghanistan, drawn by Sir Mortimer Durand

★ Durand Line today separates Pakistan and Afghanistan — still disputed

★ Younghusband Mission (1904): Lord Curzon sent it to Tibet; Treaty of Lhasa signed

★ NWFP (North West Frontier Province) created to control Afghan border regions

CHAPTER 3: IMPORTANT ACTS & CONSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENTS

3.1 Key Acts — Chronological Table

Act / Year	Governor General	Key Provisions	Exam Points
Regulating Act, 1773	Warren Hastings	First Parliamentary control over EIC; Governor of Bengal became Governor General; Supreme Court established at Calcutta; Council of 4 members	FIRST act to regulate EIC; Supreme Court 1774
Pitt's India Act, 1784	Macartney	Board of Control created for political affairs; Court of Directors for commercial; Dual government system; Company's territories called 'British possessions'	FIRST time EIC territories called 'British possessions'; Board of Control vs Court of Directors
Charter Act 1813	Hastings	EIC's monopoly over India trade ended; Christian missionaries allowed; Rs 1 lakh for Indian education	Trade monopoly ended; educational provisions
Charter Act 1833	Bentinck	EIC lost China trade monopoly; Governor General of Bengal → Governor General of India; Law Member added; slavery to be abolished	First Governor General of India = Bentinck; Law Commission established
Charter Act 1853	Dalhousie	Recruitment to Civil Services by open competition (competitive exams); Governor General's Council separated from Legislative Council; Last charter renewed	Competitive exams for civil services began; Macaulay Committee formed
Government of India Act 1858	Canning	Company rule ended; Crown rule began; Secretary of State for India created; Council of India (15 members); Viceroy replaced Governor General	Transfer of power from Company to Crown; First Viceroy = Lord Canning
Indian Councils Act 1861	Canning	Indians included in Legislative Council; Portfolio system; Viceroy could issue ordinances; Three High Courts established	First time Indians in legislative councils; High Courts at Calcutta, Bombay, Madras
Indian Councils Act 1892	Lansdowne	Some elected members in councils; right to discuss budget; limited enlargement of councils	Indirect election concept introduced
Morley-Minto Reforms 1909	Minto II	Indian Councils Act 1909; Separate electorates for Muslims (MOST IMPORTANT); one Indian in Viceroy's Executive Council; enlarged councils	FIRST separate electorate for Muslims; Satyendra Sinha first Indian in Executive Council
Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms 1919	Chelmsford	Dyarchy in provinces; two lists (reserved/transferred); bicameralism at Centre; All-India Public Service	FIRST time Dyarchy; FIRST bicameral

Act / Year	Governor General	Key Provisions	Exam Points
		Commission; Indians majority in Legislative Council	legislature in India; Direct elections
Government of India Act 1935	Willingdon/Linlithgow	Provincial Autonomy; Federal structure (never implemented); Dyarchy at Centre; RBI established; Federal Court; Burma separated	Most detailed act; LARGEST act in British Parliament; Federal Court became Supreme Court in 1950
Indian Independence Act 1947	Mountbatten	Two dominions: India and Pakistan; Partition; British rule ended 15 August 1947; Princely States free to join either	Last British act; India and Pakistan created as separate dominions

★ First Viceroy of India = Lord Canning (1858) — also last Governor General

★ Separate Electorates for Muslims first introduced in Morley-Minto Reforms (1909) — seeds of partition

★ Dyarchy: Provincial subjects split into 'Reserved' (controlled by Governor) and 'Transferred' (to Indian ministers)

★ GOI Act 1935 never fully implemented; Federal part never came into force; Provincial Autonomy did

★ Simon Commission (1927): All-British commission to review GOI Act 1919; Indians boycotted it — 'Simon Go Back'

3.2 Dual Government in Bengal (1765–1772)

- After Battle of Buxar (1764), Robert Clive introduced Dual Government in Bengal (1765)
- EIC got Diwani (revenue collection) rights from Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II
- Nizamat (law and order) remained with the Nawab
- Result: EIC collected revenue but didn't govern; Nawab governed but had no money
- Bihar famine of 1770: Over 1 crore people died due to administrative collapse
- Dual Government abolished by Warren Hastings in 1772

3.3 Important Governors General & Their Reforms

Governor General / Viceroy	Period	Key Reforms & Contributions
Robert Clive	1757–60, 1765–67	Plassey (1757); Dual Government (1765); abolished private trade by EIC servants
Warren Hastings	1772–85	Abolished Dual Government; Regulating Act 1773; First Peshkar; Rohilla War; Maratha diplomacy; First Governor General of Bengal
Lord Cornwallis	1786–93	Permanent Settlement (1793); Cornwallis Code; ICS started; Third Anglo-Mysore War

Governor General / Viceroy	Period	Key Reforms & Contributions
Lord Wellesley	1798–1805	Subsidiary Alliance; Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799); Second & Third Anglo-Maratha Wars; Fort William College (1800)
Lord Hastings (Moira)	1813–23	Ended Pindari menace; Third Anglo-Maratha War; Anglo-Nepal War; Treaty of Sugauli
Lord William Bentinck	1828–35	Abolition of Sati (1829); Suppression of Thuggee; Charter Act 1833; English medium education (Macaulay's Minute)
Lord Dalhousie	1848–56	Doctrine of Lapse; Railway (1853); Telegraph (1853); Postal Act (1854); Public Works Dept; Wood's Education Dispatch
Lord Canning	1856–62	First Viceroy (1858); Revolt of 1857; Government of India Act 1858; Indian Councils Act 1861; Universities Act 1857
Lord Curzon	1899–1905	Partition of Bengal (1905); Ancient Monuments Act; Punjab Land Alienation Act; Younghusband Mission; Official Secrets Act
Lord Hardinge II	1910–16	Transfer of capital Delhi (1911); Annulment of Partition of Bengal; Delhi Durbar (1911)
Lord Chelmsford	1916–21	Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919); Rowlatt Act (1919); Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919)
Lord Reading	1921–26	Non-Cooperation Movement; Moplah Rebellion; Chauri Chaura; Kakori Conspiracy
Lord Irwin	1926–31	Civil Disobedience Movement; Gandhi-Irwin Pact (1931); First Round Table Conference
Lord Linlithgow	1936–44	GOI Act 1935 implemented; Congress Provincial Ministries; Quit India Movement (1942)
Lord Mountbatten	1947	Last Viceroy; Mountbatten Plan (June 3, 1947); Indian Independence Act; Partition

CHAPTER 4: PEASANT, TRIBAL & EARLY REVOLTS BEFORE 1857

4.1 Early Peasant & Religious Revolts

Movement/Revolt	Period	Leader(s)	Region	Key Features
Sanyasi & Fakir Revolt	1763–1800	Majnu Shah, Musa Shah, Bhavani Pathak, Devi Chaudhurani	Bengal	Religious mendicants; resistance against EIC; mentioned in Bankim's Anandamath
Wahabi Movement	1820s onwards	Syed Ahmad Bareilvi, Shah Ismail	Bengal/NW Frontier	Islamic reform movement; jihad against non-Islamic rule; anti-British
Kuka (Namdhari) Movement	1840s–1872	Baba Ram Singh	Punjab	Social reform + anti-British; followers called 'Kukas'; Ram Singh exiled to Rangoon (1872)
Faraizi Movement	1838–57	Haji Shariatullah, Dudu Mian	Bengal (Eastern)	Islamic reform; anti-zamindari and anti-British; followers called 'Faraizis'
Titu Mir's Revolt (Narkelberia)	1831	Titu Mir (Mir Nisar Ali)	Bengal	Peasant uprising against indigo planters and Hindu zamindars; built bamboo fort
Moplah Uprising	1836–1921	Various (multiple uprisings)	Malabar, Kerala	Muslim peasants against Hindu zamindars; 1921 became communal — part of Non-Cooperation context
Pagalpanthi Revolt	1824–33	Karam Shah (Tipu)	Bengal (Garo Hills area)	Garo, Hajong tribes against British; syncretic Hindu-Muslim sect

4.2 Tribal Revolts (Major)

Revolt	Year	Leader	Region	Cause & Outcome
Chuar/Jungle Mahal Revolt	1795–1816	Durjan Singh, Jagannath Singh	Chhota Nagpur Plateau (Jharkhand)	Land alienation; against outsiders (dikus); British suppressed it
Kol Uprising	1831–32	Buddhu Bhagat, Joa Bhagat, Jhindrai Manki	Ranchi, Singhbhum, Hazaribagh	Transfer of tribal lands to outsiders; zamindars and moneylenders; 1,000+ killed

Revolt	Year	Leader	Region	Cause & Outcome
Ho Uprising	1820–22	Pokai Singrai	Singhbhum	Against British annexation; demand for autonomy
Santhal Uprising	1855–56	Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu	Rajmahal Hills (Jharkhand/West Bengal)	BLOODIEST tribal revolt before 1857; 20,000+ Santhals fought; Santhal Pargana created after suppression
Khond Uprising	1837–56	Chakra Bisoi	Srikakulam (Andhra Pradesh)	Against Lord Hardinge's ban on human sacrifice; against British interference in customs
Bhil Uprising	1818, 1825, 1831	Sewaram; later Govind Guru (1913)	Gujarat, Rajasthan	Land alienation; later Bijolia Movement (Rajasthan, 1920) by Motilal Tejawat
Khasi Uprising	1828–33	Tirath Singh (Tiroh Singh)	Meghalaya (Assam)	Against British entry and land alienation; guerrilla warfare
Munda Uprising (Ulgulan)	1899–1900	Birsa Munda	Ranchi, Jharkhand	Land rights; religious reform; 'Dharthi Aba' (father of earth) — Birsa Munda; British arrested him, died in jail 1900

★ Santhal Uprising (1855–56) = Bloodiest tribal revolt before 1857; Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu = leaders

★ Santhal Pargana (now in Jharkhand) created after the revolt — tribal area protection

★ Birsa Munda — declared 'Dharti Aba' (Father of Earth); Ulgulan (Great Tumult) = his revolt

★ Birsa Munda's birth anniversary (15 November) celebrated as Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas since 2021

★ Kuka/Namdhari Movement — Baba Ram Singh sent to Rangoon (Burma) in 1872; followers wore white

CHAPTER 5: THE REVOLT OF 1857 — FIRST WAR OF INDEPENDENCE

5.1 Overview

Started	10 May 1857 at Meerut
Names Given	Sepoy Mutiny (British); First War of Indian Independence (V.D. Savarkar, 1909); Sepoy Mutiny (Lawrence, Malletson); National Rising (Benjamin Disraeli)
Immediate Cause	Enfield Rifle and greased cartridges (cow/pig fat) offensive to Hindu and Muslim soldiers
Spread of Revolt	Started as sepoy mutiny in Meerut → spread to Delhi, Lucknow, Kanpur, Jhansi, Bareilly, Arrah
Ended	1858 — British completely suppressed the revolt
Governor General	Lord Canning (was Governor General; became first Viceroy in 1858)

5.2 Causes of the Revolt of 1857

► Immediate Cause

- Enfield rifle: cartridges greased with cow and pig fat had to be bitten before loading
- Offensive to both Hindus (cow sacred) and Muslims (pig forbidden/haram)
- British refused to address sepoys' grievances

► Military Causes

- Racial discrimination: Indian sepoys paid less, less respected than British officers
- General Service Enlistment Act (1856): Sepoys required to serve overseas — crossing 'kala pani'
- Indian sepoys sent to Crimea, Burma, Afghanistan without their consent

► Political Causes

- Doctrine of Lapse: annexation of native states (Jhansi, Nagpur, Awadh)
- Deposition of Nawab of Awadh (1856): sparked anger of Awadh soldiers in British army
- Annexation policy of Dalhousie created widespread insecurity among Indian rulers

► Economic Causes

- Ruin of Indian artisans and weavers: British machine-made goods flooded India
- Drain of wealth from India to England
- Destruction of Indian agricultural self-sufficiency; shift to cash crops

► Socio-Religious Causes

- Religious Disability Removal Act (1856): converted Indians could inherit ancestral property
- Fear of forced conversion to Christianity
- Interference with caste system; widow remarriage, Sati abolition seen as attacks on Hinduism

5.3 Centers of Revolt & Key Leaders

Center	Leader(s)	British Suppressor	Key Facts
Delhi	Bahadur Shah Zafar II (symbolic leader); Bakht Khan (military commander)	John Nicholson, Hudson	Sepoys marched from Meerut to Delhi; Zafar proclaimed emperor; captured by Hudson; last Mughal emperor exiled to Rangoon
Lucknow (Awadh)	Begum Hazrat Mahal, Birjis Qadr	Henry Lawrence (died), Colin Campbell	Most widespread; Residency under siege for months; Henry Lawrence died defending it
Kanpur	Nana Saheb (Dhondu Pant)	Campbell, Havelock	Nana Saheb escaped to Nepal after defeat; British recaptured Kanpur and massacred Indian garrison
Jhansi	Rani Lakshmibai	Hugh Rose	Rani Lakshmibai died fighting (17 June 1858); Hugh Rose called her 'bravest and best military leader'
Bareilly	Khan Bahadur Khan	Campbell	Prominent center of revolt in Rohilkhand
Arrah (Bihar)	Kunwar Singh (80-year-old zamindar)	Taylor, Vincent Eyre	Old man fought brilliantly; died after revolt at age ~80
Faizabad	Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah (Danka Shah)	—	Called 'Light of rebellion'; prophesied British defeat

5.4 Why the Revolt Failed

- Limited geographic spread — many parts of India unaffected
- No united national leadership — fragmented local command
- Lack of modern weapons and military strategy
- Some Indians (Sikhs, Gurkhas, Rajputs of some regions) helped British suppress revolt
- Better British communication — telegraph network
- Educated middle class largely did not join

5.5 Consequences of 1857 Revolt

- Government of India Act 1858: Company rule ended; Crown took over
- Queen Victoria's Proclamation (1858): Respect for native princes, religions, customs
- Indian Army reorganized: increased British officers, reduced Indian sepoy ratio
- Doctrine of Lapse abandoned — no more annexation of native states
- Policy of 'divide and rule' intensified
- Indian National Congress formed (1885) partly as a safety valve policy

★ V.D. Savarkar called it '1857 — The First War of Indian Independence' in his book (1909)

★ R.C. Majumdar called it a 'Sepoy Mutiny'; S.B. Chaudhuri called it 'Civil Rebellion'

★ Mangal Pandey fired the first shot at Barrackpore (29 March 1857) — first martyr of revolt

★ Rani Lakshmibai died on 17 June 1858 at Gwalior, not Jhansi — exam frequently confuses this

★ Kunwar Singh was about 80 years old when he led the revolt in Bihar — remarkable fact

★ Vellore Mutiny (1806) considered precursor/dress rehearsal for 1857

CHAPTER 6: SOCIAL & RELIGIOUS REFORM MOVEMENTS (19th Century)

6.1 Key Reform Movements & Organizations

Organization / Movement	Year	Founder	Region	Key Contributions
Brahmo Samaj	1828	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Bengal	Against Sati, child marriage, caste; promoted widow remarriage, English education; monotheism; 'Father of Indian Renaissance'
Prarthana Samaj	1867	Atmaram Pandurang (later M.G. Ranade)	Bombay	Social reform; opposed caste; influenced by Brahmo Samaj; Ramabai Ranade's work
Arya Samaj	1875	Swami Dayananda Saraswati	Punjab (initially Gujarat)	Go back to Vedas; opposed idol worship, caste discrimination; 'India for Indians'; Shuddhi movement
Theosophical Society	1875 (USA), 1882 (India)	H.P. Blavatsky, H.S. Olcott, Annie Besant (from 1893)	Adyar, Madras	Universal Brotherhood; combined Hindu, Buddhist thought; Annie Besant active in Indian politics
Ramakrishna Mission	1897	Swami Vivekananda (inspired by Ramakrishna Paramahansa)	Bengal (Belur Math)	Practical Vedanta; service to humanity as service to God; represented India at Chicago Parliament (1893)
Indian National Social Conference	1887	M.G. Ranade, Raghunath Rao	All-India	Social reform alongside political reform; widow remarriage, female education
Satyashodhak Samaj	1873	Jyotirao Phule	Maharashtra	Anti-caste; rights of OBCs; educated Dalits and women; called 'Mahatma' by followers
Aligarh Movement	1875	Sir Syed Ahmad Khan	UP (Aligarh)	Muslim modernization; Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College (1875) → AMU (1920); loyal to British
Servants of India Society	1905	Gopal Krishna Gokhale	Pune	Trained selfless workers for India's service; Gokhale = Gandhi's political guru
Deva Samaj	1887	Shiv Narain Agnihotri	Punjab	Scientific approach to social reform; Agnihotri called 'Guru Dev'

★ Sati abolished by Lord William Bentinck under Regulation XVII of 1829 — Raja Ram Mohan Roy's role

★ Raja Ram Mohan Roy = Father of Indian Renaissance / Modern India / Indian Nationalism

★ Swami Vivekananda at Chicago Parliament of World Religions (11 September 1893) — iconic speech

★ Gokhale = Gandhi's political guru; Ranade = Gokhale's mentor; sequence important

★ Jyotirao Phule opened first school for girls in Pune (1848) — with wife Savitribai Phule

★ Annie Besant later started Home Rule League (1916) and was Congress President (Calcutta, 1917)

CHAPTER 7: FORMATION OF INDIAN NATIONAL CONGRESS (INC)

7.1 Founding of INC (1885)

Year of Foundation	1885
Founder	Allan Octavian Hume (A.O. Hume) — retired British ICS officer
First Session	December 1885, Bombay (Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College)
First President	Womesh Chandra Banerjee (W.C. Banerjee)
Initial Delegates	72 delegates attended first session
Initial Aim	To provide a platform for discussion; moderate political demands; NOT independence
'Safety Valve Theory'	British supported it hoping it would provide a controlled outlet for Indian political aspirations — theory of Lala Lajpat Rai
Dufferin's Role	Viceroy Lord Dufferin helped in initial formation; later regretted it
Dadabhai Naoroji's Role	Grand Old Man of India; three times Congress President; coined 'Drain of Wealth' theory

7.2 Phases of Congress — Moderate, Extremist, Gandhian

Phase	Period	Key Leaders	Methods	Goal
Moderate Phase	1885–1905	Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, Surendra Nath Banerjee, Pherozeshah Mehta	Petitions, memorials, constitutional agitation, press writing	Administrative reforms, more Indian representation in councils
Extremist Phase	1905–1920	Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Lala Lajpat Rai, Bipin Chandra Pal (Lal-Bal-Pal)	Mass agitation, boycott, Swadeshi, militant nationalism	Swaraj (Self-rule)
Gandhian Phase	1919–1947	Mahatma Gandhi, Nehru, Subhas Bose, Patel, Azad	Non-violence, satyagraha, civil disobedience, mass movements	Complete Independence (Purna Swaraj)

7.3 Important INC Sessions — Exam Table

Session	Year	Place	President	Key Decision/Significance
1st Session	1885	Bombay	W.C. Banerjee	Foundation of Congress; 72 delegates; A.O. Hume
2nd Session	1886	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	First session in Calcutta
Calcutta Session	1906	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	First time 'Swaraj' demanded; Swadeshi, Boycott, National Education, Swaraj — 4 demands

Session	Year	Place	President	Key Decision/Significance
Surat Split	1907	Surat	Ras Bihari Ghosh	Congress split into Moderates and Extremists; Tilak vs Gokhale faction
Reunion Session	1916	Lucknow	Ambika Charan Mazumdar	Lucknow Pact — Congress-Muslim League pact; Tilak's group readmitted
Calcutta Special Session	1920	Calcutta	Lala Lajpat Rai	Non-Cooperation Movement approved; Gandhi takes control of Congress
Nagpur Session	1920	Nagpur	C. Vijayaraghavachariar	Non-Cooperation Movement formally launched; Provinces reorganized on linguistic lines in Congress
Calcutta Session	1928	Calcutta	Motilal Nehru	Nehru Report presented; Dominion Status vs Complete Independence debate
Lahore Session	1929	Lahore	Jawaharlal Nehru	PURNA SWARAJ (Complete Independence) declared; 26 January 1930 chosen as Independence Day
Karachi Session	1931	Karachi	Vallabhbhai Patel	Fundamental Rights and Economic Policy resolution; Gandhi-Irwin Pact ratified
Faizpur Session	1936	Faizpur (Maharashtra)	Jawaharlal Nehru	First session in a village; 1937 elections decided
Tripuri Session	1939	Tripuri (MP)	Subhas Chandra Bose (resigned)	Bose vs Gandhi; Bose won election over Pattabhi Sitaramayya; Bose resigned; Forward Bloc formed
Ramgarh Session	1940	Ramgarh	Abul Kalam Azad	Individual Civil Disobedience launched; Vinoba Bhave first satyagrahi

★ SURAT SPLIT (1907): Moderate vs Extremist — most important Congress event before Gandhi
★ LUCKNOW PACT (1916): Congress-Muslim League unity pact — Tilak and Jinnah's role
★ LAHORE SESSION (1929): Purna Swaraj declared; Nehru president; 'Poorna Azadi' demand
★ KARACHI SESSION (1931): Fundamental Rights resolution — most radical Congress resolution
★ Faizpur (1936): FIRST Congress session in a VILLAGE
★ Tripuri Session (1939): Subhas Bose defeated Gandhi's candidate Pattabhi Sitaramayya
★ A.O. Hume — called 'Father of the Indian National Congress'
★ First Woman President of Congress = Annie Besant (Calcutta, 1917)
★ First Indian Woman President of Congress = Sarojini Naidu (Kanpur, 1925)

CHAPTER 8: PARTITION OF BENGAL (1905) & SWADESHI MOVEMENT

8.1 Partition of Bengal (1905)

Announced	7 August 1905 (formal announcement; Swadeshi Movement started same day)
Implemented	16 October 1905 (official partition date)
Governor General	Lord Curzon
Official Reason	'Bengal is too large to govern' — administrative convenience
Real Reason	To divide Hindus and Muslims; undermine Bengali nationalism; weaken Congress stronghold
West Bengal	Hindu majority; included Bihar and Orissa (Bengali-speaking Hindus + Oriya + Hindi speakers)
East Bengal & Assam	Muslim majority; capital Dacca; Lieutenant Governor Sir Joseph Bamfylde Fuller
Annulled	1911 by Lord Hardinge II (Delhi Durbar, 1911) — victory for Indian nationalism
Exam Significance	7 August 1905 = National Handloom Day (observed today); 16 Oct = Rakhi Bandhan Day (communal harmony)

8.2 Swadeshi Movement (1905–1911)

► Features

- Started: 7 August 1905 at Calcutta Town Hall — formal resolution passed
- Boycott of British goods and promotion of Indian-made goods
- People dipped in Ganges; Rakhi tied between Hindus and Muslims; Rabindranath Tagore composed 'Amar Sonar Bangla'
- 16 October 1905: Declared 'Rakhi Day' — symbol of Hindu-Muslim unity

► Leaders of Swadeshi Movement

Leader	Region	Contribution
Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Maharashtra	Used Ganesh Festival and Shivaji Festival to spread nationalism; most radical
Lala Lajpat Rai	Punjab	Arya Samaj link; social reform + Swadeshi; joined with Tilak
Bipin Chandra Pal	Bengal	'Firebrand orator'; propagated militant nationalism in Bengal
V. Chidambaram Pillai	Tamil Nadu	Established Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company in Tuticorin to rival British shipping
Syed Haider Raza	Delhi	Swadeshi activities in Delhi
Aurobindo Ghosh	Bengal	Editor of Yugantar; advocated complete independence
Rabindranath Tagore	Bengal	Composed patriotic songs; Rakhi ceremony between communities

8.3 Surat Split (1907) — Congress Divided

Year	1907
Place	Surat
Cause	Dispute between Moderates (Gokhale, Pherozeshah Mehta) and Extremists (Tilak) over leadership and methods
Immediate Trigger	Extremists demanded Tilak as Congress president; Moderates chose Rash Bihari Ghosh
Result	Congress split into two factions; Moderates controlled the organization
Reunion	Lucknow Session 1916 — Extremists readmitted; Congress-Muslim League Lucknow Pact signed

8.4 Muslim League — Formation (1906)

Founded	30 December 1906
Place	Dacca (East Bengal)
Founder	Nawab Salimullah Khan of Dacca (hosted); Aga Khan III (first President)
Immediate Trigger	Simla Deputation (1906): Muslim leaders met Viceroy Minto; demanded separate electorate
First Session President	Nawab Viqar-ul-Mulk
Demand	Separate electorate for Muslims; protection of Muslim interests
British Role	British encouraged Muslim League as counterweight to Congress
Key Development	Morley-Minto Reforms (1909) gave separate electorates — Muslim League's first major success

★ Muslim League founded 1906 at DACCA — Nawab Salimullah hosted; Aga Khan was first President

★ Simla Deputation (1906): 35 Muslim leaders, led by Aga Khan, met Viceroy Minto — laid groundwork for Muslim League

★ SEPARATE ELECTORATES first granted in Morley-Minto Reforms 1909 — seeds of partition planted

★ Lucknow Pact (1916): Congress accepted separate electorates in exchange for political unity against British

CHAPTER 9: REVOLUTIONARY NATIONALISM IN INDIA

9.1 Major Revolutionary Organizations

Organization	Year	Founder/Leader	Region	Key Activities
Abhinav Bharat Society	1904	V.D. Savarkar	Maharashtra / London	Secret society; Nashik Conspiracy Case (1909); inspired by Mazzini
Anushilan Samiti	1902/1905	P. Mitter (Calcutta), Barindra Ghosh	Bengal	Physical fitness + revolutionary activities; Alipore Bomb Case (1908)
Jugantar	1906	Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Aurobindo Ghosh	Bengal	Revolutionary newspaper; preached violent overthrow of British
India House (London)	1905	Shyamji Krishna Varma	London	Centre for Indian revolutionaries in England; V.D. Savarkar, Madanlal Dhingra associated
Ghadar Party	1913	Lala Hardayal	San Francisco, USA	Indians in North America; planned armed uprising; active in Punjab
Hindu Mahasabha	1915	Madan Mohan Malaviya	All-India	Hindu political organization
Hindustan Republican Association (HSRA)	1924	Sachin Sanyal; later Ram Prasad Bismil	UP/Punjab	Kakori Train Robbery (1925); later became HSRA under Bhagat Singh
Naujawan Bharat Sabha	1926	Bhagat Singh	Punjab	Youth revolutionary organization; linked to HSRA
Indian Independence League	1928	Subhas Chandra Bose (later)	South-East Asia	Precursor to INA activities

9.2 Major Revolutionary Events

Event	Year	Key People	Details & Significance
Chapeki Dutta / Chapekar Brothers	1897	Bal Gangadhar Chapekar, Damodar Chapekar	Killed W.C. Rand (plague commissioner) in Pune; first political assassination; brothers executed
Alipore Bomb Case / Maniktala Case	1908	Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Aurobindo Ghosh, Khudiram Bose	Khudiram Bose (youngest revolutionary) threw bomb at Kingsford's carriage; hanged; Aurobindo acquitted

Event	Year	Key People	Details & Significance
Madanlal Dhingra	1909	Madanlal Dhingra	Killed Curzon Wylie (ADC to Secretary of State) in London; executed; V.D. Savarkar connection
Nashik Conspiracy Case	1909	Anant Laxman Kanhere	Killed Collector Jackson of Nashik; V.D. Savarkar arrested; transported to Andamans
Delhi-Lahore Conspiracy	1912	Rash Behari Bose	Bomb thrown at Viceroy Hardinge during Delhi Durbar procession; Hardinge wounded
Ghadar Movement	1914–15	Lala Hardayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna, Kartar Singh Sarabha	Indians from USA/Canada planned to return to India to start revolt; suppressed; Lahore Conspiracy Case
Kakori Train Robbery	1925	Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqullah Khan, Rajendra Lahiri, Roshan Singh	Looted British treasury train at Kakori (near Lucknow); leaders hanged on 19 December 1927
Lahore Conspiracy Case / Saunders Murder	1928	Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, Sukhdev	Saunders killed in revenge for Lala Lajpat Rai's death; Bhagat Singh + Rajguru + Sukhdev hanged 23 March 1931
Central Assembly Bomb Case	1929	Bhagat Singh, Batukeshwar Dutt	Threw bombs in Central Legislative Assembly to 'make the deaf hear'; both arrested; Bhagat Singh gave historic statement
Chittagong Armoury Raid	1930	Surya Sen (Masterda)	Raided British armoury at Chittagong; set up provisional revolutionary government; Surya Sen hanged 1934

★ Bhagat Singh hanged on 23 March 1931 (Lahore Jail) along with Rajguru and Sukhdev — 'Shaheed Diwas'

★ Khudiram Bose — YOUNGEST revolutionary to be hanged (1908); age ~18

★ Kakori Train Robbery — 9 August 1925; Ram Prasad Bismil and Ashfaqullah Khan executed together

★ Surya Sen = 'Masterda'; Chittagong Armoury Raid 1930 — first to declare a revolutionary government

★ V.D. Savarkar wrote '1857: The First War of Indian Independence' while in London before arrest

★ Ghadar Party founded in San Francisco (1913); Lala Hardayal; published Ghadar newspaper

CHAPTER 10: GANDHIAN ERA — MOVEMENTS & CAMPAIGNS

10.1 Gandhi — Life and Background

Full Name	Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi
Born	2 October 1869, Porbandar, Gujarat (father was Diwan)
Education	Bhavnagar, then London (bar-at-law, Inner Temple, 1891)
South Africa	1893–1914; went for one month, stayed 21 years; worked for Dada Abdulla & Co.
Incident at Pietermaritzburg	Thrown out of first-class train compartment despite valid ticket — turning point
Phoenix Settlement	1904, Durban — First ashram Gandhi established
Tolstoy Farm	1909 — Second commune; influenced by Leo Tolstoy's writings
Natal Indian Congress	1894 — Founded by Gandhi in South Africa
Indian Opinion	1903 — Gandhi's newspaper in South Africa
Indian Relief Act	1914 — South African government accepted most of Gandhi's demands
Return to India	9 January 1915 — celebrated as Pravasi Bharatiya Diwas (NRI Day)
Political Guru	Gopal Krishna Gokhale — Gandhi considered Gokhale his political guru

10.2 Gandhi's Campaigns in South Africa

Issue	Year	Action	Outcome
Boer War	1899–1902	Gandhi served in Ambulance Corps supporting British side	Gandhi was still moderate; received Kaiser-i-Hind medal
Asiatic Registration Act (Black Act)	1906	Gandhi organized first Satyagraha in South Africa; burned registration certificates	Act eventually withdrawn; first use of Satyagraha as a weapon
Poll Tax on Ex-Indentured Laborers	1913	Transvaal March — marched with 2,000+ workers from Natal to Transvaal	Government agreed to negotiate; Indian Relief Act 1914
Invalid Marriage Judgment	1913	Protest against court ruling invalidating non-Christian marriages	Part of Transvaal March; included in Indian Relief Act
Immigration Restrictions	1913–14	Passive resistance; Transvaal March	Most restrictions relaxed in Indian Relief Act 1914

10.3 Gandhi's Early Satyagrahas in India (1917–1918)

Satyagraha	Year	Place	Issue	Outcome
Champaran Satyagraha	1917	Champaran, Bihar	Indigo planters forced farmers to grow indigo on 3/20 of their land ('Tinkathia System')	First civil disobedience in India; Tinkathia system abolished; Gandhi's first success in India
Kheda Satyagraha	1918	Kheda, Gujarat	Crop failure but government demanded full revenue; farmers couldn't pay	Government temporarily suspended revenue collection; Sardar Patel's first major role
Ahmedabad Mill Strike	1918	Ahmedabad, Gujarat	Mill workers' wage dispute; demanded 35% increase	Gandhi's FIRST hunger strike; arbitration resulted in 35% wage increase; Anusuya Sarabhai's role

★ Champaran = Gandhi's FIRST satyagraha in India (1917) — against indigo planting 'Tinkathia' system

★ Kheda Satyagraha 1918 = Sardar Patel's first major national role — he organized it

★ Ahmedabad Mill Strike 1918 = Gandhi's FIRST hunger strike in India

★ Rajkumar Shukla — peasant who persuaded Gandhi to come to Champaran

★ Champaran Agrarian Act 1917 abolished the Tinkathia system

10.4 Rowlatt Act & Jallianwala Bagh (1919)

Rowlatt Act	18 March 1919 — also called 'Black Act' or 'No Vakil, No Daleel, No Appeal'
Purpose	Allowed detention without trial; suppression of revolutionary activities
Gandhi's Response	Called for hartal (strike) on 6 April 1919; started Non-Cooperation movement
Jallianwala Bagh Date	13 April 1919 (Baisakhi Day)
Commander	General Reginald Dyer ordered the firing without warning
Death Toll	Official: 379; Unofficial estimates: 1,000+; over 1,200 wounded
Political Impact	Shocked the world; Rabindranath Tagore renounced his knighthood in protest
Hunter Commission	Appointed to inquire; criticized Dyer; Dyer dismissed from service
Udham Singh	Killed Michael O'Dwyer (Lt. Governor of Punjab) in London on 13 March 1940 in revenge

10.5 Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922)

Period	1920–1922
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Launched	1 August 1920 (also day Bal Gangadhar Tilak died)
Formally Approved	Calcutta Special Session (September 1920); Nagpur Session (December 1920)
Key Demands	Withdrawal of Rowlatt Act; punish Jallianwala Bagh perpetrators; Khilafat grievances
Methods	Boycott of schools, colleges, law courts, councils; surrender of titles; boycott of foreign goods; Khilafat+Hindu unity
Khilafat Issue	Linked Muslim anger over Ottoman Caliphate being dismantled after WWI; Ali Brothers (Mohammad Ali, Shaukat Ali) led
Called Off	February 1922 after Chauri Chaura incident (UP): crowd burned police station killing 22 policemen
Gandhi's Logic	Violence unacceptable; movement called off unilaterally — criticized by many leaders
Key Outcome	Gandhi arrested and convicted (1922); sentenced to 6 years; released 1924
Historical Significance	First mass movement involving peasants, artisans, and common people under Gandhi

★ Non-Cooperation Movement called off on 12 February 1922 — Chauri Chaura incident (4 February 1922)

★ Chauri Chaura: Gorakhpur district, UP — mob burned police chowki, 22 policemen killed

★ Tilak died on 1 August 1920 — same day Gandhi launched NCM — coincidence often asked

★ Khilafat Movement: Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali (Ali Brothers) leaders; merged with NCM

★ NCM called off = most controversial Gandhi decision; criticized by Subhas Bose, Motilal Nehru, Lajpat Rai

10.6 Civil Disobedience Movement — Dandi March (1930)

Date	12 March 1930 — Started; Reached Dandi 6 April 1930
Gandhi started from	Sabarmati Ashram, Ahmedabad
Route	Ahmedabad → Dandi (Navsari, Gujarat) — 241 miles (388 km)
Duration	24 days; 78 selected followers
Salt Law Broken	6 April 1930 — Gandhi picked up a handful of salt at Dandi
Significance	Defied British monopoly on salt; entire country started making salt; global media attention
Gandhi-Irwin Pact	5 March 1931 — Gandhi agreed to suspend CDM; attend Second Round Table Conference
2nd Round Table Conference	September-December 1931, London; Gandhi represented Congress; no settlement
CDM Relaunched	1932 after Gandhi's return; suppressed harshly — Communal Award issue
Poona Pact	25 September 1932 — Gandhi vs Ambedkar; Gandhi's fast-unto-death; Poona Pact on reserved seats for Dalits

★ Dandi March started: 12 March 1930; Salt law broken: 6 April 1930 — BOTH dates important
★ 78 followers accompanied Gandhi from Sabarmati; 241 miles/388 km; 24 days
★ Abdul Ghaffar Khan (Frontier Gandhi) led 'Red Shirts' (Khudai Khidmatgar) in NWFP during CDM
★ Rani Gaidinliu — Naga tribal leader who joined CDM at age 13; 'Nagaland's Joan of Arc'; Nehru called her 'Rani'
★ Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 March 1931): CDM suspended; political prisoners released; salt manufacture allowed near seacoast
★ Poona Pact (1932): Gandhi vs B.R. Ambedkar over separate electorate for untouchables

10.7 Individual Civil Disobedience (1940–1941)

- Launched at Ramgarh Congress (1940) during World War II
- Not mass civil disobedience; selected individuals offered symbolic satyagraha against war
- First Satyagrahi: Vinoba Bhave — selected by Gandhi (17 October 1940)
- Second Satyagrahi: Jawaharlal Nehru
- Around 25,000 leaders arrested in this movement

10.8 Quit India Movement (1942)

Date Launched	8 August 1942 — Bombay (Gowalia Tank Maidan / August Kranti Maidan)
Gandhi's Slogan	'Do or Die' (Karo ya Maro)
Congress Working Committee	Resolution passed at Wardha (14 July 1942); formally approved 8 August 1942
Leaders Arrested	Gandhi, Nehru, Patel, Azad — ALL arrested on 9 August 1942 (pre-dawn)
Gandhi's Internment	Aga Khan Palace, Pune
Cripps Mission Failure	Cripps Mission (1942) failed to offer a satisfactory deal — triggered Quit India
Aruna Asaf Ali	Hoisted national flag at Gowalia Tank after leaders arrested — 'Heroine of 1942'
Underground Activities	Ram Manohar Lohia, Jayaprakash Narayan, Achyut Patwardhan organized underground
Parallel Governments	Satara (Maharashtra) — Y.B. Chavan area; Ballia (UP) — Chittu Pandey; Midnapore (Bengal) — Tamluk Jatiya Sarkar
Suppression	Most brutal suppression; 100,000+ arrested; villages bombed; 1,000+ killed
Historical Significance	Demonstrated that British must leave; mass uprising without central leadership

★ 8 August 1942 = Quit India Movement launched; Gowalia Tank Maidan, Bombay
★ 9 August 1942 = All top leaders arrested; 9 August = 'Kranti Diwas' (Revolution Day)
★ 'Do or Die' slogan given by Gandhi at the 8 August session

★ Aruna Asaf Ali — hoisted flag at Gowalia Tank after arrests; 'Heroine of 1942'

★ JP Narayan (Jayaprakash Narayan) escaped from Hazaribagh Jail to organize underground movement

★ Cripps Mission (March-April 1942): Stafford Cripps came; offered Dominion Status after war; rejected by Congress

★ Ballia Revolt (August 1942): Chittu Pandey established 'parallel government' in Ballia, UP

CHAPTER 11: SUBHAS CHANDRA BOSE & INDIAN NATIONAL ARMY (INA)

11.1 Subhas Chandra Bose — Key Facts

Born	23 January 1897, Cuttack, Orissa
Education	Cambridge University; passed ICS examination but resigned
Political Mentor	Chittaranjan Das (C.R. Das)
Newspaper Founded	Swaraj (1923)
Congress President	1938 (Haripura, near Surat) and 1939 (Tripuri)
Tripuri Crisis	Defeated Gandhi's candidate Patabhi Sitaramayya; resigned under pressure
Forward Bloc	Founded 1939 — after resigning from Congress presidency
Escape from India	January 1941 — escaped from house arrest; went via Kabul, Moscow to Berlin
Germany	Met Hitler; formed Indian Legion (Freies Indien Legion) from POWs
Singapore (INA)	July 1943 — arrived; took command of Indian National Army from Rash Behari Bose
Azad Hind Government	21 October 1943 — declared Provisional Government of Free India in Singapore
INA Campaign	1944 — INA entered India through Manipur; captured Moirang; planted INA flag
Titles Given	Called 'Netaji' (Revered Leader); soldiers called him 'Father of the Nation' before Gandhi
Death	18 August 1945 — died in plane crash at Taihoku (Taipei), Taiwan — still debated

11.2 Indian National Army (INA) — Azad Hind Fauj

Originally Founded	September 1942 in Singapore by Captain Mohan Singh with Japanese support
Revived Under Bose	July 1943; Rash Behari Bose handed over command to Subhas Bose
Motto	'Jai Hind' (Hail India) — popularized by Bose; became India's national salutation
Regiments	Gandhi Brigade, Nehru Brigade, Subhas Brigade; Rani Jhansi Regiment (women's unit)
Rani Jhansi Regiment	First women's military unit in Indian history; led by Captain Lakshmi Sahgal
Delhi Chalo	Battle cry of INA — 'Onward to Delhi'
Japanese Support	INA fought alongside Japanese Army in Burma and Manipur campaigns
INA Trials	1945-46 — British tried INA officers at Red Fort, Delhi; created massive public sympathy
Defense Lawyers	Jawaharlal Nehru, Bhulabhai Desai, Tej Bahadur Sapru defended INA prisoners
Political Impact	INA trials accelerated independence; even British soldiers began sympathizing

★ Azad Hind Government declared: 21 October 1943, Singapore — Bose became Head of State

★ Rani Jhansi Regiment = first women's regiment; Captain Lakshmi Sahgal commanded it

★ 'Dilli Chalo' (March to Delhi) = INA's battle cry

★ 'Jai Hind' slogan originated with Bose and INA; became India's national slogan

★ INA Trials at Red Fort (1945-46) — Captain Shah Nawaz Khan, Colonel Prem Kumar Sahgal, Colonel G.S. Dhillon tried

★ Haripura Session (1938): Bose first became Congress President; 51 decorated bullocks pulled his chariot

CHAPTER 12: HOME RULE MOVEMENT, KHILAFAT & INTERIM GOVERNMENT

12.1 Home Rule Movement (1916)

Feature	Tilak's League	Annie Besant's League
Founded	April 1916 (Belgaum)	September 1916 (Adyar, Madras)
Founded By	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Annie Besant (with George Arundale)
Area	Maharashtra, Karnataka, Central Provinces, Berar	Rest of India
Demand	Home Rule (Self-Government within British Empire)	Home Rule (Self-Government within British Empire)
Method	Mass education, public meetings, newspapers	Lectures, newspapers, public agitation
Ended	Merged with Congress in 1920	Annie Besant was interned in 1917; released; became Congress President 1917

- ★ Tilak's Home Rule League founded April 1916 — Annie Besant's founded September 1916
- ★ Annie Besant = FIRST WOMAN President of Indian National Congress (Calcutta, 1917)
- ★ Home Rule concept inspired by Irish Home Rule Movement; Tilak said 'Swaraj is my birthright'
- ★ Tilak's famous declaration: 'Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it'

12.2 Lucknow Pact (1916) — Congress-League Unity

Year	1916
Signatories	Indian National Congress (Tilak's faction) and Muslim League
Key Provisions	Congress accepted separate electorates for Muslims; League agreed to support demand for self-government
Tilak's Role	Led Congress faction; architect of the pact; showed Hindu-Muslim unity possible
Jinnah's Role	Key Muslim League representative; agreed on joint political demands
Significance	Period of Hindu-Muslim unity in politics; both organizations united against British
Later Impact	Congress later regretted accepting separate electorates; gave legitimacy to two-nation concept

12.3 Important Committees, Commissions & Missions

Commission/Mission	Year	Purpose/Composition	Key Outcome/Fact
Welby Commission	1895	Review EIC finances	Dadabhai Naoroji was member — first Indian in such a position
Hunter Commission (Education)	1882	Review education policy	Recommended mass primary education
Hunter Commission (Jallianwala)	1919	Inquire into Jallianwala Bagh massacre	Criticized Dyer; Dyer dismissed but given hero's welcome in Britain
Simon Commission	1927–28	Review GoI Act 1919 — all British; NO Indian member	Indians boycotted; 'Simon Go Back'; Lala Lajpat Rai lathi-charged; died 17 Nov 1928
Nehru Report	1928	Indian parties' own constitution draft (response to Simon)	Motilal Nehru chaired; demanded Dominion Status; Jinnah rejected separate electorates
Jinnah's 14 Points	1929	Muslim League counter to Nehru Report	Demanded separate electorates, 1/3 Muslim seats in Centre, Sindh separate province
First Round Table Conference	Nov 1930-Jan 1931	British and Indian parties except Congress	Congress boycotted; no settlement
Second Round Table Conference	Sep-Dec 1931	Gandhi attended alone for Congress; Ambedkar also attended	No agreement on communal award; Gandhi returned; CDM relaunched
Communal Award	1932	Ramsay MacDonald gave separate electorates to depressed classes (Dalits)	Gandhi fasted; Poona Pact replaced it
Third Round Table Conference	Nov-Dec 1932	Congress boycotted again	No important outcome
Cripps Mission	March-April 1942	Stafford Cripps came with offer of Dominion Status after WWII	Rejected by Congress ('Post-dated cheque on a crashing bank' — Gandhi); Quit India followed
Wavell Plan / Simla Conference	June-July 1945	Lord Wavell's plan for interim government; Simla Conference	Failed because Jinnah insisted Muslim League = sole representative of Muslims
Cabinet Mission	May-June 1946	Three British ministers: Stafford Cripps, A.V. Alexander, Lord Pethick-Lawrence	Three-tier structure proposed; constituent assembly plan; Congress and League initially accepted then disagreed
Mountbatten Plan (3 June Plan)	June 1947	Partition of India accepted; dominion status	India and Pakistan created; 15 August 1947 set as transfer of power date
Radcliffe Commission	1947	Sir Cyril Radcliffe — drew partition line (Punjab and Bengal)	Radcliffe Line — India-Pakistan border; Radcliffe had never visited India before

★ Simon Commission (1927): All-British; NO Indian member; Indians boycotted; Lala Lajpat Rai died

★ Nehru Report (1928): Motilal Nehru; Demanded Dominion Status; Congress's own constitutional draft

★ Cripps Mission: Gandhi called it 'Post-dated cheque on a crashing bank'

★ Cabinet Mission (1946): Three-tier structure (Centre + Groups + Provinces) — complex plan that failed

★ Radcliffe Line: Drawn by Sir Cyril Radcliffe who had NEVER been to India — controversial partition line

★ Wavell Plan (1945): Failed because Jinnah demanded Muslim League = sole Muslim representative

CHAPTER 13: ROAD TO INDEPENDENCE — PARTITION & FREEDOM (1945–1947)

13.1 Post-War Developments (1945–1946)

- End of World War II (1945): Britain weakened; Labour Government under Clement Attlee came to power
- INA Trials (1945–46): Created massive national sympathy; Royal Indian Navy Mutiny (February 1946) shocked British
- Cabinet Mission (1946): Proposed three-tier grouping plan; Constituent Assembly
- Direct Action Day: 16 August 1946 — Jinnah called for 'Direct Action'; Great Calcutta Killings
- Interim Government: September 1946 — Nehru headed Interim Government; Muslim League joined October 1946 but obstructed
- Constituent Assembly: First met 9 December 1946; Dr. Rajendra Prasad elected President; Sachchidananda Sinha was first temporary President

13.2 Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947)

Date Announced	3 June 1947
Announced by	Lord Mountbatten (Last Viceroy)
Key Provisions	Partition of India into two dominions — India and Pakistan; Punjab and Bengal to be partitioned; NWFP and Sylhet referendum; Princely States to join either dominion
Radcliffe Commission	Sir Cyril Radcliffe drew the boundary line; Punjab and Bengal boundaries
Punjab Decision	Punjab Legislative Assembly voted for partition
Bengal Decision	Bengal Legislative Assembly voted for partition
NWFP	Referendum held (Congress won assembly but British arranged referendum); NWFP joined Pakistan
Princely States	Given option to join India or Pakistan; no independence allowed
Indian Independence Act	Passed by British Parliament; based on Mountbatten Plan
Why 15 August	Mountbatten chose 15 August — date Japanese surrendered in WWII; significant to him personally

13.3 Independence — Key Dates

Event	Date	Significance
Indian Independence Act	18 July 1947	Act passed in British Parliament; gave legal basis for partition
Pakistan Independence	14 August 1947	Pakistan became independent dominion
India Independence	15 August 1947	India became independent dominion; Nehru's 'Tryst with Destiny' speech
India as Republic	26 January 1950	Constitution adopted; India became fully sovereign Republic

Event	Date	Significance
Constitution Passed	26 November 1949	Constitution adopted by Constituent Assembly
Republic Day Significance	26 January 1930	Purna Swaraj declaration — linked to 26 January 1950 Republic Day

★ 15 August 1947: Lord Mountbatten transferred power; Nehru's midnight speech 'Tryst with Destiny'
★ 26 November 1949: Constitution adopted; Constitution Day (Samvidhan Diwas) celebrated
★ 26 January 1950: Constitution came into force; India became Republic
★ 26 January chosen: To commemorate 26 January 1930 Purna Swaraj declaration — exactly 20 years
★ First President of India: Dr. Rajendra Prasad (elected by Constituent Assembly)
★ Partition reasons: Communalism, British divide-and-rule, two-nation theory, Muslim League demand
★ Factors of Partition: Separate electorates (1909) → Lahore Resolution (1940) → Direct Action Day (1946) → Partition (1947)

CHAPTER 14: NEWSPAPERS, JOURNALS & IMPORTANT SLOGANS

14.1 Important Newspapers & Journals

Newspaper/Journal	Founder/Editor	Year	Language	Key Facts
Bengal Gazette	James Augustus Hicky	1780	English	First newspaper in India; also called 'Hicky's Gazette'
Sambad Kaumudi	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1821	Bengali	Social reform; against Sati; first important vernacular newspaper
Mirat-ul-Akbar	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1822	Persian	First Persian newspaper by an Indian
The Hindu	G. Subramaniya Aiyar, M. Veeraraghavacharyar	1878	English	Chennai; nationalist; still published
Kesari	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	1881	Marathi	Nationalist; 'Lion'; Tilak used it to spread nationalism
Mahratta	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	1881	English	Companion newspaper to Kesari
Sudharak	G.K. Gokhale	1888	Marathi	Social reform; Poona
Yugantar	Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Bhupendranath Dutta	1906	Bengali	Revolutionary; preached armed struggle
Kal	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	1908	Hindi	Nationalist
Sandhya	Brahmabandhav Upadhyay	1904	Bengali	Extremist nationalist
The Comrade	Mohammad Ali	1911	English	Pro-Khilafat; edited by Mohammad Ali
Al-Hilal	Abul Kalam Azad	1912	Urdu	Nationalist; anti-British; Maulana Azad published
Al-Balagh	Abul Kalam Azad	1915	Urdu	After Al-Hilal was banned
Young India	Mahatma Gandhi	1919	English	Gandhi's views; later became Harijan
Navajivan	Mahatma Gandhi	1919	Gujarati	Gandhi's Gujarati newspaper
Harijan	Mahatma Gandhi	1933	English	Focus on Dalit rights and upliftment
Indian Opinion	Mahatma Gandhi	1903	English	Gandhi's South Africa newspaper
Ghadar	Lala Hardayal	1913	Urdu/Punjabi	Published from San Francisco; anti-British
New India	Annie Besant	1914	English	Home Rule advocate
Commonweal	Annie Besant	1914	English	Home Rule; Theosophical Society
Swadeshabhimani	K. Ramakrishna Pillai	1905	Malayalam	Kerala; first Malayalam nationalist paper; editor jailed
Forward	Subhas Chandra Bose	1923	English	Bose's newspaper in Bengal

Newspaper/Journal	Founder/Editor	Year	Language	Key Facts
Dawn	Muslim League	1941	English	Official organ of Muslim League
Bombay Samachar	Fardoonji Murzban	1822	Gujarati	Oldest surviving newspaper in Asia

14.2 Important Slogans & Their Originators

Slogan	Who Said It	Context/Significance
Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it	Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Home Rule Movement; most famous pre-Gandhi nationalist slogan
Vande Mataram	Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay (from novel Anandamath, 1882)	Became rallying cry of Swadeshi Movement; now India's National Song
Jai Hind	Subhas Chandra Bose / INA	INA's salutation; became India's national slogan
Do or Die (Karo ya Maro)	Mahatma Gandhi	Quit India Movement, 8 August 1942
Give me blood, I shall give you freedom	Subhas Chandra Bose	INA soldiers in South-East Asia
Dilli Chalo (March to Delhi)	Subhas Chandra Bose	INA's battle cry toward India
Simon Go Back	Nationwide protest (Lala Lajpat Rai led)	Against Simon Commission, 1928
Inquilab Zindabad (Long Live Revolution)	Bhagat Singh (also attributed to Maulana Hasrat Mohani)	Revolutionary slogan; Bhagat Singh shouted in Central Assembly
Sarfarooshi ki tamanna ab hamare dil mein hai	Ram Prasad Bismil	Revolutionary poem; associated with Kakori revolutionaries
Sare Jahan Se Achha Hindustan Hamara	Mohammad Iqbal (1904)	Written before Iqbal's views changed; remains iconic patriotic song
One country, one God, one caste, one mind, men all belonging to one family	Sri Narayana Guru	Social equality in Kerala; Ezhava community reformer
Dharti Aba (Father of Earth)	Tribal communities for Birsa Munda	Title given to Birsa Munda by his followers
Poverty is not a natural but a manufactured product	Dadabhai Naoroji	Drain of Wealth theory; poverty as consequence of British rule

CHAPTER 15: MASTER TIMELINE & QUICK REVISION

15.1 Master Chronological Timeline

Year	Event
1498	Vasco da Gama arrived Calicut (Portuguese)
1600	East India Company founded (31 Dec)
1605	Dutch arrived Masulipatnam
1608	English (EIC) arrived Surat
1612	Battle of Swally — British defeated Portuguese
1620	Danish arrived Tranquebar
1668	French arrived; Bombay transferred to EIC
1674	Pondicherry founded by Francois Martin (French)
1690	Calcutta/Fort William founded by Charnock
1700	Fort William officially established
1717	Farrukhsiyar's Farman — 'Magna Carta'
1742	Dupleix became French Governor General in India
1757	Battle of Plassey (23 June) — British defeated Nawab of Bengal
1760	Battle of Wandiwash — British defeated French
1763	Treaty of Paris — end of French power in India
1764	Battle of Buxar (22 October) — British defeated combined Indian force
1765	Diwani rights granted to EIC by Shah Alam II
1773	Regulating Act — first Parliamentary control over EIC
1784	Pitt's India Act — Board of Control created
1799	Tipu Sultan died (4 May); Fourth Anglo-Mysore War ended
1806	Vellore Mutiny — precursor to 1857
1813	Charter Act — EIC's India trade monopoly ended
1828	Lord William Bentinck became GG; Brahmo Samaj founded
1829	Abolition of Sati (Regulation XVII)
1833	Charter Act; First GG of India = Bentinck
1835	English medium education — Macaulay's Minute
1848	Lord Dalhousie; Doctrine of Lapse began (Satara)
1853	First railway (Bombay-Thane, 16 April); Charter Act 1853
1855	Santhal Uprising — Sidhu and Kanhu Murmu
1857	Revolt of 1857 (10 May, Meerut); Company rule ended 1858

Year	Event
1858	Government of India Act; Lord Canning = First Viceroy
1861	Indian Councils Act; Three High Courts
1875	Arya Samaj (Dayananda); Satyashodhak Samaj (Phule)
1878	Vernacular Press Act (Lytton)
1882	Hunter Education Commission; Ilbert Bill controversy
1885	Indian National Congress founded (December); First session Bombay
1893	Vivekananda at Chicago Parliament; Durand Line
1897	Ramakrishna Mission (Vivekananda); Chapekar Brothers
1899	Lord Curzon became Viceroy
1905	Partition of Bengal (7 Aug — Swadeshi; 16 Oct — official); Servants of India Society
1906	All-India Muslim League (30 Dec, Dacca); Calcutta INC session; first 'Swaraj' demand
1907	Surat Split — Congress divided
1909	Morley-Minto Reforms; separate electorates for Muslims
1911	Partition of Bengal annulled; Capital transferred to Delhi; Delhi Durbar
1913	Ghadar Party (San Francisco)
1915	Gandhi returned to India (9 Jan)
1916	Lucknow Pact; Home Rule Leagues (Tilak + Besant)
1917	Champaran Satyagraha; Montagu Declaration
1918	Kheda + Ahmedabad Satyagrahas
1919	Rowlatt Act; Jallianwala Bagh (13 April); Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms
1920	Non-Cooperation Movement (1 August); Khilafat Movement
1922	Chauri Chaura (4 Feb); NCM called off; Gandhi arrested
1923	Swaraj Party formed (C.R. Das, Motilal Nehru)
1925	Kakori Train Robbery (9 August)
1927	Simon Commission appointed (all British)
1928	Nehru Report; Simon Commission visits; Lajpat Rai lathi-charged (died Nov 1928)
1929	Lahore Session — Purna Swaraj; Saunders killed (Bhagat Singh)
1930	Dandi March (12 March — 6 April); Civil Disobedience Movement; Chittagong Armoury Raid
1931	Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 March); Bhagat Singh hanged (23 March); 2nd RTC; Karachi Session
1932	Communal Award; Poona Pact (25 September); 3rd RTC
1935	Government of India Act 1935
1937	Provincial elections; Congress won 7 states; Ministries formed
1939	World War II; Congress ministries resigned; Tripuri Session; Forward Bloc

Year	Event
1940	Lahore Resolution (Pakistan demand, 23 March); Individual CDM; Ramgarh Session
1942	Cripps Mission (March); Quit India (8 August); INA revived (September)
1943	Azad Hind Government (21 October, Singapore)
1945	World War II ended; INA trials began
1946	Cabinet Mission; Direct Action Day (16 August); Constituent Assembly (9 December)
1947	Mountbatten Plan (3 June); Indian Independence Act; Independence (15 August)
1949	Constitution adopted (26 November)
1950	Constitution came into force (26 January); India became Republic

15.2 High-Frequency Exam Facts — Last-Minute Revision

★ Most Frequently Asked in UPPCS/RO-ARO/SSC/UPSC

- First European to arrive in India = Vasco da Gama (Portuguese), 1498, at Calicut
- First Indian war against British = Battle of Plassey, 1757; first Viceroy = Lord Canning
- Farrukhsiyar's Farman (1717) = Magna Carta of British Rule in India
- Battle of Buxar (1764) = More decisive than Plassey; led to Diwani rights
- Subsidiary Alliance = Wellesley's policy; First state = Hyderabad (1798)
- Doctrine of Lapse = Dalhousie; First state = Satara (1848)
- Revolt of 1857 started = 10 May 1857, Meerut; Mangal Pandey fired first shot
- 1857: V.D. Savarkar = First War of Independence; British = Sepoy Mutiny
- Raja Ram Mohan Roy = Father of Indian Renaissance; abolished Sati 1829
- INC founded 1885 by A.O. Hume; first president = W.C. Banerjee
- Surat Split (1907) = Congress split; Lucknow Pact (1916) = Reunion + Muslim League
- Partition of Bengal (1905) = Curzon; Swadeshi started 7 August 1905
- Muslim League founded 30 December 1906, Dacca; Aga Khan = first president
- Purna Swaraj = Lahore Session, 1929; Jawaharlal Nehru = president
- Dandi March = 12 March 1930; Salt law broken = 6 April 1930
- Quit India = 8 August 1942; 'Do or Die' slogan by Gandhi
- Bhagat Singh hanged = 23 March 1931; INA formed by Mohan Singh in 1942
- Jai Hind = Subhas Bose/INA; Azad Hind Govt = 21 October 1943
- Cabinet Mission (1946) = Cripps, Alexander, Pethick-Lawrence
- Independence = 15 August 1947; Republic = 26 January 1950

15.3 Frequently Confused Facts

Confused Fact A	Confused Fact B	Clarification
Battle of Plassey 1757	Battle of Buxar 1764	Plassey laid foundation; Buxar consolidated British power (more decisive)
7 August 1905	16 October 1905	7 Aug = Swadeshi declared; 16 Oct = Official partition of Bengal
Separate electorate for Muslims: Morley-Minto 1909	Muslim League: 1906	Muslim League founded 1906; separate electorates given in 1909
Surat Split 1907	Lucknow Pact 1916	Split in 1907; reunion and Congress-League pact in 1916
Dandi March started 12 March 1930	Salt law broken 6 April 1930	March started 12 March from Sabarmati; reached Dandi and broke law 6 April
NCM started 1 August 1920	NCM called off 12 February 1922	Tilak died 1 August 1920 = same day NCM launched
Quit India 8 August 1942	Leaders arrested 9 August 1942	Movement launched 8 Aug; ALL leaders pre-emptively arrested 9 Aug morning
Bhagat Singh Central Assembly bombing 1929	Bhagat Singh hanged 23 March 1931	Two different events: bombing in 1929; execution in 1931
First Congress President: W.C. Banerjee 1885	First Woman Congress President: Annie Besant 1917	First Indian Woman Congress President: Sarojini Naidu 1925
Rani Lakshmibai died IN JHANSI	Rani Lakshmibai died IN GWALIOR (17 June 1858)	She fled to Gwalior after Jhansi fell; died fighting at Gwalior
Doctrine of Lapse: Awadh	Awadh annexed for 'misrule'	Awadh NOT under Doctrine of Lapse — it was for misrule in 1856
INA founded by Subhas Bose	INA originally founded by Captain Mohan Singh (1942)	Mohan Singh founded it; Bose took command from Rash Behari Bose in 1943

15.4 Memory Tricks (Mnemonics)

Memory Aids for Exam

- Order of Europeans: 'Please Drink English Danish French' = Portuguese (1498), Dutch (1605), English (1608), Danish (1620), French (1668)
- Subsidiary Alliance states: 'HMT-APP' = Hyderabad, Mysore, Tanjore, Awadh, Peshwa
- Doctrine of Lapse order: 'SJBUNJA' = Satara, Jaitpur, Baghat, Udaipur, Jhansi, Nagpur, Awadh
- First War of Indian Independence leaders: 'BNZLK' = Bahadur Shah Zafar, Nana Saheb, Rani Lakshmibai, Kunwar Singh = major leaders of 1857
- Congress Sessions: 'SLNKL' = Surat (1907 Split), Lucknow (1916 Pact), Nagpur (1920 NCM), Calcutta (1928 Nehru Report), Lahore (1929 Purna Swaraj)

- Round Table Conferences: 1st = No Congress; 2nd = Gandhi only; 3rd = No Congress again
- Gandhi's early Satyagrahas: 'CAK' = Champaran (1917), Ahmedabad (1918), Kheda (1918)
- Bhagat Singh's team: 'RSS' = Rajguru, Sukhdev, Singh — hanged together 23 March 1931
- Carnatic Wars: 3 wars = British won 3rd decisively at Wandiwash (1760), Treaty of Paris (1763)
- Dandi March: '78 followers, 241 miles, 24 days, 12 March to 6 April 1930'

15.5 Allahabad High Court RO-Specific Focus Points

High Court RO Exam Priority Topics

- All Acts and their years: Regulating Act 1773 → Pitt's India Act 1784 → Charter Acts → GOI Acts → Independence Act 1947
- Viceroy-wise events: Match each Viceroy with their key policy/reform (frequently asked in AHC RO)
- Constitutional development sequence: Must know each act's key provisions in one line
- All three Carnatic Wars: years, key battles, result — frequently tested in AHC RO
- INC Sessions: Match Year-Place-President-Decision — table format most exam-friendly
- Personality-based questions: Match leaders with organizations, books, newspapers
- Movement timelines: Exact dates for Swadeshi, NCM, CDM, Quit India — dates matter
- Revolutionary events: Match revolutionary with act (Bhagat Singh → Saunders murder + Assembly bomb)
- Governor General reforms: Who did what — Bentinck abolished Sati, Dalhousie introduced railways
- Match: Revolt of 1857 centers with leaders — asked frequently in AHC RO

Document Prepared for: Allahabad High Court RO | UPPCS | RO/ARO | SSC | UPSC | Railway Exams

References: NCERT Class 6–12 | Spectrum Modern India | Bipin Chandra's Modern India | Plassey to Partition